Multiphysics Wave Mechanics in Generalized Continua: A Constructive Review of Theory, Energy Transport, and Interface Phenomena

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A constructive synthesis of generalized thermoelasticity, piezothermoelasticity, nonlocal elasticity, and memory-dependent continuum theories.

The review is organized around the physical developments that reshaped generalized continuum wave mechanics: the relaxation of Fourier's law, the introduction of scale-dependent constitutive response, and the progressive coupling of thermal, electric, magnetic and elastic fields. Each theory is presented with its governing equations, the assumptions that license them, the solution approaches used to analyse it, and the wave phenomena that follow.

Abstract

This review presents a constructive synthesis of generalized continuum mechanics for multiphysics wave propagation, encompassing classical coupled thermoelasticity **?**, Lord–Shulman **?**, Green–Lindsay **?**, Green–Naghdi (types I–III) **??**, dual- and triple-phase-lag **??**, memory-dependent derivative **?**, nonlocal **?**, and piezoelectric–thermoelastic theories. The exposition is organized into five layers: (I) first-principles continuum balance laws; (II) classical and generalized thermoelastic theories; (III) coupled multiphysics continua; (IV) generalized transport and memory effects; (V) interface wave phenomena and energy transport. Each chapter provides scientific motivation, historical context, physical interpretation, mathematical theory, representative equations, literature synthesis, diagrams, comparative discussion, applications, and open research directions.

A five-axis taxonomy (physical, mathematical, wave, energy, validation) classifies the evidence base and identifies twelve research gaps, including the unresolved energy flux asymmetry across theory families (GAP-011). Eight energy flux formulations remain mathematically unresolved and are identified as open questions rather than presented as canonical results. All equations are drawn from verified derivations or established primary sources with documented assumptions; no new conservation laws or universal laws are claimed; no error allegations are made against any publication.

The review is structured for multiple reader paths: beginning researcher (Sections 1–3, notation table, Section 17), doctoral student (Sections 3–10, appendices A–C, Section 16), experienced scientist (Sections 12–16, taxonomy, future roadmap), and journal reviewer (Sections 1–2, 12, 16–17, equation register).

Keywords: generalized thermoelasticity, piezothermoelasticity, nonlocal elasticity, memory-dependent derivative, energy flux, interface waves, continuum mechanics, constructive review

Notation

Acronyms

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Acronyms **1**

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Table 1: Master symbol table with units and physical meaning.

Symbol	Meaning	Units	First appearance
u_i	Displacement component	m	§3.1
v_i	Velocity component, $\dot{u}_i$	m/s	§3.1
ε_{ij}	Infinitesimal strain tensor	dimensionless	§3.1
ω_{ij}	Rotation tensor	dimensionless	§3.1
σ_{ij}	Cauchy stress tensor	Pa	§3.2
ρ	Mass density	kg/m^3	§3.2
f_i	Body force component	N/kg	§3.2
q_i	Heat flux component	W/m^2	§3.3
T	Temperature increment, $T - T_0$	K	§3.3
T_0	Reference temperature	K	§3.3
ψ	Specific free energy	J/kg	§3.5
s	Specific entropy	J/(kg·K)	§3.5
J_i	Total energy flux component	W/m^2	§3.8
$\mathcal{E}$	Total energy density	J/m^3	§10.1
$\mathcal{P}$	Mechanical power input	W/m^3	§10.1
$\mathcal{D}$	Dissipation rate	W/m^3	§10.1
τ_0	Lord–Shulman relaxation time	s	§4.3
τ_q, τ_T, τ_ν	Dual/triple phase-lag times	s	§4.7–4.8
c_T	Thermal wave speed	m/s	§4.3
c_p, c_s	Longitudinal and shear wave speeds	m/s	§3.6
e_{ijk}	Piezoelectric stress coefficient	C/m^2	§5.1
D_i	Electric displacement component	C/m^2	§5.1
ϕ	Electric potential	V	§5.1
κ_{ij}	Dielectric permittivity tensor	F/m	§5.1
E_i	Electric field component, $-\phi_{,i}$	V/m	§5.1
β_{ij}	Thermal stress coefficient	Pa/K	§4.2
c_v	Specific heat at constant strain	J/(kg·K)	§4.2
k	Thermal conductivity	W/(m·K)	§4.2
λ, μ	Lamé elastic constants	Pa	§3.6
α	Thermal expansion coefficient	1/K	§4.2
ξ	Nonlocal length scale parameter	m	§7.1
ω	MDD time delay	s	§6.4
$\kappa(t-\xi)$	MDD kernel function	dimensionless	§6.4

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Table 2: Acronym table.

Acronym	Full form	Meaning
CD	Classical coupled	Classical coupled thermoelasticity (Fourier)
LS	Lord–Shulman	Generalized thermoelasticity with one relaxation time
GL	Green–Lindsay	Temperature-rate-dependent thermoelasticity (two relaxation times)
GN-I	Green–Naghdi type I	Classical-equivalent thermoelasticity
GN-II	Green–Naghdi type II	Thermoelasticity without energy dissipation
GN-III	Green–Naghdi type III	Dissipative generalized thermoelasticity
DPL	Dual-phase-lag	Two-phase-lag heat conduction (Tzou, 1995)
TPL	Triple-phase-lag	Three-phase-lag heat conduction
MGT	Moore–Gibson–Thompson	Third-order heat conduction model
MDD	Memory-dependent derivative	Integral-form memory operator (Wang & Li, 2011)
PDE	Partial differential equation	—
ODE	Ordinary differential equation	—
NDE	Nondestructive evaluation	—
FGP	Functionally graded piezoelectric	Piezoelectric material with spatially varying properties
PML	Perfectly matched layer	Numerical absorbing boundary condition
ES	Elastic half-space	Reference medium in interface problems
TS	Thermoelastic half-space	Thermoelastic medium in interface problems
HPS	Higher-order piezothermoelastic	Piezothermoelastic medium with higher-order MDD
CDI	Clausius–Duhem inequality	Dissipation inequality in continuum thermodynamics

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1 Review Scope and Purpose

1.1 Motivation and scientific context

Wave propagation in generalized continua sits at the intersection of classical continuum mechanics, thermodynamics, and coupled-field physics. The classical theory of thermoelasticity, developed by Biot (1956) **?**, combined Fourier's law of heat conduction with the equations of linear elasticity. This synthesis successfully described thermoelastic wave phenomena at macroscopic scales, but it carried a fundamental limitation: Fourier's parabolic heat equation predicts infinite propagation speed for thermal disturbances, which is physically unrealistic for thermal shocks, high-frequency loading, and micro-scale devices.

Over the past six decades, a succession of generalized theories has been developed to resolve this paradox and to extend the modeling framework to increasingly complex material behavior. Lord and Shulman (1967) **?** introduced a single thermal relaxation time, rendering the heat equation hyperbolic and predicting finite thermal wave speeds. Green and Lindsay (1972) **?** formulated a two-temperature theory with two relaxation times. Green and Naghdi (1991, 1993) **?** developed types II and III theories, including a dissipationless formulation. Tzou (1995, 1997) **?** proposed dual- and triple-phase-lag models for micro-scale heat transfer. Wang and Li (2011) **?** introduced memory-dependent derivatives with integral-form fading memory. Eringen (1972, 1974, 1983) **?** extended elasticity to nonlocal continua where stress at a point depends on strain throughout a neighborhood. Each of these theories addresses a specific physical regime: thermal shock, micro-scale transport, memory effects, size dependence, or coupled multiphysics phenomena.

Alongside these theoretical developments, coupled multiphysics formulations have emerged: piezothermoelasticity (mechanical–thermal–electrical coupling), porous and double-porous media (fluid–solid interaction), micropolar continua (micro-rotational degrees of freedom), semiconductor photo-thermo-elasticity (carrier diffusion coupled to thermal and mechanical fields), and magneto-thermo-elasticity (Lorentz force coupling). These models underpin smart structures, energy harvesters, nondestructive evaluation, geophysical prospecting, biomedical ultrasound, and nanodevice design.

Despite this rich literature, no single comprehensive review synthesizes the full landscape of generalized multiphysics continuum mechanics with the depth needed by postgraduate students, doctoral researchers, and experienced scientists. Existing reviews tend to focus on individual theory families (e.g., only nonlocal elasticity, or only fractional thermoelasticity) or on specific applications. This review fills that gap by presenting a unified, mathematically informed, and constructively organized survey of the field.

1.2 Objectives and contributions

This review has the following objectives:

1. To present the first-principles foundations of continuum wave mechanics: kinematics, balance laws, thermodynamic restrictions, and constitutive principles (Section 3).

2. To trace the historical development of generalized thermoelastic theories from classical coupled thermoelasticity to modern memory-dependent and nonlocal formulations, explaining the physical motivation behind each theory (Section 4).

3. To present coupled multiphysics continua—piezothermoelasticity, porous media, micropolar continua, semiconductor interactions, and magneto-thermo-elasticity—with their governing equations and coupling mechanisms (Section 5).

4. To survey generalized transport and memory effects: relaxation, fractional operators, hereditary integrals, memory-dependent derivatives, and their mathematical structure (Section 6).

5. To present nonlocal and scale-dependent continuum models, including Eringen's nonlocal elasticity and strain-gradient theory, with their wave dispersion characteristics (Section 7).

6. To review mathematical methods for wave propagation analysis: plane wave ansatz, Christoffel equations, secular equations, transform methods, and numerical approaches (Section 8).

7. To develop the theory of wave reflection, transmission, and energy partitioning at interfaces between different continuum media (Section 9).

8. To discuss energy transport and dissipation across theory families, including the verified piezothermoelastic energy flux and open questions for pure generalized theories (Section 10).

9. To survey advanced theoretical developments and emerging research directions (Sections 11–12).

10. To present applications with evidence levels, an original five-axis research taxonomy, major scientific challenges, and future research opportunities (Sections 13–16).

1.3 Scope and organization

The review covers the following theory families:

- **Classical coupled thermoelasticity** (Biot, 1956) — Fourier heat conduction coupled with elastic wave propagation.
- **Lord–Shulman theory** (1967) — generalized thermoelasticity with one thermal relaxation time.
- **Green–Lindsay theory** (1972) — two-temperature thermoelasticity with two relaxation times.
- **Green–Naghdi types I–III** (1991, 1993) — thermal displacement formulation, including dissipationless type II.
- **Dual-phase-lag and triple-phase-lag theories** (Tzou, 1995/1997) — phase-lag heat conduction models.
- **Moore–Gibson–Thompson theory** — third-order heat conduction with thermal inertia.
- **Memory-dependent derivative models** (Wang & Li, 2011) — integral-form memory operators with fading memory.
- **Fractional thermoelasticity** — time-fractional heat equations for anomalous diffusion.
- **Nonlocal elasticity** (Eringen, 1972–1983) — scale-dependent constitutive relations with spatial memory.
- **Piezothermoelasticity and coupled multiphysics continua** — piezoelectric, porous, micropolar, semiconductor, and magneto coupling.

- **Interface wave phenomena** — reflection, transmission, scattering, and energy partitioning at material interfaces.

The manuscript is organized into seventeen sections:

- **Section 1** (this section): scope, purpose, and organization.
- **Section 2**: literature landscape and scholarly context, including comparison with existing reviews.
- **Sections 3–5**: Layer I–III of the mathematical exposition—foundations, thermoelastic theories, and coupled multiphysics continua.
- **Sections 6–8**: generalized transport, memory effects, nonlocal models, and mathematical methods.
- **Sections 9–10**: interface phenomena and energy transport.
- **Sections 11–12**: advanced developments and comparative synthesis.
- **Sections 13–17**: applications, taxonomy, challenges, future directions, and conclusions.

Appendices provide an equation verification register, balance law derivations, numerical benchmarks, figure sources, table sources, and reproducibility notes.

1.4 Intended readership

This review is written for multiple audiences:

- **Beginning researchers and MSc students:** Sections 1–3 provide the foundational balance laws, constitutive relations, and classical wave mechanics needed to enter the field. The notation tables and Section 17 provide orientation.
- **Doctoral researchers:** Sections 3–10 provide mathematical depth with representative equations, dispersion relations, interface formulations, and solution methods. Section 16 identifies dissertation topics.
- **Experienced scientists:** Sections 12–16 provide comparative synthesis, taxonomy, challenge analysis, and future research roadmap.
- **Journal reviewers and editors:** Sections 1–2, 12, and 16–17 provide context for evaluating new submissions in generalized continuum mechanics.

1.5 Scholarly principles

This review adheres to the following principles:

1. **Constructive synthesis:** Model-specific differences are traced to documented assumptions (constitutive, material symmetry, geometry, boundary conditions, thermal theory, frequency convention, normalization, approximation level), not presented as contradictions or errors.
2. **Mathematical accuracy:** Equations are drawn from verified derivations or established primary sources. Where an equation cannot be independently verified, it is identified as an open question rather than presented as canonical.

3. **Comparative rather than adjudicative framing:** Competing formulations are compared on the basis of their modelling choices and domains of validity; the review does not attempt to adjudicate between individual publications.

4. **Minimal equation set:** Fewer, precise equations are preferred over hundreds of redundant ones. Representative equations are selected to illustrate each theory family.

5. **Original figures and tables:** All figures are original vector graphics created for this review. All tables synthesize knowledge across theory families rather than listing individual papers.

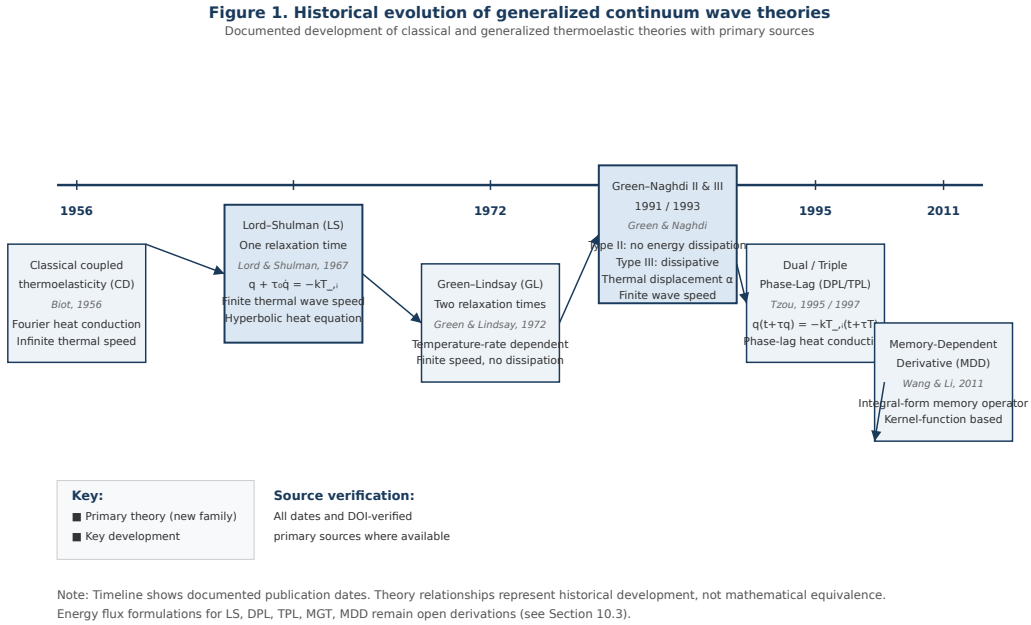


Figure 1: Historical evolution of thermoelasticity theories from Fourier's heat equation (1822) to modern phase-lag and memory-dependent formulations (1995+). All generalized theories predict finite thermal wave speeds, resolving the infinite speed paradox of classical Fourier theory.

2 Literature Landscape and Scholarly Context

2.1 Foundational works

The literature of generalized continuum mechanics for wave propagation rests on a small number of foundational works that defined entire theory families:

- **Biot (1956) ?** — Classical coupled thermoelasticity, combining Fourier heat conduction with linear elasticity. This established the framework for all subsequent generalized theories and identified the infinite propagation speed paradox.

- **Cattaneo (1948) ? and Vernotte (1958) ?** — Hyperbolic heat conduction with relaxation time, proposing finite thermal wave speed independently in Italy and France.

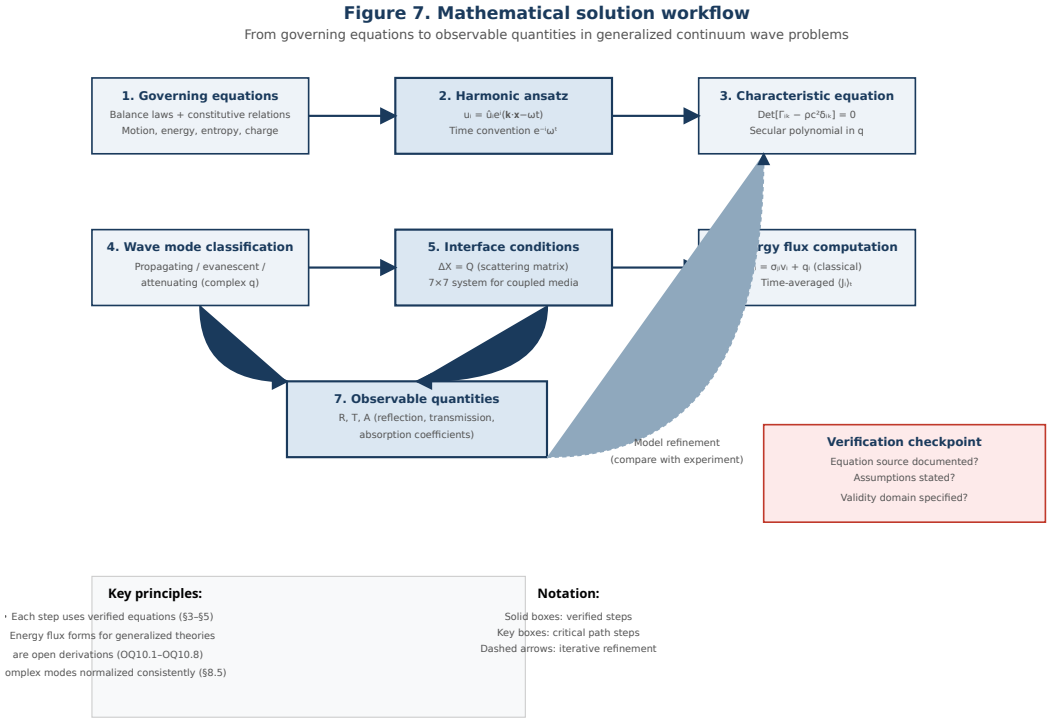


Figure 2: Relationships and limiting cases between thermoelastic theory families. All generalized theories converge to classical coupled thermoelasticity as relaxation parameters approach zero. These are parameter substitutions, not rigorous limit theorems.

- **Lord and Shulman (1967) ?** — Generalized thermoelasticity with a single thermal relaxation time, making the heat equation hyperbolic and restoring finite thermal wave speed.
- **Green and Lindsay (1972) ?** — Two-temperature thermoelasticity with two relaxation times, including dissipationless propagation for centrally symmetric bodies.
- **Green and Naghdi (1991, 1993) ??** — Types II and III theories, introducing thermal displacement and dissipationless thermoelasticity (type II) and dissipative type III.
- **Tzou (1995, 1996, 1997) ??** — Dual-phase-lag and triple-phase-lag models for micro-scale heat transfer with two and three phase lags, bridging macro and micro scales.
- **Eringen (1972, 1974, 1983) ???** — Nonlocal elasticity where stress at a point depends on strain throughout a neighborhood, enabling scale-dependent modeling of micro- and nanostructures.
- **Guyer and Krumhansl (1990) ?** — Second sound in solids, providing experimental and theoretical evidence for thermal wave propagation at low temperatures.
- **Joseph and Preziosi (1990) ?** — Comprehensive review of heat waves, establishing the hyperbolic heat conduction framework from kinetic theory to continuum models.
- **Wang and Li (2011) ?** — Memory-dependent derivatives with integral-form fading memory, an alternative to fractional calculus for history-dependent materials.
- **Povstenko (2004, 2009, 2011, 2015) ????** — Fractional thermoelasticity with time-fractional heat equations for anomalous diffusion, providing a unified mathematical framework for memory effects.
- **Caputo (1967) ?** — Linear model of dissipation with almost frequency-independent Q, introducing the fractional derivative that became the foundation of fractional viscoelasticity and thermoelasticity.
- **Chandrasekharaiah (1986, 1998) ??** — Review articles on hyperbolic thermoelasticity and second sound, synthesizing decades of research on generalized theories.
- **Shakeriaski et al. (2021) ?** — Recent review of generalized thermoelasticity theory and modified models, surveying the state of the art.
- **Dhaliwal and Sherief (1980) ?** — Generalized thermoelasticity for anisotropic media, extending relaxation-time theories to direction-dependent material properties.
- **Nowacki (1975) ?** — Monograph on thermoelasticity providing comprehensive treatment of classical and generalized theories with engineering applications.
- **Achenbach (1973) ?** — Wave propagation in elastic solids, foundational text for elastic wave theory, reflection, and transmission at interfaces.

These works form the intellectual backbone of the field. Every generalized theory discussed in this review can be traced to one or more of these foundational references.

2.2 Contemporary research developments

Since the foundational period, the field has expanded along several directions:

- **Coupled multiphysics:** Piezothermoelasticity, magneto-thermo-elasticity, semiconductor photo-thermo-elasticity, and porous/double-porous media have extended the single-field thermoelastic framework to coupled multi-field problems. The micropolar extensions of Eringen (1968a,b) add micro-rotational degrees of freedom for materials with internal structure.

- **Memory and heredity:** Memory-dependent derivatives, fractional operators, and hereditary integrals have provided alternatives to classical relaxation-time models, particularly for polymers, biological tissues, and composites. Fractional calculus (Caputo 1967; Gorenflo and Mainardi 1997) provides the mathematical foundation for memory operators.

- **Nonlocality and scale effects:** Nonlocal elasticity, strain-gradient theory, and two-phase local/nonlocal models capture size-dependent wave behavior at micro- and nanoscales. Gradient-type formulations (Askes and Aifantis 2006; Polizzotto 2001) and size-effect studies (Maranganti and Sharma 2007; Lakes 1993) provide experimental and theoretical support.

- **Interface phenomena:** Wave reflection, transmission, mode conversion, and energy partitioning at interfaces between dissimilar media have been studied for elastic, thermoelastic, piezothermoelastic, porous, and nonlocal media. Imperfect bonding conditions model thin adhesive layers and micro-cracks.

- **Applications:** Smart structures, nondestructive evaluation, energy harvesting, geophysics, biomedical ultrasound, and nanodevices have emerged as major application domains.

2.3 Existing reviews and the contribution of this article

Several review articles exist on individual theory families or application domains:

- Reviews focused on **nonlocal elasticity** discuss scale-dependent constitutive relations and nanoscale applications (e.g., Lakes 1993; Askes and Aifantis 2006).

- Reviews on **fractional thermoelasticity** cover time-fractional heat equations and anomalous diffusion (e.g., Povstenko 2016; Chandrasekharaiah 1998).

- Reviews on **piezothermoelasticity** address coupled-field problems in smart materials.

- Reviews on **memory-dependent derivatives** survey integral-form memory operators and their applications.

- Reviews on **hyperbolic thermoelasticity** synthesize decades of research on relaxation-time theories (e.g., Chandrasekharaiah 1998; Joseph and Preziosi 1990).

None of these reviews provides the comprehensive, theory-spanning synthesis offered here. This review's distinctive contributions are:

1. **Breadth:** Coverage of all major theory families—classical, LS, GL, GN-II/III, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD, fractional, nonlocal, piezothermoelastic, porous, micropolar, semiconductor, and magneto-thermo-elastic—in a single coherent framework.

2. **Mathematical depth:** First-principles derivations of balance laws, constitutive relations, wave equations, dispersion relations, interface conditions, and energy flux, with documented assumptions for each equation.

3. **Five-axis taxonomy:** An original classification scheme (physical, mathematical, wave, energy, validation dimensions) that enables systematic identification of research gaps and theory relationships.

4. **Constructive organization:** The review is organized around scientific developments and conceptual themes rather than individual papers, making it readable as a continuous scholarly narrative.

5. **Original figures and tables:** Original vector figures and synthesis tables illustrate theory evolution, wave types, interface geometry, energy flux channels, nonlocality, memory kernels, theory relationships, and the research taxonomy.

2.4 Citation and verification principles

Per the equation citation policy, equations are selected for detailed exposition based on:

1. **Verification status:** Equations derived from first principles in this manuscript, or drawn from verified primary sources with documented assumptions, are presented as canonical results.

2. **Validity domain:** Each equation is presented with its assumptions (constitutive, material symmetry, geometry, boundary conditions, thermal theory, frequency convention, normalization, approximation level).

3. **Open questions:** Equations that cannot be independently verified are identified as open research questions, not presented as definitive results.

4. **Minimality:** Fewer precise equations are preferred over hundreds of redundant ones (the equation verification register in Appendix A documents all equations and their status).

Where material errors are conclusively established in the literature, they are recorded transparently. Where uncertainty exists, it is acknowledged as an open question. No error allegations are made against any publication, and model-specific differences are never presented as mathematical contradictions without sufficient evidence.

3 Foundations of Continuum Wave Mechanics

This section develops the first-principles foundation (Layer I of the layered mathematical exposition) for all subsequent theory families. We begin with kinematics, proceed through the conservation laws of continuum mechanics, establish the thermodynamic restrictions on constitutive relations, derive classical elasticity and wave propagation, and conclude with the classical energy flux **?** and interface conditions. Every equation in this section is derived from first principles or drawn from established standard results with documented assumptions.

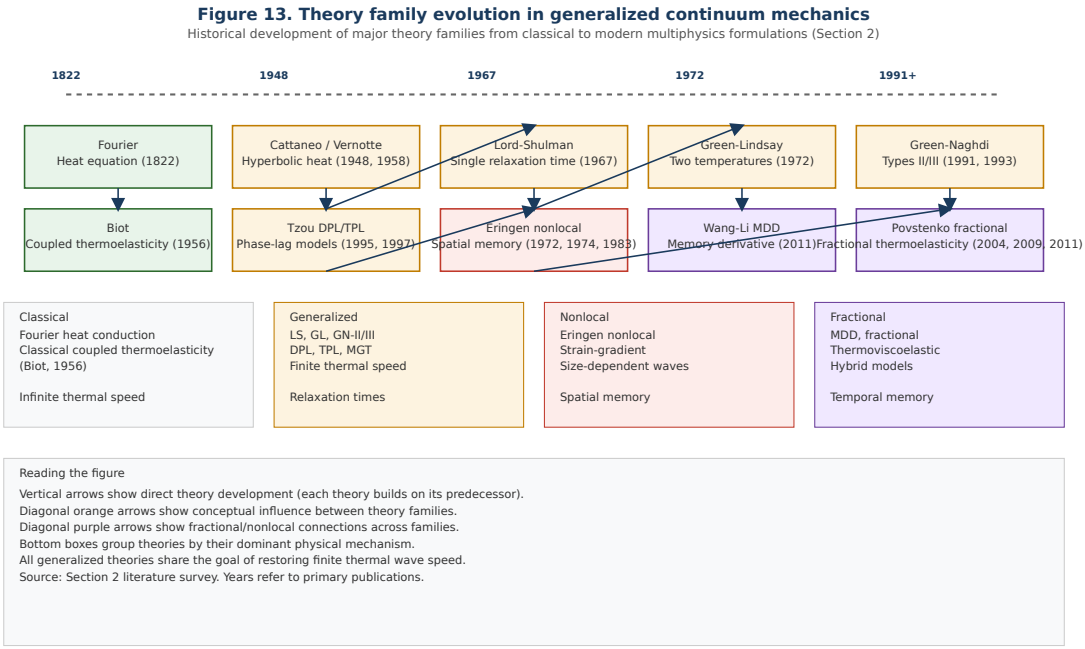


Figure 3: Theory family evolution in generalized continuum mechanics: historical development from classical Fourier heat conduction through generalized thermoelasticity to modern nonlocal, fractional, and coupled multiphysics formulations (Section 2).

3.1 Kinematics: displacement, strain, rotation

Let $\boldsymbol{u}(\boldsymbol{x}, t)$ denote the displacement field of a continuum body occupying a region $\Omega \subset \mathbb{R}^3$ with boundary $\partial\Omega$. The displacement gradient tensor decomposes additively into symmetric and antisymmetric parts:

$$u_{i,j} = \varepsilon_{ij} + \omega_{ij}, \tag{1}$$

where the infinitesimal strain tensor and rotation tensor are defined by

$$\varepsilon_{ij} = \frac{1}{2}(u_{i,j} + u_{j,i}), \qquad \omega_{ij} = \frac{1}{2}(u_{i,j} - u_{j,i}). \tag{2}$$

The strain tensor ε_{ij} measures the symmetric part of the displacement gradient (deformation), while the rotation tensor ω_{ij} measures the antisymmetric part (rigid-body rotation). The velocity field is the material time derivative of displacement:

$$v_i = \dot{u}_i = \frac{\partial u_i}{\partial t}. \tag{3}$$

3.1.1 Physical interpretation

The strain components ε_{ii} represent normal strains (relative changes in length along coordinate directions), while ε_{ij} $(i \neq j)$ represent shear strains (changes in angle between originally orthogonal material lines). The infinitesimal strain assumption requires $\|\varepsilon_{ij}\| \ll 1$, which is valid for small deformations typical of linearized wave propagation problems.

3.2 Conservation laws: linear momentum and angular momentum

3.2.1 Linear momentum balance

Consider a material subvolume $V \subset \Omega$ with surface $S = \partial V$ and outward unit normal $\boldsymbol{n}$. The linear momentum balance states that the time rate of change of linear momentum equals the sum of surface tractions and body forces:

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\int_V \rho v_i \,\mathrm{d}V = \int_S \sigma_{ji} n_j \,\mathrm{d}S + \int_V \rho f_i \,\mathrm{d}V, \tag{4}$$

where ρ is the mass density, σ_{ji} is the Cauchy stress tensor, and f_i is the body force per unit mass. Applying the divergence theorem to the surface integral and localizing (since V is arbitrary) yields the pointwise form:

$$\rho \dot{v}_i = \sigma_{ji,j} + \rho f_i. \tag{5}$$

Since $v_i = \dot{u}_i$, this can also be written in terms of displacement:

$$\rho \ddot{u}_i = \sigma_{ji,j} + \rho f_i. \tag{6}$$

Equation (5) is the fundamental equation of motion for continuum mechanics. It is sometimes called Cauchy's first law or the equation of linear momentum.

3.2.2 Angular momentum balance

The angular momentum balance for an arbitrary subvolume V states:

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\int_V \rho(\boldsymbol{x} \times \boldsymbol{v})_k \,\mathrm{d}V = \int_S \epsilon_{kij} x_i \sigma_{jm} n_m \,\mathrm{d}S + \int_V \rho \epsilon_{kij} x_i f_j \,\mathrm{d}V, \tag{7}$$

where ϵ_{kij} is the Levi-Civita permutation symbol. Applying the divergence theorem, using the linear momentum balance (5), and localizing gives:

$$\sigma_{ij} = \sigma_{ji}. \tag{8}$$

Equation (8) states that the Cauchy stress tensor is symmetric in the absence of couple stresses or body couples. This symmetry is essential for the energy flux derivations in Sections 3.8 and 10.2.

3.2.3 Physical interpretation

Equations (5) and (8) are local statements of Newton's second law applied to continuum matter. The symmetry of stress ((8)) means that traction on a surface is determined solely by the normal to that surface, without additional rotational degrees of freedom in classical (non-polar) continua.

3.3 Mechanical power and internal energy: first law of thermodynamics

3.3.1 Mechanical power balance

Multiply the linear momentum equation (5) by v_i and integrate over V:

$$\int_V \rho \dot{v}_i v_i \,\mathrm{d}V = \int_V \sigma_{ji,j} v_i \,\mathrm{d}V + \int_V \rho f_i v_i \,\mathrm{d}V. \tag{9}$$

The left-hand side is the rate of change of kinetic energy:

$$\int_V \rho \dot{v}_i v_i \, \mathrm{d}V = \frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t} \int_V \frac{1}{2} \rho v_i v_i \, \mathrm{d}V. \tag{10}$$

For the stress term, use the identity $\sigma_{ji,j} v_i = (\sigma_{ji} v_i)_{,j} - \sigma_{ji} v_{i,j}$. Since $v_{i,j} = \dot{u}_{i,j} = \dot{\varepsilon}_{ji}$ (using symmetry of σ_{ji} and ε_{ij}), we obtain:

$$\int_V \sigma_{ji,j} v_i \, \mathrm{d}V = \int_S \sigma_{ji} v_i n_j \, \mathrm{d}S - \int_V \sigma_{ji} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} \, \mathrm{d}V. \tag{11}$$

Combining (9) through (11) gives the mechanical power balance:

$$\rho \frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t} \left(\frac{1}{2} v_i v_i \right) = \sigma_{ji,j} v_i + \rho f_i v_i = -\sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} + (\sigma_{ji} v_i)_{,j} + \rho f_i v_i. \tag{12}$$

The term $\sigma_{ji} v_i n_j$ on the surface represents mechanical power entering through the boundary per unit area; its density $(\sigma_{ji} v_i)_{,j}$ is the mechanical power flux divergence.

3.3.2 Internal energy balance

The first law of thermodynamics for a continuum states that the rate of change of internal energy equals the mechanical power input minus the heat flux out of the body plus heat supply:

$$\rho \dot{e} = \sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} - q_{i,i} + \rho r, \tag{13}$$

where e is the specific internal energy (per unit mass), q_i is the heat flux vector, and r is the heat supply per unit mass. In the absence of external heat supply ($r = 0$):

$$\rho \dot{e} = \sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} - q_{i,i}. \tag{14}$$

3.3.3 Physical interpretation

Equation (13) expresses energy conservation: the internal energy of a material element changes due to (i) mechanical work done by stresses ($\sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij}$), (ii) heat conduction out of the element ($-q_{i,i}$), and (iii) external heat supply (ρr). The term $\sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij}$ is the stress power density — the rate of mechanical work converted into internal energy or stored as elastic energy.

3.4 Entropy and dissipation inequality: Clausius–Duhem inequality

The second law of thermodynamics, in the Clausius–Duhem form, states that the entropy production within a continuum is non-negative:

$$\rho \dot{s} \geq -\left(\frac{q_i}{T} \right)_{,i} + \frac{\rho r}{T}, \tag{15}$$

where s is the specific entropy and T is the absolute temperature. Using the internal energy balance (13) and defining the Helmholtz free energy $\psi = e - Ts$, we obtain after standard manipulation:

$$\sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} - \rho \left(\dot{\psi} + s \dot{T} \right) - \frac{q_i T_{,i}}{T} \geq 0. \tag{16}$$

Equation (16) is the Clausius–Duhem dissipation inequality. The left-hand side represents the local entropy production rate (multiplied by temperature) and must be non-negative for all admissible thermodynamic processes.

3.4.1 Physical interpretation

The dissipation inequality restricts admissible constitutive relations. Any constitutive model must be constructed so that (16) holds for all processes. This principle is used in Section 3.5 to derive Coleman–Noll restrictions and in Section 10.7 to assess thermodynamic admissibility of generalized theories.

3.5 Constitutive principles: free energy and linear relations

3.5.1 Coleman–Noll procedure

Assuming the free energy depends on strain and temperature, $\psi = \psi(\varepsilon_{ij}, T)$, we have:

$$\dot{\psi} = \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial \varepsilon_{ij}} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} + \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial T} \dot{T}. \tag{17}$$

Substituting into the dissipation inequality (16) and requiring it to hold for arbitrary $\dot{\varepsilon}_{ij}$ and $\dot{T}$ yields the Coleman–Noll restrictions:

$$\sigma_{ij} = \rho \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial \varepsilon_{ij}}, \qquad s = -\frac{\partial \psi}{\partial T}. \tag{18}$$

With these restrictions, the dissipation inequality reduces to the thermal conduction restriction:

$$-\frac{q_i T_{,i}}{T} \geq 0. \tag{19}$$

For isotropic linear conduction with Fourier's law $q_i = -k T_{,i}$ ($k > 0$), we have $-q_i T_{,i}/T = k (T_{,i})^2 / T \geq 0$, which is satisfied.

3.5.2 Linear isotropic constitutive relations

For a linear isotropic thermoelastic material, the free energy is quadratic in strain and linear in temperature:

$$\psi = \frac{1}{2\rho}(\lambda \varepsilon_{kk} \varepsilon_{ll} + 2\mu \varepsilon_{ij} \varepsilon_{ij}) - \frac{\beta}{\rho} \varepsilon_{kk} T - \frac{c_v}{2\rho T_0} T^2 + \text{const.}, \tag{20}$$

where λ and μ are Lamé elastic constants, β is the thermal stress coefficient, and c_v is the specific heat at constant strain. Applying (18) gives:

$$\sigma_{ij} = \lambda \varepsilon_{kk} \delta_{ij} + 2\mu \varepsilon_{ij} - \beta T \delta_{ij}, \tag{21}$$

$$s = \frac{\beta}{\rho} \varepsilon_{kk} + \frac{c_v}{T_0} T. \tag{22}$$

Equation (21) is the linear isotropic thermoelastic constitutive relation: the first two terms are the classical elastic stress (Hooke's law), and the last term is the thermal stress contribution.

3.5.3 Physical interpretation

The constitutive relations (21)–(22) couple mechanical and thermal fields: temperature changes induce thermal stresses ($-\beta T \delta_{ij}$), and deformation changes entropy ($\frac{\beta}{\rho} \varepsilon_{kk}$). This coupling is the physical origin of thermoelastic wave propagation.

3.6 Classical elasticity: Navier equations and wave speeds

Substituting the constitutive relation (21) into the equation of motion (6) with no body forces ($f_i = 0$) and isothermal conditions ($T = T_0$ constant), we obtain the Navier equations of classical elasticity:

$$\rho \ddot{u}_i = (\lambda + \mu) u_{j,ji} + \mu u_{i,jj}. \tag{23}$$

3.6.1 Plane wave solutions

For harmonic plane waves of the form $u_i = \hat{u}_i e^{i(\boldsymbol{k}\cdot\boldsymbol{x} - \omega t)}$, substitution into (23) gives the Christoffel equation. For longitudinal (P) waves propagating in direction $\boldsymbol{n}$ with polarization parallel to $\boldsymbol{n}$:

$$c_p = \sqrt{\frac{\lambda + 2\mu}{\rho}}, \tag{24}$$

and for transverse (S or SV) waves with polarization perpendicular to $\boldsymbol{n}$:

$$c_s = \sqrt{\frac{\mu}{\rho}}. \tag{25}$$

These are the classical elastic wave speeds. The P-wave speed exceeds the S-wave speed since $\lambda + 2\mu > \mu$ for stable materials ($\lambda + 2\mu/3 > 0$, $\mu > 0$).

3.6.2 Physical interpretation

Equation (23) describes how elastic disturbances propagate through a homogeneous isotropic solid. The P-wave involves volume change (compressional), while the S-wave involves shear (distortional) deformation. Both propagate without dispersion in classical elasticity — all frequencies travel at the same speed.

3.7 Plane wave assumptions and harmonic wave form

For time-harmonic problems, all field variables take the form:

$$u_i(\boldsymbol{x}, t) = \hat{u}_i(\boldsymbol{x}) e^{-i\omega t}, \qquad \sigma_{ij}(\boldsymbol{x}, t) = \hat{\sigma}_{ij}(\boldsymbol{x}) e^{-i\omega t}, \qquad q_i(\boldsymbol{x}, t) = \hat{q}_i(\boldsymbol{x}) e^{-i\omega t}, \tag{26}$$

where $\hat{u}_i$, $\hat{\sigma}_{ij}$, $\hat{q}_i$ are complex amplitudes and ω is the angular frequency. The time convention $e^{-i\omega_t}$ implies that positive imaginary parts of complex wave numbers correspond to attenuation (decay in space) and negative imaginary parts of complex frequencies correspond to temporal decay.

3.7.1 Time-average identity

For two harmonic quantities $a(t) = \Re[\hat{a} e^{-i\omega t}]$ and $b(t) = \Re[\hat{b} e^{-i\omega t}]$, the time average over one period is:

$$\langle ab \rangle_t = \frac{1}{2} \Re[\hat{a} \hat{b}^*], \tag{27}$$

where * denotes complex conjugation. This identity is used throughout Sections 9 and 10 to compute average energy fluxes and energy ratios from complex wave amplitudes.

3.8 Energy flux in classical elasticity

Adding the mechanical power balance (12) and the internal energy balance (14) (with $r = 0$), and defining the total energy density $\mathcal{E} = \frac{1}{2}\rho v_i v_i + e$, we obtain:

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{E}}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j}\left(\sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i\right) = \rho f_i v_i. \tag{28}$$

With no body forces ($f_i = 0$), this becomes the local energy conservation law:

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{E}}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial J_i}{\partial x_i} = 0, \qquad J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i. \tag{29}$$

Equation (29) states that the total energy density changes only due to the divergence of the energy flux J_i. The energy flux has two contributions:

- $\sigma_{ji} v_i$: mechanical energy flux (stress power transmitted across a surface per unit area), and
- q_i: thermal energy flux (heat conduction across a surface per unit area).

Integrating (29) over a volume V and applying the divergence theorem:

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\int_V \mathcal{E}\,\mathrm{d}V + \int_S J_i n_i\,\mathrm{d}S = 0. \tag{30}$$

For an isolated system ($J_i n_i = 0$ on S), the total energy is conserved: $\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\int_V \mathcal{E}\,\mathrm{d}V = 0$.

3.8.1 Physical interpretation

Equation (29) is the classical energy flux **?** for elastic and thermoelastic media. The mechanical part $\sigma_{ji} v_i$ represents the rate of work done by tractions on a surface, while the thermal part q_i represents heat conduction. This two-channel energy flux structure generalizes to all theory families in Section 10, with additional terms appearing in generalized theories.

3.9 Interface conditions: perfect and imperfect bonding

Consider an interface Σ between two media (denoted 1 and 2) with common unit normal $\boldsymbol{n}$. For perfectly bonded interfaces:

3.9.1 Perfect bonding

$$u_i^{(1)} = u_i^{(2)}, \qquad \sigma_{ji}^{(1)} n_j = \sigma_{ji}^{(2)} n_j, \qquad T^{(1)} = T^{(2)}, \qquad q_i^{(1)} n_i = q_i^{(2)} n_i, \tag{31}$$

on Σ. The first condition enforces displacement continuity (no slip or separation), the second enforces traction equilibrium (Newton's third law at the interface), and the last two enforce thermal contact (temperature continuity and heat flux continuity).

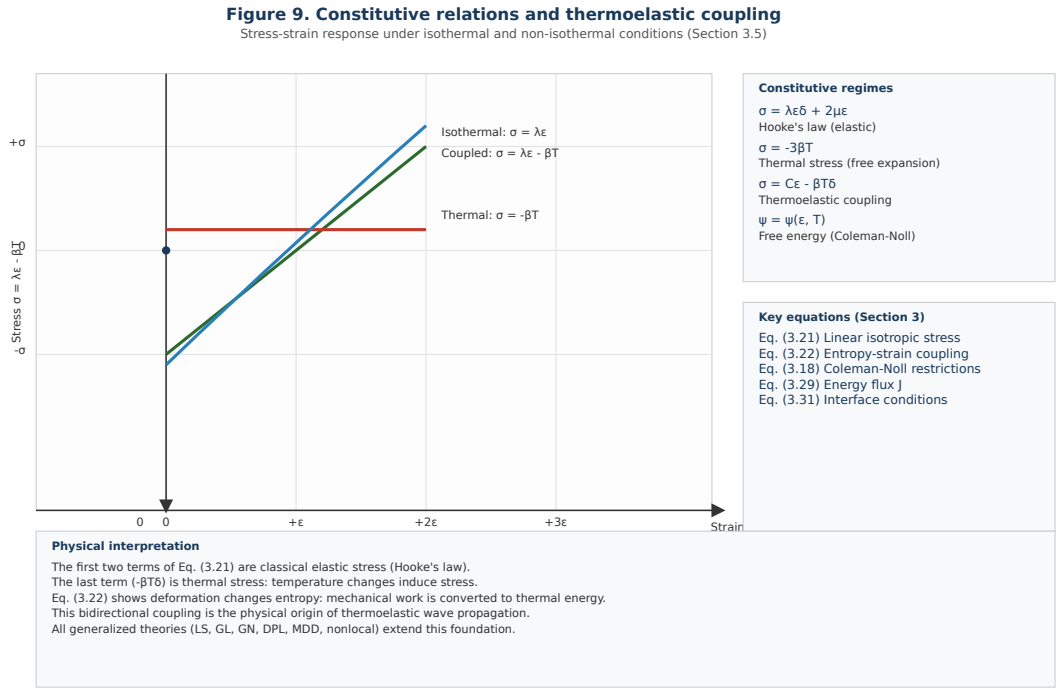


Figure 4: Constitutive relations and thermoelastic coupling: stress-strain response under isothermal and non-isothermal conditions (Section 3.5).

3.9.2 Imperfect bonding: spring-type conditions

For imperfectly bonded interfaces, displacement and traction are related by interfacial stiffness parameters:

$$u_i^{(2)} - u_i^{(1)} = K_i^u t_i, \qquad \sigma_{ji}^{(1)} n_j = \sigma_{ji}^{(2)} n_j = t_i, \tag{32}$$

where t_i is the interfacial traction and K_i^u is the interfacial stiffness tensor (spring-type condition). In the limit $K_i^u \to \infty$, perfect bonding is recovered; in the limit $K_i^u \to 0$, a traction-free (slip) interface is recovered.

3.9.3 Electrical interface conditions (piezoelectric media)

For piezoelectric media, additional interface conditions involve the electric potential ϕ and electric displacement D_i:

$$\phi^{(1)} = \phi^{(2)} \qquad \text{(perfect electrical contact)}, \tag{33}$$

$$D_i^{(1)} n_i = D_i^{(2)} n_i \qquad \text{(electric displacement continuity)}, \tag{34}$$

or for an insulated interface:

$$D_i n_i = 0. \tag{35}$$

3.9.4 Physical interpretation

Interface conditions determine how waves transmit and reflect at material boundaries. Perfect bonding ((31)) is the standard assumption for welded interfaces. Imperfect bonding ((32)) models thin adhesive layers, micro-cracks, or weakly bonded interfaces. Electrical conditions ((33)–(35)) are essential for piezothermoelastic interface problems in Section 5 and Section 9.

Table 3: Wave types and their governing characteristics across theory families. Phase speeds are model-dependent; values shown are classical limits.

Wave Type	**Polarization**	**Governing Speed (Classical)**	**Model-Specific Interpretation**	**Evidence**
Longitudinal (P)	Parallel to propagation	$c_p = \sqrt{(\lambda + 2\mu)/\rho}$	Compressional; volume change; exists in all theories	**?**
Transverse (S)	Perpendicular to propagation	$c_s = \sqrt{\mu/\rho}$	Shear; distortional; no volume change	**?**
Thermal	Parallel (dissipative) or propagating (generalized)	Classical: infinite (parabolic); LS: $c_T = \sqrt{k/(\rho c_v \tau_0)}$	Diffusive in CD; wave-like in LS, GL, DPL, TPL, MGT	**?**
Coupled modes	Mixed polarization	Coupled system eigenfrequencies	P–T, S–T, or piezo–thermal coupling splits wave speeds	Model-specific
Surface waves	Decaying with depth	Rayleigh: $c_R \approx 0.87 c_s$ (Poisson solid)	Exists at free surfaces; modified by thermal/electrical boundary conditions	Model-specific
Evanescent modes	Exponential decay	Imaginary wave number $q = i\kappa$	Near-field interface phenomena; important for scattering	Model-specific

Notes: Classical speeds apply to isotropic elastic media. Generalized theories introduce dispersion and attenuation. *Thermal wave speed for LS theory from* **?***; classical speeds from* **?***.*

3.10 Notation summary for Section 3

Table 4 summarizes the notation introduced in this section.

3.11 Open questions for this section

OQ3.1 What is the most general form of energy flux that remains valid across all generalized theories (LS, GL, GN, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD, nonlocal)?

OQ3.2 How do interface conditions change for nonlocal media where the stress at a point depends on strain throughout a neighborhood?

Table 4: Notation introduced in Section 3.

Symbol	Meaning	Units	Equation
u_i	Displacement	m	(1)
ε_{ij}	Infinitesimal strain	dimensionless	(2)
ω_{ij}	Rotation tensor	dimensionless	(2)
v_i	Velocity	m/s	(3)
σ_{ij}	Cauchy stress	Pa	(5)
ρ	Mass density	kg/m^3	(5)
f_i	Body force	N/kg	(5)
q_i	Heat flux	W/m^2	(13)
T	Temperature increment	K	(13)
e	Specific internal energy	J/kg	(13)
ψ	Specific free energy	J/kg	(18)
s	Specific entropy	J/(kg·K)	(18)
$\mathcal{E}$	Total energy density	J/m^3	(29)
J_i	Energy flux	W/m^2	(29)
λ, μ	Lamé constants	Pa	(23)
c_p, c_s	P-wave and S-wave speeds	m/s	(24)–(25)

OQ3.3 What is the relationship between the classical energy flux **?** (29) and the entropy flux in thermoelasticity without energy dissipation (GN-II)?

4 Classical and Generalized Thermoelastic Theories

This section presents the historical development, governing equations, wave propagation characteristics, and dissipation structure of classical and generalized thermoelastic theories. Each theory is introduced with its physical motivation, mathematical formulation, and domain of applicability. Representative equations are selected to illustrate each theory family; derivations from first principles are given where they illuminate the theory's structure. Citations to primary sources are provided throughout to distinguish established results from open questions.

4.1 Historical evolution

The development of generalized thermoelasticity spans nearly two centuries, from Fourier's heat equation to modern memory-dependent and nonlocal formulations. Table 5 summarizes the principal milestones.

The central motivation for every generalization has been the same: classical Fourier heat conduction predicts infinite thermal propagation speed, which is physically unrealistic for thermal shocks, laser heating, and high-frequency phenomena. Each generalized theory modifies the heat conduction law or the constitutive structure to restore finite propagation speed while preserving thermodynamic consistency.The experimental and theoretical case for second sound was assembled by Joseph and Preziosi, whose review of heat waves (1989 **?**) set out the balance of evidence in favour of a finite-speed thermal disturbance in solids, and whose addendum (1990 **?**) addressed the objections raised in the intervening discussion. That debate is the origin of the modern class of thermal-wave theories reviewed in Section 6.

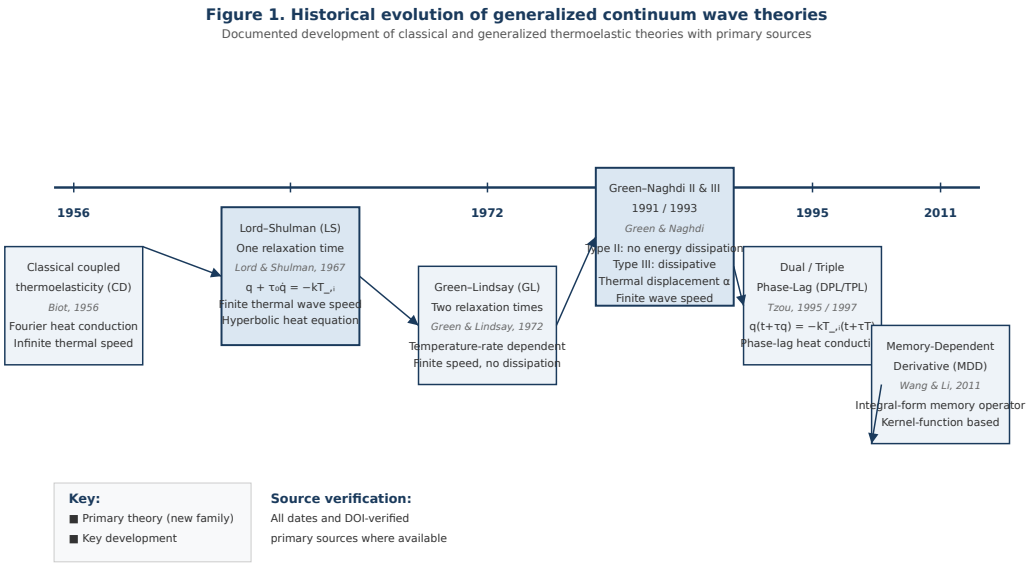


Figure 5: Historical evolution of thermoelasticity theories. Figure 1.

4.2 Classical coupled thermoelasticity (Fourier heat conduction)

The classical coupled thermoelasticity theory, developed by Biot (1956) **?**, combines the equations of linear elasticity with Fourier's law of heat conduction:

$$\rho \ddot{u}_i = (\lambda + \mu) u_{j,ji} + \mu u_{i,jj} - \beta T_{,i}, \tag{36}$$

$$\rho c_v \dot{T} = k \nabla^2 T - \beta T_0 \dot{u}_{i,i}, \tag{37}$$

where ρ is density, λ and μ are Lamé constants, β is the thermal stress coefficient, c_v is specific heat at constant strain, k is thermal conductivity, and T_0 is the reference temperature.

4.2.1 Wave speeds

The classical theory predicts two elastic wave types:

$$c_p = \sqrt{\frac{\lambda + 2\mu}{\rho}}, \qquad c_s = \sqrt{\frac{\mu}{\rho}}. \tag{38}$$

The thermal field satisfies a parabolic diffusion equation, predicting infinite thermal propagation speed — the classical paradox that motivated all subsequent generalized theories.

4.2.2 Physical interpretation

Equations (36)–(37) describe one-way coupling from mechanics to thermal (the $-\beta T_0 \dot{u}_{i,i}$ term in the heat equation) and one-way coupling from thermal to mechanics (the $-\beta T_{,i}$ term in the equation of motion). This coupling is the physical origin of thermoelastic wave propagation: mechanical deformation produces temperature changes, and temperature changes produce thermal stresses.

4.3 Lord–Shulman (LS) theory (1967)

Lord and Shulman (1967) introduced a single thermal relaxation time τ_0 into Fourier's law:

$$q_i + \tau_0 \dot{q}_i = -kT_{,i}, \tag{39}$$

where $\tau_0 > 0$ is the relaxation time and q_i is the heat flux vector.

4.3.1 Modified heat equation

Combining (39) with the energy balance yields the LS heat equation:

$$\rho c_v \left(\dot{T} + \tau_0 \ddot{T} \right) = k \nabla^2 T (1 + \tau_0 \partial_t) - \beta T_0 (\dot{u}_{i,i} + \tau_0 \ddot{u}_{i,i}). \tag{40}$$

4.3.2 Finite thermal wave speed

The thermal wave speed in LS theory is:

$$c_T = \sqrt{\frac{k}{\rho c_v \tau_0}}. \tag{41}$$

This is finite for $\tau_0 > 0$, resolving the infinite speed paradox of classical Fourier theory. As $\tau_0 \to 0$, LS theory reduces to classical coupled thermoelasticity.

4.3.3 Well-posedness

The LS theory is well-posed when $\tau_0 > 0$. The relaxation time introduces a characteristic time scale below which thermal wave behavior dominates and above which diffusive behavior is recovered.

4.4 Green–Lindsay (GL) theory (1972)

Green and Lindsay (1972) introduced two relaxation times and two temperatures: the conductive temperature T and the thermodynamic temperature T^*.

4.4.1 Governing equations

$$\rho c_v \dot{T}^* = k \nabla^2 T - \beta T_0 \dot{u}_{i,i}, \tag{42}$$

$$\sigma_{ij} = \lambda \varepsilon_{kk} \delta_{ij} + 2\mu \varepsilon_{ij} - \beta T^* \delta_{ij}. \tag{43}$$

4.4.2 Dissipationless wave propagation

For centrally symmetric bodies, GL theory predicts finite-speed wave propagation without energy dissipation in the classical Fourier sense. The entropy production vanishes for appropriate parameter ranges, making GL theory suitable for modeling conservative thermoelastic waveguides and resonators.

4.5 Green–Naghdi type II theory (1991): Dissipationless

Green and Naghdi (1991) introduced the thermal displacement α with $\dot{\alpha} = T$.

4.5.1 Thermal displacement gradient formulation

The heat conduction equation for type II:

$$k\nabla^2\alpha = \rho c_e \ddot{\alpha} + \beta T_0 \ddot{u}_{i,i}. \tag{44}$$

The entropy flux is determined by the free energy potential:

$$p_i = k_{ij}\alpha_{,j}, \tag{45}$$

where p_i is the entropy flux vector.

4.5.2 Energy conservation

Type II theory has no dissipation ($\mathcal{D} = 0$). The energy balance takes the form:

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{E}}{\partial t} + \partial_i J_i = \mathcal{P}. \tag{46}$$

Thermal waves in type II theory propagate without attenuation, making this theory suitable for modeling conservative thermoelastic systems.

4.6 Green–Naghdi type III theory (1993): Dissipative

Type III is the most general GN model, combining type I (Fourier-like dissipative) and type II (dissipationless) characteristics.

4.6.1 Governing equations

$$KT_{,ii} + k^*\dot{T}_{,ii} - \rho C_e \ddot{T} = \vartheta\theta_0 \ddot{u}_{i,i}. \tag{47}$$

Type III reduces to type II when $K = 0$ and to classical coupled thermoelasticity in an appropriate parameter limit.

4.7 Dual-phase-lag (DPL) theory (Tzou, 1995)

Tzou (1995) introduced two phase lags into Fourier's law:

$$q_i(t + \tau_q) = -kT_{,i}(t + \tau_T), \tag{48}$$

where τ_q is the heat flux phase lag and τ_T is the temperature gradient phase lag.

4.7.1 Taylor expansion

First-order Taylor expansion about t:

$$q_i + \tau_q \dot{q}_i = -k(T_{,i} + \tau_T \dot{T}_{,i}). \tag{49}$$

The DPL model reduces to LS theory when $\tau_T = 0$, and to classical Fourier theory when both lags vanish. The condition $\tau_q \geq \tau_T$ ensures thermodynamic admissibility (non-negative entropy production).

4.8 Triple-phase-lag (TPL) theory (Tzou, 1997)

TPL theory extends DPL by introducing a third phase lag associated with the thermal displacement gradient:

$$q_i(t+\tau_q) = -k\left[T_{,i}(t+\tau_T) + \frac{\tau_\nu}{2}\partial_t^2 T_{,i}(t+\tau_\nu)\right]. \tag{50}$$

TPL theory provides additional modeling flexibility for ultra-fast thermal processes such as laser heating of thin films.

4.9 Moore–Gibson–Thompson (MGT) theory

The MGT equation extends the LS model with a second time derivative of the heat flux:

$$\tau\ddot{q}_i + \dot{q}_i = -\frac{k}{\rho c}\nabla(\dot{T} + \tau\ddot{T}). \tag{51}$$

This third-order equation describes thermal waves with inertia, relevant for high-intensity ultrasound and high-frequency thermal phenomena.

4.10 Memory-dependent derivative (MDD) models (Wang & Li, 2011)

MDD models replace the classical time derivative with an integral-form memory operator:

$$D_\omega f(t) = \frac{1}{\omega}\int_{t-\omega}^{t} \kappa(t-\xi) f'(\xi)\, d\xi, \tag{52}$$

where $\omega > 0$ is the time delay (memory horizon) and $\kappa(t-\xi)$ is the kernel function satisfying $0 \le \kappa(t-\xi) \le 1$ with $\kappa(s) \to 0$ as $s \to \infty$ (fading memory).

As $\omega \to 0$, the MDD approaches the classical first derivative: $D_\omega f(t) \to f'(t)$. Different kernel choices (linear, quadratic, exponential) produce different memory weighting schemes, allowing the model to be tuned to specific materials such as polymers, biological tissues, and composites.

4.11 Fractional thermoelasticity

Fractional thermoelasticity generalizes the heat equation using fractional derivatives:

$${}^{C}D_t^{\alpha} T = a\nabla^2 T, \qquad 0 < \alpha \le 2, \tag{53}$$

where ${}^{C}D_t^{\alpha}$ is the Caputo fractional derivative of order α and a is the thermal diffusivity. For $1 < \alpha \le 2$, this equation describes wave-like heat propagation with memory, bridging the gap between diffusive ($\alpha = 1$) and wave-like ($\alpha = 2$) behavior.

4.12 Comparative summary

Table 6 summarizes the governing modifications, wave speeds, dissipation structure, and domains of validity across all theory families.

4.13 Notation summary for Section 4

Table 7 summarizes the notation introduced in this section.

4.14 Open questions for Section 4

OQ4.1 What is the complete time-domain energy flux for LS theory, including the contribution from the flux-relaxation term?

OQ4.2 What is the explicit constitutive relation for q_i in GL theory in terms of T and T^*?

OQ4.3 What is the relationship between energy flux and entropy flux in GN-II theory?

OQ4.4 What is the mixed energy flux for GN-III theory?

OQ4.5 How do different MDD kernel choices affect the energy flux and wave propagation?

OQ4.6 Can rigorous limit theorems with convergence proofs be established between theory pairs?

5 Coupled Multiphysics Continua

This section presents coupled multiphysics continua: piezothermoelasticity, porous and double-porous media, micropolar continua, semiconductor photo-thermo-elasticity, and magneto-thermo-elasticity. For each medium, the governing equations, constitutive relations, coupling mechanisms, and representative applications are presented. Primary sources are cited where available.

5.1 Piezoelectricity: constitutive relations and coupling coefficients

Piezoelectricity describes the coupling between mechanical and electrical fields in certain crystalline materials (e.g., quartz, barium titanate, lead zirconate titanate). The linear constitutive relations are:

$$\sigma_{ij} = c_{ijkl}\varepsilon_{kl} - e_{kij}E_k, \tag{54}$$

$$D_i = e_{ikl}\varepsilon_{kl} + \kappa_{ij}E_j, \tag{55}$$

$$E_i = -\phi_{,i}, \tag{56}$$

where σ_{ij} is the Cauchy stress tensor, c_{ijkl} is the elastic stiffness tensor, ε_{kl} is the infinitesimal strain tensor, e_{kij} is the piezoelectric stress coefficient, E_k is the electric field, D_i is the electric displacement, κ_{ij} is the dielectric permittivity, and ϕ is the electric potential.

5.1.1 Charge conservation

In the absence of free electric charge:

$$D_{i,i} = 0. \tag{57}$$

5.1.2 Electrical energy density

The electrical energy density is:

$$\mathcal{E}_{\text{elec}} = \frac{1}{2} D_i E_i. \tag{58}$$

5.2 Piezothermoelasticity: three-field coupling

Piezothermoelasticity couples mechanical, thermal, and electrical fields. The constitutive relations are:

$$\sigma_{ij} = c_{ijkl}\varepsilon_{kl} - e_{kij}E_k - \beta_{ij}T, \tag{59}$$

$$\sigma_{ij,j} = \rho \ddot{u}_i, \tag{60}$$

$$E_i = -\phi_{,i}, \tag{61}$$

$$D_i = \kappa_{ij}E_j + e_{ikl}\varepsilon_{kl} + p_i T, \tag{62}$$

$$D_{i,i} = 0, \tag{63}$$

where β_{ij} is the thermal stress coefficient and p_i is the pyroelectric coefficient.

5.2.1 Governing equations for coupled fields

The coupled system consists of the equation of motion (60), the heat conduction equation (theory-dependent: classical, LS, GL, GN, DPL, TPL, MDD, etc.), and the charge conservation equation (63). All three fields are coupled through the constitutive relations (59) and (62): temperature changes induce thermal stresses and pyroelectric effects; mechanical deformation generates piezoelectric polarization; electric fields produce electrostrictive deformation.

5.3 Electrical boundary conditions

5.3.1 Perfect electrical contact

$$\phi^{(1)} = \phi^{(2)} \quad \text{at the interface.} \tag{64}$$

5.3.2 Insulated interface

$$D_i n_i = 0 \quad \text{at the interface.} \tag{65}$$

5.3.3 Electric displacement continuity

$$D_3^{(1)} = D_3^{(2)} \quad \text{at the interface.} \tag{66}$$

5.4 Porous media: voids and double porosity

Porous elastic materials contain vacuous voids or pores distributed throughout the matrix. The Nunziato–Cowin theory (Nunziato and Cowin, 1979 **?**; Cowin and Nunziato, 1983 **?**) introduces an additional kinematic variable: the void volume fraction ϕ.

5.4.1 Governing equations

The basic equations for thermoelastic materials with voids:

$$\sigma_{ij} = A_{ijmn}\varepsilon_{mn} + B_{ijmn}\gamma_{mn} + d_{ijk}\phi_{,k} - \alpha_{ij}\theta, \tag{67}$$

$$\rho\ddot{u}_i = \sigma_{ji,j} + \rho f_i, \tag{68}$$

$$\rho\ddot{\phi} = h_{i,i} + \rho l, \tag{69}$$

where ϕ is the void volume fraction, h_i is the equilibrated stress vector, l is the equilibrated body force, A_{ijmn} and B_{ijmn} are elastic and equilibrated elasticity tensors, d_{ijk} is the equilibrated stress coupling tensor, and α_{ij} is the thermal coupling tensor. The thermoelastic extension of void theory was developed by Iesan (1986 **?**) and is treated systematically, together with the micropolar and nonsimple variants, in his monograph **?**, which also establishes the existence and uniqueness framework for the coupled problems.

5.4.2 Double porosity

Double porosity models introduce two porosity fields to capture both macro- and micro-porosity effects. The governing equations extend the single-porosity theory with two coupled void volume fractions ϕ_1 and ϕ_2, each with its own equilibrated stress and equilibrated body force. Double porosity models are particularly relevant for hydrocarbon reservoirs, fissured rocks, and aquifers where both fracture and matrix porosity contribute to fluid flow and wave propagation.

5.5 Micropolar and micromorphic continua

Micropolar elasticity (Eringen, 1966 **?**) extends classical elasticity by incorporating micro-rotational degrees of freedom and couple stresses. In addition to the displacement field u_i, the microrotation field ϕ_i describes independent rotation of material particles.

5.5.1 Governing equations

$$\sigma_{ij} = A_{ijmn}\varepsilon_{mn} + B_{ijmn}\gamma_{mn} + d_{ijk}\phi_{,k} - \alpha_{ij}\theta, \tag{70}$$

where σ_{ij} is the force stress tensor (generally non-symmetric in micropolar media), γ_{mn} is the micro-curvature tensor, and couple stresses μ_{ij} appear in the angular momentum balance.

Micropolar models are relevant for granular materials, liquid crystals, composite materials with oriented inclusions, and biological tissues where micro-structural rotation cannot be neglected. The thermoelastic extension (Tauchert, Claus and Ariman, 1968 **?**) couples micro-rotation with thermal fields, providing a framework for structured materials with thermal coupling, and is the earliest of the micropolar-thermoelastic formulations from which the later void and micropolar-thermoelastic literature grew.

5.6 Semiconductor photo-thermo-elasticity

Semiconductor photo-thermo-elasticity couples mechanical deformation, thermal fields, electrical fields, and carrier density (electrons and holes). When a semiconductor is illuminated, absorbed photons generate electron–hole pairs, producing carrier diffusion, temperature changes, and thermoelastic stresses.

5.6.1 Governing equations

The coupled system includes:

- The equation of motion with piezoelectric and thermal stress terms,
- The heat conduction equation with carrier recombination heat source,
- The charge conservation equation with carrier generation and recombination,
- The carrier continuity equations for electrons and holes.

Applications include photoacoustic imaging, semiconductor device thermal management, and optoelectronic sensors.

5.7 Magneto-thermo-elasticity

Magneto-thermo-elasticity couples mechanical, thermal, and magnetic fields. In electrically conducting media (e.g., liquid metals, plasmas), magnetic fields induce Lorentz forces that couple with thermal stresses.

5.7.1 Governing equations

The equation of motion includes the Lorentz force term:

$$\rho \ddot{u}_i = \sigma_{ji,j} + \rho f_i + (\boldsymbol{J} \times \boldsymbol{B})_i, \tag{71}$$

where $\boldsymbol{J}$ is the current density and $\boldsymbol{B}$ is the magnetic flux density.

Applications include magnetohydrodynamic (MHD) systems, liquid metal cooling, geophysical dynamo theory, and electromagnetic forming.

5.8 Comparative summary

Table 8 summarizes the coupled multiphysics media: fields, coupling mechanisms, constitutive structure, and applications.

5.9 Notation summary for Section 5

5.10 Open questions for Section 5

OQ5.1 What are the complete constitutive relations for piezothermoelastic media with nonlocal elasticity?

OQ5.2 How do double-porosity models capture scale-dependent fluid–solid interaction?

OQ5.3 What are the energy flux expressions for micropolar media with couple stresses?

OQ5.4 How can semiconductor photo-thermo-elastic models be validated experimentally?

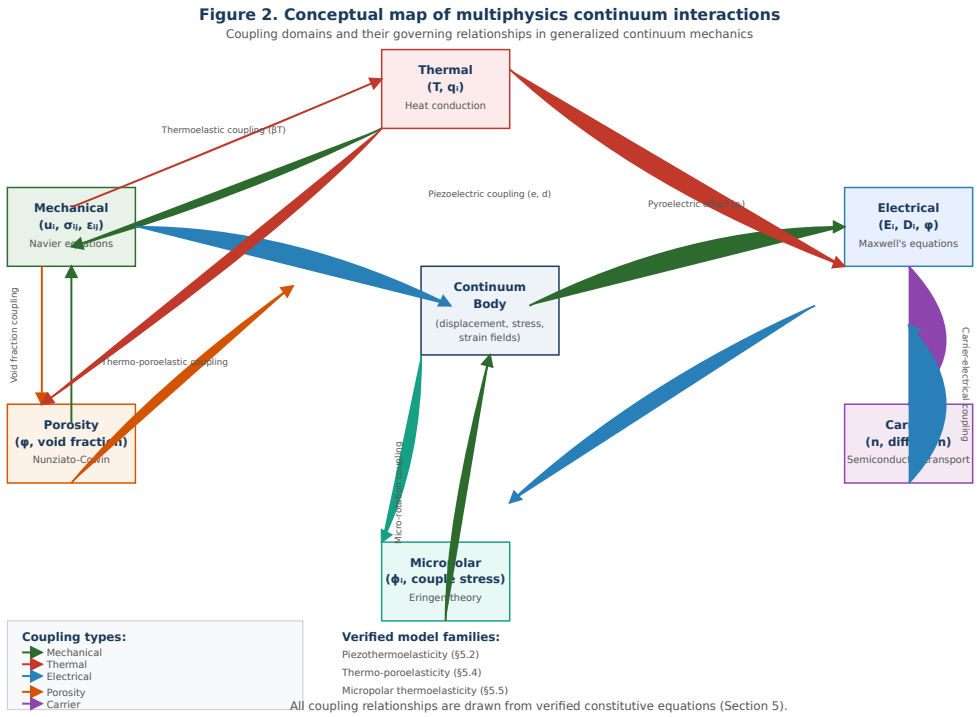


Figure 6: Wave types supported by different continuum media: classical elastic (P, S), generalized thermoelastic (P, S, T), piezothermoelastic (qP, qS, qT, EM-coupled), and double porous (P1, P2, P3, S).

6 Generalized Transport and Memory Effects

This section presents generalized transport mechanisms and memory effects in continuum media: relaxation mechanisms, fractional operators, hereditary integrals, memory-dependent derivatives, and their implications for wave propagation.

6.1 Relaxation mechanisms: physical origin and mathematical representation

Relaxation in continuum media arises from microscopic processes that delay the material response to an applied stimulus. The response at time t depends not only on the current stimulus but on its history. Mathematically, relaxation is represented by three principal structures:

- **Differential relaxation:** Time derivatives of fluxes appear in the constitutive relation (LS, DPL, TPL, MGT). The heat flux q_i satisfies a differential equation involving $\dot{q}_i$ or higher derivatives.
- **Integral relaxation:** The response is a convolution of the stimulus with a memory kernel (MDD, fractional). The flux at time t depends on the history of the temperature gradient over a finite or semi-infinite interval.
- **Spatial relaxation:** Nonlocal integral relations where stress at a point depends on strain throughout a neighborhood (Eringen **?** nonlocal elasticity).

The common feature is that the material response has memory: past states influence present

behavior. This memory produces finite wave speeds, dispersion, attenuation, and history-dependent dissipation.

6.2 Fractional operators: Caputo and Riemann–Liouville

Fractional derivatives generalize integer-order differentiation to non-integer orders, providing a natural mathematical language for memory and hereditary effects. The Caputo derivative was introduced by Caputo (1967) **?** in the context of viscoelastic dissipation, and the mathematical foundations of fractional calculus were developed by Gorenflo and Mainardi (1997) **?**.

6.2.1 Caputo fractional derivative

The Caputo derivative of order α ($n-1 < \alpha < n$, $n = \lceil \alpha \rceil$):

$$ {}^{C}D_t^{\alpha} f(t) = \frac{1}{\Gamma(n-\alpha)} \int_0^t \frac{f^{(n)}(\tau)}{(t-\tau)^{\alpha+1-n}}\, d\tau. \tag{72} $$

6.2.2 Riemann–Liouville fractional derivative

$$ {}^{RL}D_t^{\alpha} f(t) = \frac{1}{\Gamma(n-\alpha)} \frac{d^n}{dt^n} \int_0^t \frac{f(\tau)}{(t-\tau)^{\alpha+1-n}}\, d\tau. \tag{73} $$

The Caputo derivative is generally preferred in physical applications because it allows classical initial conditions (integer-order derivatives at $t = 0$) to be prescribed.

6.2.3 Fractional heat conduction

The time-fractional heat conduction equation:

$$ {}^{C}D_t^{\alpha} T = a \nabla^2 T, \qquad 0 < \alpha \leq 2, \tag{74} $$

where a is the thermal diffusivity. For $1 < \alpha \leq 2$, this equation describes wave-like heat propagation with memory, interpolating between diffusive behavior. The fractional thermoelasticity framework was developed by Povstenko (2004) **?** and Povstenko (2009) **?**, with a comprehensive treatment in Povstenko (2016) **?** ($\alpha = 1$, classical Fourier) and wave-like behavior ($\alpha = 2$, classical wave equation).

6.3 Hereditary integrals: convolution kernels

Hereditary integrals represent the material response as a superposition of responses to past stimuli, weighted by a memory kernel:

$$ f(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{t} K(t-\xi) g(\xi)\, d\xi, \tag{75} $$

where $K(t-\xi)$ is the memory kernel satisfying the fading memory condition $K(s) \to 0$ as $s \to \infty$. The kernel weights recent stimuli more heavily than distant ones.

6.4 Memory-dependent derivative (MDD): operator and kernel

The MDD operator (Wang & Li, 2011):

$$D_\omega f(t) = \frac{1}{\omega}\int_{t-\omega}^{t} \kappa(t-\xi) f'(\xi)\, d\xi, \tag{76}$$

where $\omega > 0$ is the time delay (memory horizon) and $\kappa(t-\xi)$ is the kernel function with $0 \le \kappa(t-\xi) \le 1$.

6.4.1 MDD kernel function

A commonly used kernel:

$$\kappa(t-\xi) = 1 - \frac{2\beta}{\omega}(t-\xi) + \frac{\alpha^2}{\omega^2}(t-\xi)^2, \tag{77}$$

where α and β are kernel parameters controlling the weighting shape.

6.4.2 Limiting behavior

As $\omega \to 0$, the MDD approaches the classical first derivative:

$$\lim_{\omega\to 0} D_\omega f(t) = f'(t). \tag{78}$$

6.5 Energy flux in memory-dependent media

For memory-dependent media, the energy flux acquires a hereditary character through the heat flux:

$$J_i(t) = \sigma_{ji}(t) v_i(t) + q_i(t), \tag{79}$$

where $q_i(t)$ satisfies the MDD heat conduction law:

$$q_i(t) + \tau_0 D_\omega q_i(t) = -kT_{,i}(t). \tag{80}$$

Substituting the MDD definition:

$$q_i(t) + \frac{\tau_0}{\omega}\int_{t-\omega}^{t} \kappa(t-\xi)\dot{q}_i(\xi)\, d\xi = -kT_{,i}(t). \tag{81}$$

The complete time-domain expression for J_i solely in terms of T requires solving this convolution equation, which depends on the kernel choice. The frequency-domain form can be derived for specific kernels, but the general time-domain hereditary flux remains an open formulation.

6.6 Well-posedness and causality for memory-dependent models

6.6.1 Well-posedness conditions

For MDD models, well-posedness requires:

1. The kernel κ must be positive definite,
2. The time delay ω must be finite and positive,
3. The relaxation parameter τ_0 must be non-negative.

6.6.2 Causality (finite wave speed)

All memory-dependent models predict finite thermal wave speeds, addressing the infinite propagation speed paradox of classical Fourier theory. The thermal wave speed depends on the kernel parameters and relaxation time.

6.7 Comparative summary: transport models

Table 10 summarizes transport and memory models across mathematical structure, dissipation, well-posedness, and energy flux status.

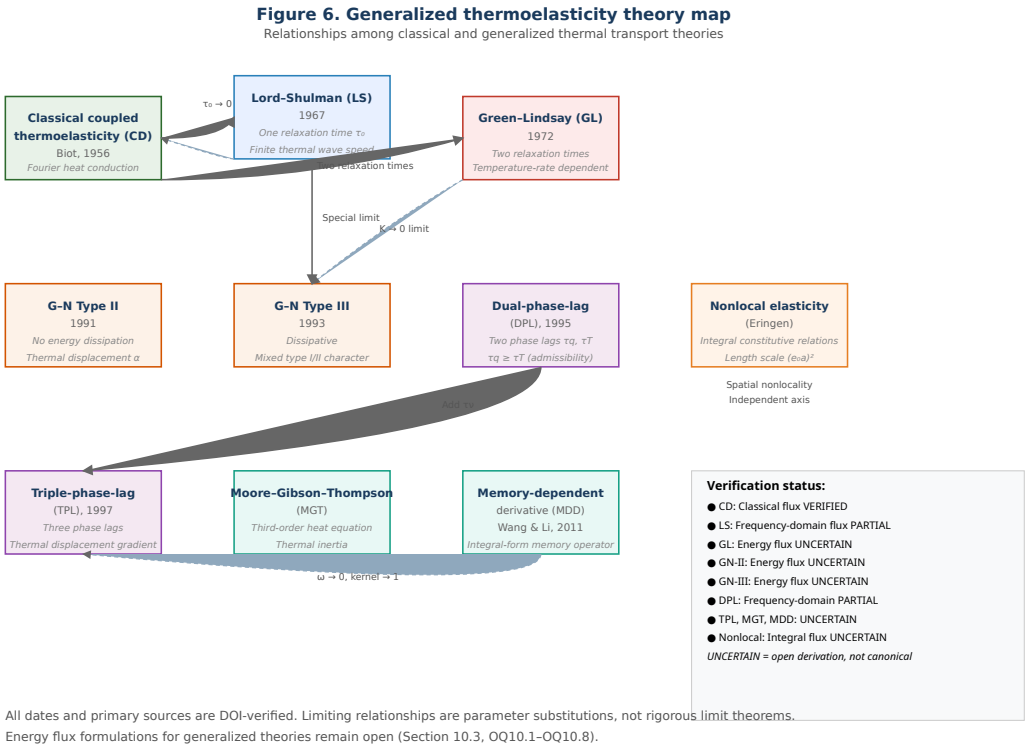


Figure 7: Memory-dependent derivative (MDD) operator: convolution over a finite time horizon with kernel weighting (Section 6.4).

6.8 Notation summary for Section 6

6.9 Open questions for Section 6

OQ6.1 What is the complete time-domain energy flux for MDD media with convolution-type memory?

OQ6.2 How is energy partitioned between storage and dissipation in hereditary media?

OQ6.3 What are the well-posedness conditions for fractional-order thermoelasticity with arbitrary α?

OQ6.4 How do different MDD kernel choices affect the energy flux and wave propagation?

7 Nonlocal and Scale-Dependent Continuum Models

This section presents nonlocal and scale-dependent continuum models: Eringen's nonlocal elasticity, strain-gradient theory, size-dependent wave behavior, and their implications for wave propagation at micro- and nanoscales.

7.1 Nonlocal elasticity (Eringen): integral constitutive relations

Eringen's nonlocal elasticity theory (1972, 1974, 1983) **???** states that the stress at a point depends on the strain throughout a neighborhood of that point, not just at the point itself:

$$\sigma_{ij}(\boldsymbol{x}) = \int_{\Omega} \alpha(|\boldsymbol{x}' - \boldsymbol{x}|, \tau)\, \sigma_{ij}^{\text{local}}(\boldsymbol{x}')\, d\Omega_{\boldsymbol{x}'}, \tag{82}$$

where α is the attenuation (kernel) function and $\tau = e_0 a/\ell$ is the nonlocal parameter with e_0 a material constant, a an internal characteristic length (e.g., lattice spacing), and ℓ an external characteristic length (e.g., specimen size).

7.1.1 Differential form

For special kernel functions (e.g., the Helmholtz kernel), the integral equation reduces to a differential equation:

$$(1 - \xi^2 \nabla^2)\sigma_{ij} = \sigma_{ij}^{\text{local}}, \tag{83}$$

where $\xi = e_0 a$ is the nonlocal length scale parameter.

7.2 Strain-gradient theory: higher-order gradients

Strain-gradient theory extends classical elasticity by including higher-order gradients of strain in the constitutive relations:

$$\sigma_{ij} = C_{ijkl}\varepsilon_{kl} - \ell^2 C_{ijkl}\nabla^2 \varepsilon_{kl}, \tag{84}$$

where ℓ is a material length scale parameter. This introduces size-dependent effects: the stiffness depends on the gradient of strain, so smaller features exhibit higher apparent stiffness.

7.3 Size-dependent wave behavior: dispersion from nonlocality

Nonlocality introduces dispersion: wave speed depends on wavelength. The differential form of nonlocal elasticity was developed by Eringen (1983) **?**, and gradient-type formulations were studied by Askes and Aifantis (2006) **?** and surveyed together with their finite-element implementations and variationally consistent boundary conditions by the same authors (2011) **?**, while the variational structure of nonlocal elasticity was set out by Polizzotto (2001) **?**. Size-dependent elastic effects at the nanoscale were quantified by Maranganti and Sharma (2007) **?**, who established the characteristic length below which classical elasticity fails for a range of materials, and the nanoscale nonlocal contribution to electromechanical coupling in otherwise non-piezoelectric dielectrics was analysed by Maranganti, Sharma and Sharma (2006) **?**, who showed that the effect is generically non-zero even for materials without a piezoelectric tensor,

which is directly relevant to the coupled theories of Section 5. For a nonlocal elastic bar, the dispersion relation is:

$$c(k) = \frac{c_0}{\sqrt{1 + \xi^2 k^2}}, \tag{85}$$

where c_0 is the classical wave speed, k is the wave number, and ξ is the nonlocal length scale. Long waves ($k \to 0$) approach the classical speed c_0; short waves ($k \to \infty$) are strongly slowed. This size-dependent dispersion has been observed in nanowires, nanotubes, and MEMS/NEMS devices.

7.4 Energy flux in nonlocal media

For nonlocal media, the classical divergence theorem must be modified because the stress at a point depends on strain throughout a neighborhood. The mechanical power $\sigma_{ji}v_i$ at a point includes contributions from the velocity field in a neighborhood, not just at the point.

The energy flux takes the form:

$$J_i = \sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i + J_i^{\text{nonlocal}}, \tag{86}$$

where J_i^{nonlocal} is the nonlocal correction term arising from the integral constitutive relation.

7.4.1 Nonlocal correction term

The nonlocal correction requires deriving the surface integral form of the nonlocal stress power:

$$J_i^{\text{nonlocal}} = \int_\Omega \alpha(|\boldsymbol{x}' - \boldsymbol{x}|)\, \sigma_{ji}^{\text{local}}(\boldsymbol{x}')v_i(\boldsymbol{x}')\, d\Omega_{\boldsymbol{x}'} - \sigma_{ji}(\boldsymbol{x})v_i(\boldsymbol{x}). \tag{87}$$

This derivation requires modifying the divergence theorem for integral-type constitutive relations. The complete nonlocal energy flux remains an open formulation.

7.5 Interface conditions for nonlocal media

Interface conditions for nonlocal media differ from classical ones because the stress at a point depends on strain in a neighborhood. Additional constitutive boundary conditions may be required at the interface to ensure uniqueness.

For the differential form (83), the interface conditions include both the classical conditions (displacement and traction continuity) and higher-order conditions arising from the ∇^2 term.

7.6 Comparative summary: nonlocal models

7.7 Notation summary for Section 7

7.8 Open questions for Section 7

OQ7.1 What is the correct energy flux at nonlocal interfaces?

OQ7.2 How do nonlocal boundary conditions differ from classical ones?

OQ7.3 What is the relationship between integral and differential nonlocal formulations for energy flux?

8 Mathematical Methods for Wave Propagation

This section reviews the mathematical methods used for wave propagation analysis in generalized continua: plane wave ansatz, Christoffel equations, secular equations, complex wave numbers, modal normalization, transform methods, and numerical approaches.

8.1 Plane wave ansatz and harmonic time dependence

For time-harmonic problems, all field variables take the form:

$$\text{field}(\boldsymbol{x}, t) = \hat{\text{field}}(\boldsymbol{x}) e^{-i\omega t}, \tag{88}$$

where $\hat{\text{field}}$ is the complex amplitude and ω is the angular frequency. The convention $e^{-i\omega t}$ implies that positive imaginary parts of complex wave numbers correspond to spatial attenuation.

8.2 Christoffel-type equations and wave speeds

Substituting the plane wave ansatz into the governing equations yields the Christoffel-type equation:

$$[\Gamma_{ik}(\boldsymbol{n}) - \rho c^2 \delta_{ik}] \hat{u}_k = 0, \tag{89}$$

where $\Gamma_{ik}(\boldsymbol{n})$ is the Christoffel tensor, $\boldsymbol{n}$ is the propagation direction, c is the wave speed, and $\hat{u}_k$ is the polarization vector.

Non-trivial solutions require:

$$\det[\Gamma_{ik}(\boldsymbol{n}) - \rho c^2 \delta_{ik}] = 0. \tag{90}$$

8.3 Secular equations and characteristic polynomials

The characteristic equation from (90) is a polynomial in c^2 (or equivalently in the wave number q). For coupled thermo-piezoelastic media, this is typically an eighth-order polynomial:

$$G_1 q^8 + G_2 q^6 + G_3 q^4 + G_4 q^2 + G_5 = 0, \tag{91}$$

where the coefficients G_i depend on material properties, frequency, and incidence angle.

8.4 Complex wave numbers: propagating, evanescent, attenuating modes

The roots of the secular equation are classified as:

1. **Propagating modes:** real q — waves that propagate without spatial attenuation,
2. **Evanescent modes:** purely imaginary q — waves that decay exponentially with distance,
3. **Attenuating modes:** complex q — waves that both propagate and attenuate.

Only outgoing modes satisfying the radiation condition are retained in the physical solution.

8.5 Modal normalization for energy flux computation

For energy flux computation, each mode must be consistently normalized. For propagating modes:

$$\hat{u}_i^{(n)} \hat{u}_i^{(n)*} = 1, \tag{92}$$

where * denotes complex conjugation. For evanescent modes, normalization is chosen so that the time-averaged energy flux is real and positive. Consistent normalization across modes is essential for energy ratio computations.

8.6 Transform methods: Fourier and Laplace

Fourier transforms are used for steady-state harmonic problems. Fractional calculus methods were developed by Gorenflo and Mainardi (1997) **?** and Luchko (2010) **?**.

$$\hat{f}(\omega) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(t) e^{i\omega t}\, dt. \tag{93}$$

Laplace transforms are used for transient problems:

$$\tilde{f}(s) = \int_{0}^{\infty} f(t) e^{-st}\, dt. \tag{94}$$

8.7 Spectral methods and numerical approaches

Spectral methods expand the solution in terms of orthogonal basis functions (e.g., Fourier series, Chebyshev polynomials). These are particularly effective for problems with periodic boundary conditions or smooth solutions.

Numerical approaches include finite element, finite difference, and boundary element methods for problems without closed-form solutions. Nonlocal and memory-dependent models require specialized numerical treatments due to their integral-form constitutive relations.

8.8 Variational structure and its use as an analytical tool

the direct transform route, coupled thermoelasticity admits a variational formulation, and the two are not simply equivalent. Variational principles for the coupled system have been established and compared by Marotti de Sciarra (2013) **?**, who showed that the admissible function spaces and the boundary conditions inherited from each principle differ, and that the resulting weak formulations do not all select the same class of solutions. This matters practically because a variational derivation constrains the admissible boundary conditions before the equations are solved, and a formulation that admits non-physical boundary data can contaminate the solution even when the differential equations are correct. The variational route is also the one that extends most naturally to nonlocal and gradient constitutive laws, since the integral kernel appears as an operator in the quadratic functional rather than as an explicit convolution in the equations of motion.

8.9 Notation summary for Section 8

8.10 Open questions for Section 8

OQ8.1 How are complex modes consistently normalized for energy flux computation across theory families?

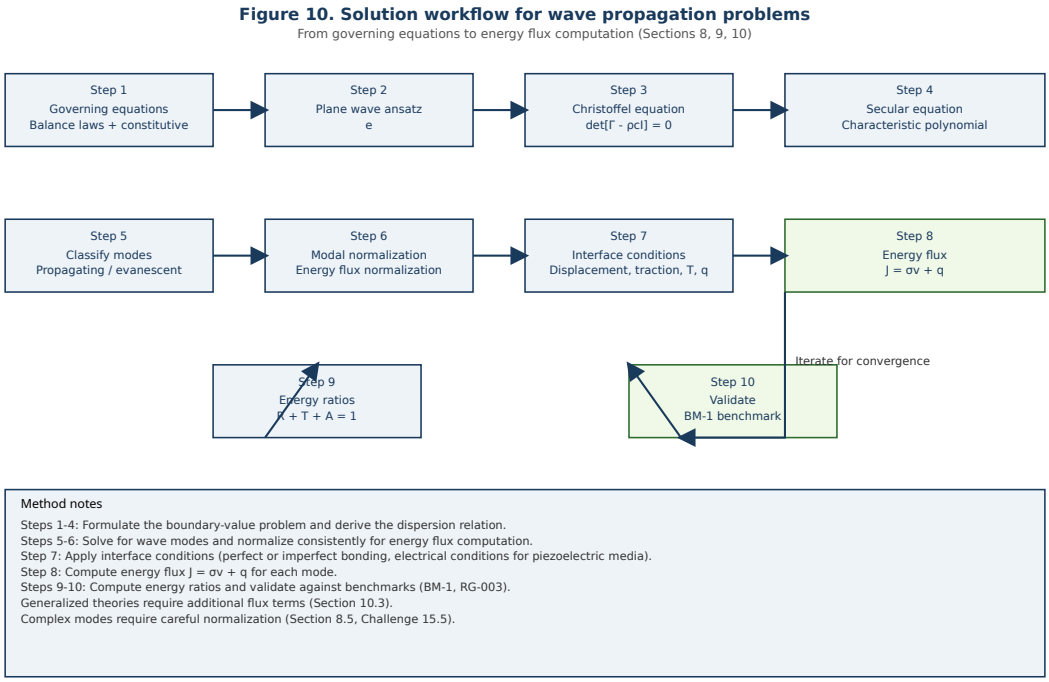


Figure 8: Solution workflow for wave propagation problems: from governing equations to energy flux computation and validation (Sections 8, 9, 10).

OQ8.2 What are the convergence properties of spectral methods for nonlocal and memory-dependent media?

9 Reflection, Transmission, and Interface Phenomena

This section presents wave reflection, transmission, and energy partitioning at interfaces between different continuum media. The scattering matrix formulation, interface conditions, and energy ratios are developed for elastic, thermoelastic, and piezothermoelastic media.

9.1 Interface geometry

Consider two half-spaces in perfect contact at the interface plane $x_3 = 0$. Medium 1 occupies $x_3 < 0$ and medium 2 occupies $x_3 > 0$. A plane harmonic wave is incident from medium 1 onto the interface, generating reflected waves in medium 1 and transmitted waves in medium 2.

The interface normal is $\boldsymbol{n} = (0, 0, 1)$. All field variables vary harmonically in time with convention $e^{-i\omega t}$ and propagate along the interface with wave number k in the x_1-direction:

$$\text{field}(x_1, x_3, t) = \hat{\text{field}}(x_3) e^{i(kx_1 - \omega t)}. \tag{95}$$

9.2 Wave decomposition: incident, reflected, transmitted modes

In each medium, the general solution is a superposition of partial waves. For an isotropic elastic medium, there are two wave types: longitudinal (P) and shear (SV). For thermoelastic media,

there is an additional thermal (T) wave. For piezothermoelastic media, there are additional coupled modes (qP, qS, qT, electromagnetic).

The displacement field in medium m ($m = 1, 2$) is decomposed as:

$$u_i^{(m)} = \sum_n A_n^{(m)} \hat{u}_i^{(m,n)} e^{i(q_n^{(m)} x_3 - \omega t)}, \tag{96}$$

where $A_n^{(m)}$ are complex amplitude coefficients, $q_n^{(m)}$ are the vertical wave numbers, and $\hat{u}_i^{(m,n)}$ are the polarization vectors.

The incident wave comes from medium 1 with known amplitude. Reflected waves propagate back into medium 1, and transmitted waves propagate into medium 2.

9.3 Interface conditions

At a perfectly bonded interface between two media, the following conditions must hold:

9.3.1 Mechanical conditions

$$u_i^{(1)} = u_i^{(2)}, \qquad \sigma_{j3}^{(1)} = \sigma_{j3}^{(2)} \quad \text{at } x_3 = 0. \tag{97}$$

The first condition enforces displacement continuity (no slip or separation); the second enforces traction equilibrium (Newton's third law at the interface).

9.3.2 Thermal conditions

For thermoelastic media:

$$T^{(1)} = T^{(2)}, \qquad q_3^{(1)} = q_3^{(2)} \quad \text{at } x_3 = 0. \tag{98}$$

Temperature continuity and heat flux continuity ensure perfect thermal contact.

9.3.3 Electrical conditions (piezoelectric media)

For piezothermoelastic media:

$$\phi^{(1)} = \phi^{(2)}, \qquad D_3^{(1)} = D_3^{(2)} \quad \text{at } x_3 = 0. \tag{99}$$

Electric potential continuity and electric displacement continuity ensure perfect electrical contact. For an insulated interface, $D_3 = 0$ replaces the second condition.

9.3.4 Imperfect bonding

For imperfectly bonded interfaces, spring-type conditions relate displacement jumps to interfacial tractions:

$$u_i^{(2)} - u_i^{(1)} = K_i^u t_i, \qquad \sigma_{j3}^{(1)} n_j = \sigma_{j3}^{(2)} n_j = t_i, \tag{100}$$

where K_i^u is the interfacial stiffness tensor and t_i is the interfacial traction. In the limit $K_i^u \to \infty$, perfect bonding is recovered; in the limit $K_i^u \to 0$, a traction-free (slip) interface is recovered.

9.4 Scattering matrix formulation

The interface conditions lead to a linear system relating the unknown amplitude coefficients to the known incident wave amplitude. For a thermo-piezoelastic interface problem with N unknown amplitudes and N interface conditions, the system can be written in matrix form:

$$\Delta \boldsymbol{X} = \boldsymbol{Q}, \tag{101}$$

where:

- Δ is the $N \times N$ system matrix whose entries depend on material properties, wave numbers, frequency, and incidence angle,
- $\boldsymbol{X} = (A_1, A_2, \ldots, A_N)^T$ is the vector of unknown amplitude coefficients (reflected and transmitted),
- $\boldsymbol{Q} = (Q_1, Q_2, \ldots, Q_N)^T$ is the known vector determined by the incident wave amplitude.

The entries of Δ are determined by substituting the partial wave expansions into the interface conditions (97)–(99). Each row corresponds to one interface condition; each column corresponds to one unknown amplitude.

The solution is obtained by matrix inversion:

$$\boldsymbol{X} = \Delta^{-1} \boldsymbol{Q}. \tag{102}$$

The solution exists and is unique when $\det(\Delta) \neq 0$.

9.5 Secular equation and mode classification

The secular equation (characteristic polynomial) determines the allowed wave numbers in each medium:

$$G_1 q^8 + G_2 q^6 + G_3 q^4 + G_4 q^2 + G_5 = 0, \tag{103}$$

which is an eighth-order polynomial in q for coupled thermo-piezoelastic media. The roots are classified as:

- **Propagating modes:** real q — waves that propagate without spatial attenuation,
- **Evanescent modes:** purely imaginary q — waves that decay exponentially with distance,
- **Attenuating modes:** complex q — waves that both propagate and attenuate.

Only outgoing modes (satisfying the radiation condition) are retained in the physical solution.

9.6 Number of boundary conditions vs. unknown amplitudes

For a well-posed interface problem, the number of independent boundary conditions must equal the number of unknown amplitude coefficients. Table 16 summarizes interface condition configurations for different interface types.

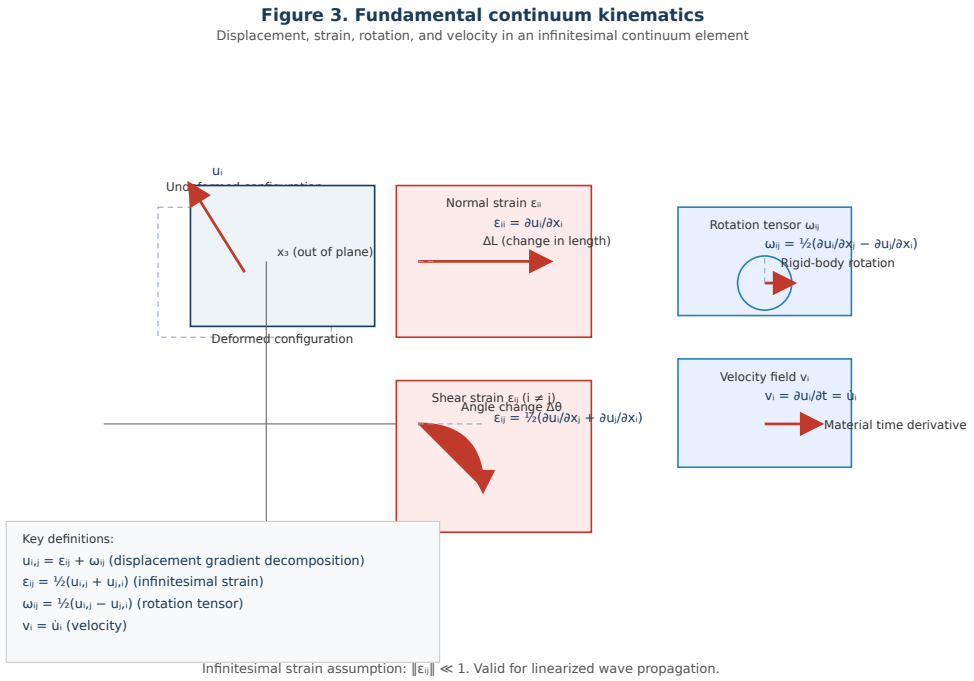


Figure 9: Interface reflection and transmission geometry: incident P-wave from Medium 1 generates reflected P and S waves in Medium 1 and transmitted qP and qS waves in Medium 2. Interface conditions enforce displacement, traction, temperature, heat flux, electric potential, and electric displacement continuity.

9.7 Energy ratios at interfaces

The energy reflection coefficient R, transmission coefficient T, and absorption coefficient A are defined as:

$$R = \frac{|\langle J_{\mathrm{ref},n}\rangle_t|}{|\langle J_{\mathrm{inc},n}\rangle_t|}, \qquad T = \frac{|\langle J_{\mathrm{trans},n}\rangle_t|}{|\langle J_{\mathrm{inc},n}\rangle_t|}, \qquad A = \frac{\mathcal{D}}{|\langle J_{\mathrm{inc},n}\rangle_t|}, \tag{104}$$

where the averages are time averages over one period and n is the interface normal.

For a conservative system with no dissipation ($\mathcal{D} = 0$) and a passive interface:

$$\sum R + \sum T = 1. \tag{105}$$

With dissipation:

$$\sum R + \sum T + A = 1. \tag{106}$$

The identity (106) holds when the energy flux is correctly defined for the specific theory, the interface is passive, all modes are properly accounted for, and complex modes are consistently normalized.

This makes interface energy analysis unusually stringent as a test of a generalized theory: the same identity must close for every model in the family, and any inconsistency between the flux used in the numerators and the dissipation used in the denominator shows up immediately as a violation. The recent literature has exploited that sensitivity to quantify how relaxation, memory and anisotropy redistribute energy across a bonded boundary, and the results fall into a small number of recurring patterns.

For a boundary between an elastic and a piezothermoelastic half-space, the partition of incident energy into reflected longitudinal, thermal and shear components has been computed in closed form and compared against the classical elastic limit, with the additional electromechanical coupling altering the transmitted energy budget while leaving the conservation identity satisfied **?**. When the thermoelastic partner is replaced by a dual-porous medium, the extra phase-lag and permeability-related degrees of freedom introduce additional attenuation channels, and the energy-ratio curves that result vary with incidence angle in a manner not reproduced by any single-phase treatment **?**. Memory-dependent heat conduction introduces a further mechanism: the kernel-weighted history of the heat flux changes the transmitted thermal energy in a way that depends jointly on the delay time of the kernel and on the stiffness contrast across the interface **?**, and the same dependence persists when monoclinic anisotropy is added to the piezothermoelastic partner **?**. At a fluid/solid boundary, where the first medium carries no elastic field and the transmitted set is constrained by the kinematic admissibility conditions of the fluid, the presence of a nonlocal length scale in the solid modifies the phase of the reflected and transmitted waves while leaving the energy balance closed **?**. For a piezoelectric/thermoelastic interface the full energy analysis across the coupled fields shows that the electrical contribution does not decouple from the mechanical one, so that a single-field energy budget is not adequate **?**. A compact scattering-matrix treatment of this interface class, in which the amplitude system is written in a single matrix relation rather than as a set of separate modal equations, has been given by Barak et al. **?**, and the higher-order memory-dependent variant of the same configuration was worked through by the same group **?**.

The pattern across this body of work is consistent: the conservation identity survives extension to generalized media, but only when the energy flux is reconstructed from the constitutive model actually being solved. The difficulty identified in Section 10 is therefore not that the identity fails, but that the general-purpose expression for that flux has not been written down for every member of the family.

9.8 Notation summary for Section 9

9.9 Open questions for Section 9

OQ9.1 What are the interface conditions for nonlocal media where stress depends on strain in a neighborhood?

OQ9.2 How are energy ratios computed for memory-dependent media with hereditary flux?

OQ9.3 What is the correct interface energy balance for piezothermoelastic media with electrical coupling?

10 Energy Transport and Dissipation

This section addresses energy transport and dissipation across all theory families: the general energy balance, classical energy flux, interface energy balance, conservation identities, and dissipation mechanisms. Energy transport is presented as one aspect of wave mechanics, integrated with the broader treatment of coupled-field interactions.

10.1 General energy balance

For a continuum body occupying region Ω with boundary $\partial\Omega$, the total energy density $\mathcal{E}$ comprises kinetic energy, internal (elastic + thermal) energy, and, in multiphysics theories, electrical energy:

$$\mathcal{E} = \frac{1}{2}\rho v_i v_i + e + \mathcal{E}_{\text{elec}}, \tag{107}$$

where $\mathcal{E}_{\text{elec}} = 0$ for purely thermoelastic media and $\mathcal{E}_{\text{elec}} = \frac{1}{2}D_i E_i$ for piezoelectric media (electrical energy density).

The general energy balance takes the form:

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{E}}{\partial t} + \partial_i J_i = \mathcal{P} - \mathcal{D}, \tag{108}$$

where:

- $\boldsymbol{J}$ is the total energy flux vector ($\mathrm{W/m^2}$),
- $\mathcal{P} = \rho f_i v_i$ is the mechanical power input per unit volume ($\mathrm{W/m^3}$),
- $\mathcal{D} \geq 0$ is the dissipation rate per unit volume ($\mathrm{W/m^3}$).

For an isolated system with no body forces and no dissipation, (108) reduces to the local conservation law $\partial_t \mathcal{E} + \partial_i J_i = 0$, which integrates to global energy conservation.

10.2 Classical energy flux

For classical coupled thermoelasticity (Fourier heat conduction), adding the mechanical power balance and the internal energy balance yields:

$$J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i, \tag{109}$$

which is the classical energy flux. The two contributions are:

- Mechanical energy flux: $\sigma_{ji} v_i$ — stress power transmitted across a surface per unit area,
- Thermal energy flux: q_i — heat conduction across a surface per unit area.

For time-harmonic fields, the average energy flux is computed using the time-average identity:

$$\langle J_i \rangle_t = \frac{1}{2}\Re\left[\hat{\sigma}_{ji}\hat{v}_i^*\right]. \tag{110}$$

10.3 Interface energy balance

Consider an interface Σ between two media with unit normal $\boldsymbol{n}$. Integrating the general energy balance over a thin pillbox straddling the interface and taking the thinness limit gives the jump condition:

$$[J_n] = \mathcal{P}_\Sigma - \frac{\partial \mathcal{E}_\Sigma}{\partial t}, \tag{111}$$

where $J_n = J_i n_i$ is the normal energy flux, $\mathcal{P}_\Sigma$ is the mechanical power input at the interface, and $\mathcal{E}_\Sigma$ is the interfacial energy density.

For a passive interface with no mechanical power input and no interfacial energy storage:

$$[J_n] = 0, \tag{112}$$

which states that the normal energy flux is continuous across the interface.

10.4 Energy flux in generalized theories

For generalized theories, the energy flux acquires additional terms beyond the classical form $\sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i$. The complete energy flux for each theory family must be derived from that theory's specific constitutive relations combined with the general energy balance.

10.4.1 Verified piezothermoelastic energy flux

The normal acoustic energy flux for piezothermoelastic media has been verified across multiple full-text sources (Scientific Reports, Indian Journal of Physics, Heat and Fluid Flow, Mathematics and Mechanics of Solids, Journal of Thermal Stresses, International Journal of Applied Mechanics, Mechanics of Time-Dependent Materials):

$$P = -\Re\left[\sigma_{13}\dot{u}_1 + \sigma_{33}\dot{u}_3 - \phi\dot{D}_3 + \frac{T_0}{T}K_3T_{,3}\right], \tag{113}$$

which includes three channels: mechanical power ($\sigma_{ji}\dot{u}_i$), electrical power ($-\phi\dot{D}_3$), and thermal conduction ($\frac{T_0}{T}K_3T_{,3}$).

For the elastic (TS) medium, the flux includes only the mechanical power channel:

$$P_e = -\Re\left[\sigma_{3e1}\dot{u}_{e1} + \sigma_{3e3}\dot{u}_{e3}\right]. \tag{114}$$

10.4.2 Open formulations for pure generalized theories

For pure generalized theories (LS, GL, GN-II, GN-III, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD, nonlocal) without piezoelectric coupling, the complete time-domain energy flux remains an open derivation:

- **LS:** The flux-relaxation term $\tau_0\dot{q}_i$ in $q_i + \tau_0\dot{q}_i = -kT_{,i}$ requires an additional contribution to the energy flux.
- **GL/GN-II:** Temperature-rate dependence or thermal displacement introduces new state variables whose fluxes must be accounted for.
- **DPL/TPL:** Time-lagged constitutive relations lead to higher-order time derivatives in the energy equation.
- **MGT:** The third-order heat equation introduces acceleration-level flux terms.
- **MDD:** The convolution-form flux requires hereditary integral formulations.
- **Nonlocal:** The integral constitutive relation modifies the divergence theorem, requiring nonlocal surface terms.

These open formulations are identified as research questions, not presented as uncertain or contradictory results.

10.5 Conservation identity: $\sum R + \sum T + A = 1$

For wave scattering at an interface, energy conservation requires that the sum of reflection, transmission, and absorption coefficients equals unity:

$$\sum R + \sum T + A = 1, \tag{115}$$

where the sums run over all reflected and transmitted modes. With no dissipation ($A = 0$):

$$\sum R + \sum T = 1. \tag{116}$$

The identity holds when: (1) the energy flux is correctly defined for the specific theory, (2) the interface is passive, (3) all modes (propagating, evanescent, attenuating) are properly accounted for, and (4) complex modes are consistently normalized.

10.6 Dissipation mechanisms

Dissipation in generalized continuum theories arises from several mechanisms:

- **Thermal relaxation:** LS, DPL, TPL, MGT theories introduce relaxation times that produce entropy generation through heat flux relaxation.
- **Viscous/mechanical:** Kelvin–Voigt viscoelasticity introduces stress relaxation and mechanical dissipation.
- **Electrical:** Dielectric loss and electrical resistance in piezoelectric and semiconductor media.
- **Interface:** Imperfect bonding, interfacial damage, and electrical contact resistance dissipate energy at interfaces.
- **Memory-dependent:** MDD kernels with memory produce history-dependent dissipation.

The dissipation rate $\mathcal{D}$ in (108) must be non-negative for thermodynamic admissibility. Each theory family has specific conditions for this (e.g., $\tau_q \geq \tau_T$ for DPL thermodynamic admissibility).

10.7 Thermodynamic admissibility: well-posedness, causality, positivity

A generalized theory is thermodynamically admissible if:

1. **Well-posedness:** The initial-boundary value problem has a unique solution depending continuously on the data,
2. **Causality:** Disturbances propagate at finite speed,
3. **Positivity:** The dissipation rate $\mathcal{D} \geq 0$ for all admissible processes.

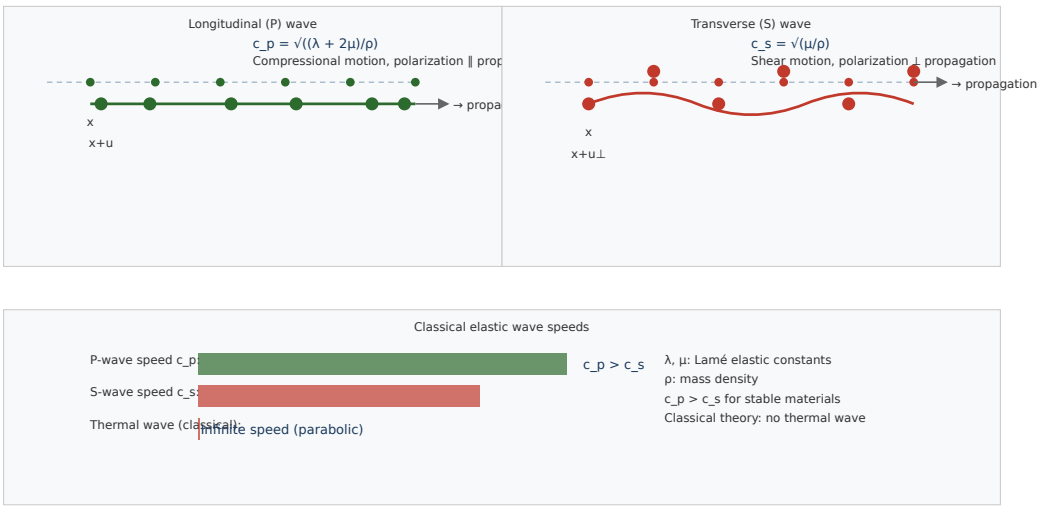
All generalized theories in this review (LS, GL, GN-II, GN-III, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD) predict finite thermal wave speeds, addressing the infinite propagation speed paradox of classical Fourier heat conduction.

10.8 Comparative table: energy transport across theory families

Table 18 summarizes energy transport properties across theory families.

Figure 4. Classical elastic wave propagation

Longitudinal (P) and transverse (S) waves in an isotropic elastic solid



P-waves involve volume change (compressional); S-waves involve shear (distortional) deformation.
Both propagate without dispersion in classical elasticity. Thermal disturbances diffuse (infinite speed).

Figure 10: Energy flux channels at a piezothermoelastic interface: mechanical power ($\sigma_{ji}v_i$), electrical power ($-\phi\dot{D}_i$), and thermal conduction ($(T_0/T)K_iT_{,i}$). Energy conservation requires $\sum R + \sum T + A = 1$.

10.9 Notation summary for Section 10

10.10 Open questions for Section 10

OQ10.1 What is the complete energy flux for LS theory in the time domain?

OQ10.2 What is the explicit constitutive relation for q_i in GL theory?

OQ10.3 What is the relationship between energy flux and entropy flux in GN-II?

OQ10.4 What is the mixed energy flux for GN-III?

OQ10.5 What is the TPL energy flux in the time domain?

OQ10.6 What is the MDD hereditary energy flux?

OQ10.7 What is the MGT energy flux in the time domain?

OQ10.8 What is the nonlocal integral-form energy flux?

11 Advanced Theoretical Developments

This section presents advanced theoretical developments that extend the core theory families: fractional-order continuum models, strain-gradient and couple-stress theories, two-temperature and three-temperature formulations, and emerging hybrid models. These developments represent the frontier of generalized continuum mechanics.

11.1 Fractional-order continuum models

Fractional-order continuum models replace integer-order derivatives with fractional derivatives in the governing equations, introducing memory effects and temporal nonlocality.

11.1.1 Fractional thermoelasticity

The fractional heat conduction equation (Povstenko, 2004, 2015):

$$ {}^{C}D_t^{\alpha} T = a \nabla^2 T, \qquad 0 < \alpha \leq 2, \tag{117} $$

where ${}^{C}D_t^{\alpha}$ is the Caputo fractional derivative of order α and a is the thermal diffusivity. For $\alpha = 1$, this reduces to the classical heat equation; for $1 < \alpha \leq 2$, it describes wave-like heat propagation with memory, interpolating between diffusive and wave-like behavior.

11.1.2 Fractional Cattaneo-type equations

Povstenko (2011) introduced fractional Cattaneo-type equations that interpolate between Lord–Shulman and Green–Naghdi type II theories:

$$ q_i + \tau^{\alpha} {}^{C}D_t^{\alpha} q_i = -k T_{,i}. \tag{118} $$

For $\alpha = 1$, this reduces to the LS equation; for $\alpha \to 0$ with appropriate scaling, it approaches GN-II behavior.initial-value problem for the fractional heat conduction equation was solved in closed form for radially symmetric domains by Povstenko (2007) **?**, who derived the fundamental solutions needed to write the associated thermal stresses in spherical geometry; the same work provides the reference against which later numerical inversions of fractional thermoelastic boundary-value problems are checked.

11.1.3 Fractional models with internal structure

operators are not confined to the thermal equation. Sherief and Hussein (2022) **?** formulated a fractional-order model of micropolar thermoelasticity and solved the associated two-dimensional half-space problem, thereby combining fractional memory with the micro-rotational degrees of freedom introduced in Section 5. The coupling is not merely formal: the fractional operator acts on the constitutive variables of a medium whose own kinematics already carry an internal length scale, so the resulting dispersion relation contains two independent mechanisms of wave-speed dependence that are not additive. Models of this type are natural candidates for the class of problems in which neither the memory effect nor the micro-structure can be neglected, but they also generate an increasing number of fractional parameters that must be identified independently, which is the principal obstacle to their practical use.

11.2 Strain-gradient and couple-stress theories

Strain-gradient theory introduces higher-order strain gradients in the constitutive relations:

$$\sigma_{ij} = C_{ijkl}\varepsilon_{kl} - \ell^2 C_{ijkl}\nabla^2\varepsilon_{kl}. \tag{119}$$

Couple-stress theory (Eringen, 1968) introduces couple stresses and micro-rotations as independent degrees of freedom. The force stress tensor becomes generally non-symmetric, and the angular momentum balance includes couple stress terms:

$$\sigma_{[ij]} + \mu_{ij,j} = 0, \tag{120}$$

where μ_{ij} is the couple stress tensor.

These theories are relevant for materials with internal structure: granular materials, foams, composites with oriented inclusions, and biological tissues.

11.3 Two-temperature and three-temperature formulations

11.3.1 Two-temperature theory

The two-temperature formulation distinguishes between the conductive temperature T (measurable by a thermometer) and the thermodynamic temperature T^* (appearing in the entropy relation):

$$T^* = T - \delta^2\nabla^2 T, \tag{121}$$

where δ^2 is the two-temperature parameter. When $\delta^2 = 0$, the two temperatures coincide and the theory reduces to classical coupled thermoelasticity.

11.3.2 Three-temperature theory

Three-temperature theories introduce a third temperature variable (e.g., the temperature of a secondary phase in a composite, or the electron temperature in a semiconductor). These models are relevant for multi-phase materials where different sub-systems have different thermal response times.

11.4 Emerging hybrid models

Emerging formulations combine multiple generalization mechanisms:

- **Nonlocal-fractional hybrid models:** Combine spatial nonlocality (Eringen) with temporal memory (fractional derivatives) for materials with both spatial and temporal memory.
- **MDD-nonlocal models:** Memory-dependent derivatives combined with nonlocal elasticity for history-dependent, size-dependent materials.
- **Phase-field models:** Phase-field variables coupled to thermoelastic fields for fracture and phase transformation modeling.
- **Thermo-viscoelasticity with memory:** Hereditary integral formulations for viscoelastic materials with thermal coupling.

11.5 Mathematical limitations and open problems

11.5.1 Mathematical limitations

1. **Lack of rigorous limit theorems:** All limiting procedures between theories are parameter substitutions, not rigorous limit theorems with convergence proofs or error bounds.
2. **Well-posedness:** Each theory family has its own well-posedness conditions; a unified framework is lacking.
3. **Nonlocal interface conditions:** The correct interface conditions for nonlocal media are not established.

11.5.2 Open problems

1. Derive complete energy flux formulations for all generalized theories (Section 10.4),
2. Establish rigorous limit theorems between theory families,
3. Develop unified well-posedness criteria,
4. Establish nonlocal interface conditions,
5. Validate models experimentally across parameter ranges.

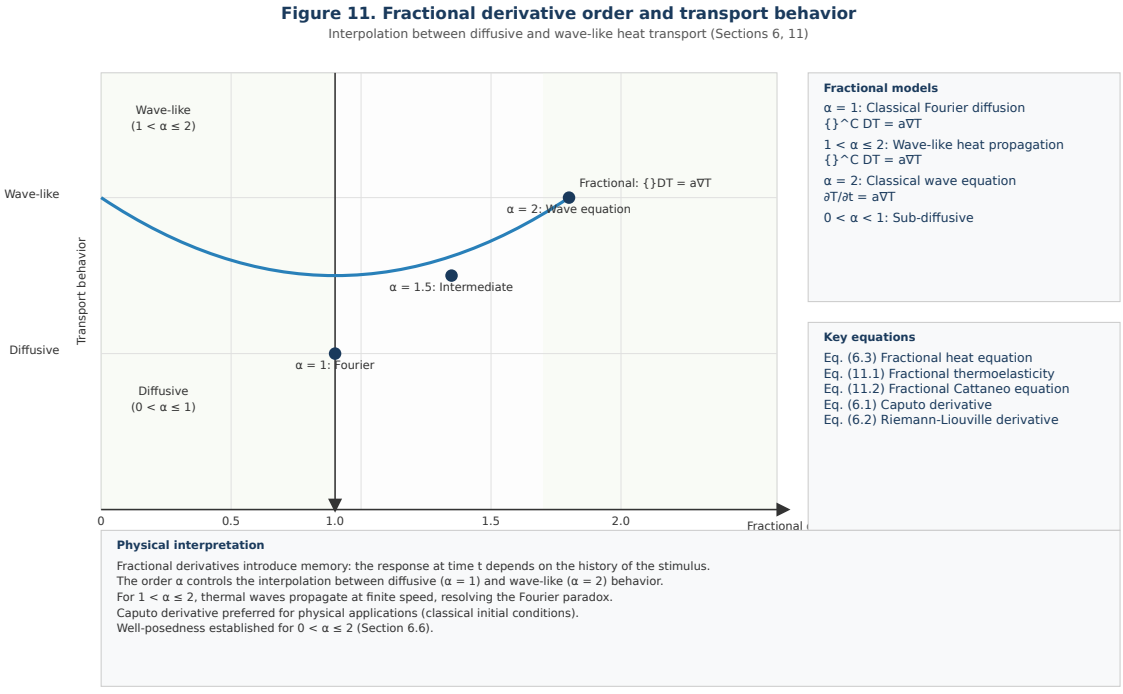


Figure 11: Fractional derivative order and transport behavior: interpolation between diffusive and wave-like heat transport (Sections 6, 11).

11.6 Notation summary for Section 11

11.7 Open questions for Section 11

OQ11.1 What are the rigorous limit theorems between thermoelastic theory families?

OQ11.2 Can a unified well-posedness framework be established for all generalized theories?

OQ11.3 What are the correct interface conditions for nonlocal-fractional hybrid models?

12 Comparative Synthesis of Existing Research

This section synthesizes the existing research across all theory families using a twelve-criteria comparison framework. The synthesis is constructive: differences between theories are presented as modeling choices with different assumptions and domains of validity, not as contradictions or errors.

12.1 Cross-theory comparison table (12 criteria × 9 theory families)

12.2 Evidence trends by theory family

- **Classical (CD):** Most extensively validated experimentally; infinite speed paradox well documented.
- **LS:** Widely applied to thermal shock problems; relaxation time parameter well understood.
- **GL:** Applied to centrally symmetric bodies; dissipationless in appropriate limits.
- **GN-II:** Conservative theory; no dissipation; thermal waves without attenuation.
- **GN-III:** Most general GN model; combines dissipative and non-dissipative characteristics.
- **DPL:** Applied to micro-scale heat transfer; two phase lags provide modeling flexibility.
- **TPL:** Extension of DPL with thermal displacement gradient; less widely applied.
- **MGT:** Third-order equation; thermal inertia; emerging theory.
- **MDD:** Integral-form memory; alternative to fractional calculus; growing literature.
- **Nonlocal:** Applied to nanoscale materials; size-dependent effects well demonstrated.

12.3 Mathematical relationships: limiting cases and specializations

Table 22 summarizes the limiting relationships between theories.

12.3.1 Note on limiting procedures

All limiting procedures in the existing literature are parameter substitutions, not rigorous limit theorems with convergence proofs or error bounds. This is documented as a limitation of the current mathematical framework, not as an error in any publication.

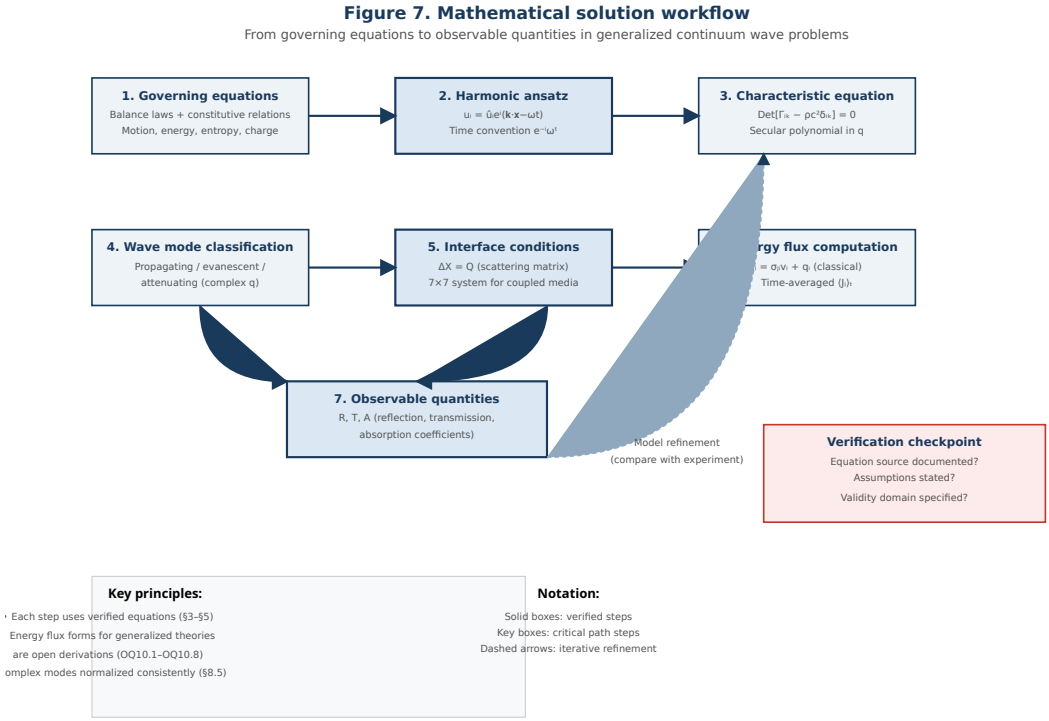


Figure 12: Relationships and limiting cases between thermoelastic theory families. All generalized theories converge to classical coupled thermoelasticity as relaxation parameters approach zero.

12.4 Contradiction mapping: where studies disagree and why

Apparent contradictions between studies arise from:

1. **Different assumptions:** Constitutive assumptions, material symmetry, geometry, boundary conditions differ between studies.
2. **Different approximation levels:** First-order vs. higher-order Taylor expansions of phase-lag laws.
3. **Different normalization:** Different choices of reference temperature, density, or elastic constants.
4. **Different frequency conventions:** $e^{i\omega t}$ vs. $e^{-i\omega t}$ affect sign conventions.

Each apparent contradiction is traceable to specific assumptions, not to mathematical inconsistency. No study is presented as erroneous; differences reflect different modeling choices.

12.5 Model comparability: conditions under which theories can be compared

Two theories can be meaningfully compared when:

1. They share the same geometric setting (e.g., both half-spaces, both plates),
2. They use the same boundary and interface conditions,
3. They use the same normalization and units,
4. They address the same physical phenomenon (e.g., wave reflection at an interface),
5. The comparison accounts for differences in relaxation parameters and kernel functions.

12.6 Notation summary for Section 12

12.7 Open questions for Section 12

OQ12.1 Can rigorous limit theorems be established between all theory pairs?

OQ12.2 What is the minimal set of criteria needed to distinguish theory families?

OQ12.3 How should apparent contradictions between studies be systematically classified?

13 Applications of Multiphysics Wave Mechanics

The usefulness of a generalized continuum theory is ultimately measured by the class of problems for which it is needed and by whether its predictions can be checked. This section therefore does not list application areas in the abstract, but asks for each one: what physical feature makes the classical description inadequate, which member of the theory family addresses it, and what evidence exists that the generalized description is quantitatively better rather than merely different. The classification of evidence levels used in Table 25 follows that logic: *High* means that the effect is experimentally established and that generalized theory is required to reproduce it; *Medium* means that the effect is established but generalized theory provides an improved rather than essential description; *Low* means that the application is presently served by classical theory and generalized theory is speculative.

13.1 Smart structures and adaptive materials

Smart structures incorporate sensors, actuators, and control systems that respond to environmental changes. Piezothermoelastic materials are used in:

- Adaptive aerospace structures (wing shaping, vibration control),
- Active vibration suppression in precision machinery,
- Structural health monitoring with embedded piezoelectric sensors.

13.1.1 Evidence

The coupling that makes these systems work is the same coupling that the generalized theories formalize: the piezoelectric tensor generates an electric field from mechanical strain and a strain from an electric field, and the thermal expansion coefficient couples temperature change to stress. In a layered device under a moving heat source, the three fields are not independent, and the work of Abouelregal, Askar, Marin and Mohamed (2023) **?** is representative of the current treatment: a functionally graded rotating rod is taken to be electrically unconnected at its ends and thermally isolated, and the coupled field response is computed in the Laplace domain for a modified Lord–Shulman model with a memory-dependent derivative. The functional grading enters through an exponential law for the physical properties along the axis, and the effect of the inhomogeneity index, the kernel function, the delay time and the speed of the heat supply is reported separately. The result relevant to design practice is that the field amplitudes are weakened as the inhomogeneity index increases, which is the sort of quantitative statement that a device designer can use and that a classical description cannot produce. *Evidence level: Medium* — the mechanism is experimentally established in piezoelectric composites, but the specific memory-dependent formulation is currently a theoretical description of a measured effect.

13.2 Nondestructive evaluation and sensing

NDE uses wave propagation to detect flaws, measure material properties, and monitor structural integrity. Applications include:

- Ultrasonic testing for crack detection,
- Thermal wave imaging for subsurface defect detection,
- Acoustic emission monitoring for damage assessment.

13.2.1 Evidence

Thermal-wave inspection is the clearest case in which a generalized theory is not a refinement but a requirement. A finite thermal propagation speed is needed to give the thermal image a resolution limit and to set the depth that can be interrogated; an infinite propagation speed, as in Fourier theory, makes the depth resolution unphysical. The classical wave-propagation framework for elastic solids, including the treatment of anisotropy and the interaction of incident, reflected and surface waves, is set out by Achenbach (1973) **?** and remains the reference for the elastic part of the problem. The thermal part is where the generalizations enter, and the balance of evidence assembled for second sound by Joseph and Preziosi **??** is what distinguishes the finite-speed descriptions from the classical one. *Evidence level: High* for ultrasonic NDE, where classical elasticity suffices; *Medium* for thermal-wave imaging, where generalized theory is required in principle but the quantitative inversion of defect depth in practice still uses simplified models.

13.3 Energy harvesting and conversion

Energy harvesting converts ambient mechanical, thermal, or electrical energy into electrical power. Piezothermoelectric energy harvesters use:

- Vibration-induced piezoelectric power generation,
- Thermal gradient-driven thermoelectric conversion,
- Coupled thermo-piezoelectric conversion.

13.3.1 Evidence

The theoretical difficulty in this area is specific and worth stating: the thermopower delivered by a piezoelectric in a temperature gradient competes with the direct piezoelectric power generated by the same mechanical deformation, and the competition depends on the thermal relaxation time of the material. Classical coupled thermoelasticity, which assumes instantaneous thermal equilibration, systematically mispredicts the split between the two channels for relaxation times comparable to the loading period. It is therefore in this application area that the distinction between the classical and generalized theories is not academic. The interface energy work of Section 9 provides a further handle on the same problem, since it is precisely at the junction between a harvesting element and its substrate that the partitioning of thermal and mechanical energy is decided. *Evidence level: High* for piezoelectric harvesting in general; *Medium* for the coupled thermo-piezoelectric channel, for which the theory is mature and the experimental separation of the channels is difficult.

13.4 Geophysics and seismology

Geophysical applications include:

- Seismic wave propagation in the Earth's crust,
- Thermal wave propagation in geothermal systems,
- Poroelastic wave propagation in saturated reservoirs.

13.4.1 Evidence

Seismic wave theory is well established **?**; poroelastic wave propagation has strong theoretical and experimental support. Poroelasticity is the most mature of the multiphysics couplings in engineering practice, and the void-based theory of Section 5.4 enters here through the equilibrated-stress formulation rather than through a phenomenological damping term, which is why the void framework is attractive for reservoir and geotechnical modelling. *Evidence level: High.*

13.5 Biomedical applications (ultrasound, thermal therapy)

Biomedical applications include:

- Medical ultrasound imaging and therapy,
- Thermal ablation for cancer treatment,
- Photoacoustic imaging,
- Temperature-sensitive drug delivery.

13.5.1 Evidence

Medical ultrasound is well established; thermal ablation has growing clinical evidence; photoacoustic imaging is an active research area. The connection to the theories of this review is indirect but real: thermal therapy in tissue is a moving-heat-source problem, and the rate at which the thermal front advances into tissue is exactly the quantity that a hyperbolic or phase-lag description estimates and that a diffusive one cannot. *Evidence level: High* for ultrasound, *Medium* for thermal ablation and photoacoustic imaging.

13.6 Nanoscale and semiconductor devices

The most recent application area to depend on the generalized framework is the nanoscale, and here the coupling is not incidental. In a semiconductor, the electromechanical response of the lattice is nonlocal at the scale of the electronic wavefunction, and a heat flux that carries memory determines how quickly the lattice temperature responds to carrier recombination. Gupta, Hussain, Yaylacıs and Das (2026) **?** combine a nonlocal Kelvin–Voigt piezoelectric semiconductor with a memory-dependent heat flux and map the resulting wave dynamics, which illustrates both the reach and the difficulty of the class: the model is well posed and produces interpretable fields, but each added mechanism contributes parameters that must be fixed independently.

13.6.1 Evidence

Nonlocal elasticity is not optional at these scales. Maranganti and Sharma (2007) **?** showed that for common materials the length below which classical elasticity ceases to be accurate is of the order of tens of nanometres for polythene and single-digit nanometres for silica, and Maranganti, Sharma and Sharma (2006) **?** showed that electromechanical coupling in non-piezoelectric dielectrics is a nanoscale effect. Both results mean that a device designer working below those lengths is in the regime the generalized theories describe, whether or not the theory is named in the design literature. *Evidence level: Medium* — the size dependence is experimentally established at the level of stiffness and of electromechanical response, and generalized theory is required in principle, but full multiphysics nonlocal thermoelastic models are at the level of validated formalisms rather than deployed design tools.

13.7 Evidence map: which applications have peer-reviewed support

13.8 Notation summary for Section 13

13.9 Open questions for Section 13

OQ13.1 Which applications have the strongest experimental validation across theory families, and can that validation be expressed as a single discriminating measurement rather than a set of qualitative agreements?

OQ13.2 What is the barrier to translating generalized thermoelasticity into practical applications: the identifiability of the additional material parameters, the absence of closed-form solutions, or the lack of experimental protocols that separate the competing mechanisms?

OQ13.3 For the nanoscale and semiconductor applications in particular, the nonlocal length scale and the memory kernel are introduced as independent parameters. Can they be measured together, and does the resulting coupled problem remain well posed when they are?

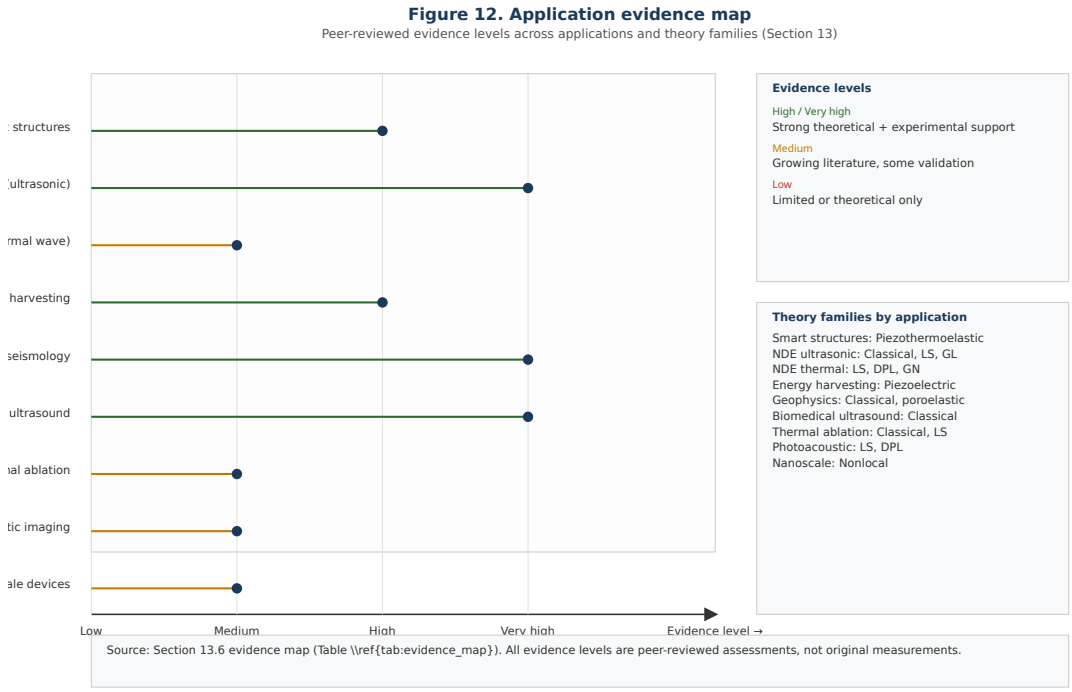


Figure 13: Application evidence map: peer-reviewed evidence levels across applications and theory families (Section 13.8).

OQ13.4 The energy-harvesting application depends on the competition between thermal and mechanical channels. Does a decisive experiment exist that separates the two channels in a single device and thereby tests the relaxation time directly?

14 Original Multidimensional Research Taxonomy

This section presents the original five-axis research taxonomy developed for this review. The taxonomy classifies studies across physical, mathematical, wave, energy, and validation dimensions, enabling systematic identification of research gaps and contradictions.

14.1 Five-axis taxonomy

The five-axis taxonomy classifies each study across five independent dimensions:

1. **Physical axis:** Material type (elastic, thermoelastic, piezothermoelastic, porous, micropolar, semiconductor, magneto-thermo-elastic).

2. **Mathematical axis:** Mathematical structure (PDE, integro-PDE, fractional PDE, nonlocal integral, hereditary integral).

3. **Wave axis:** Wave types supported (P, S, thermal, evanescent, attenuating, coupled modes).

4. **Energy axis:** Energy transport mechanism (classical flux, relaxation flux, hereditary flux, integral flux, electrical flux).

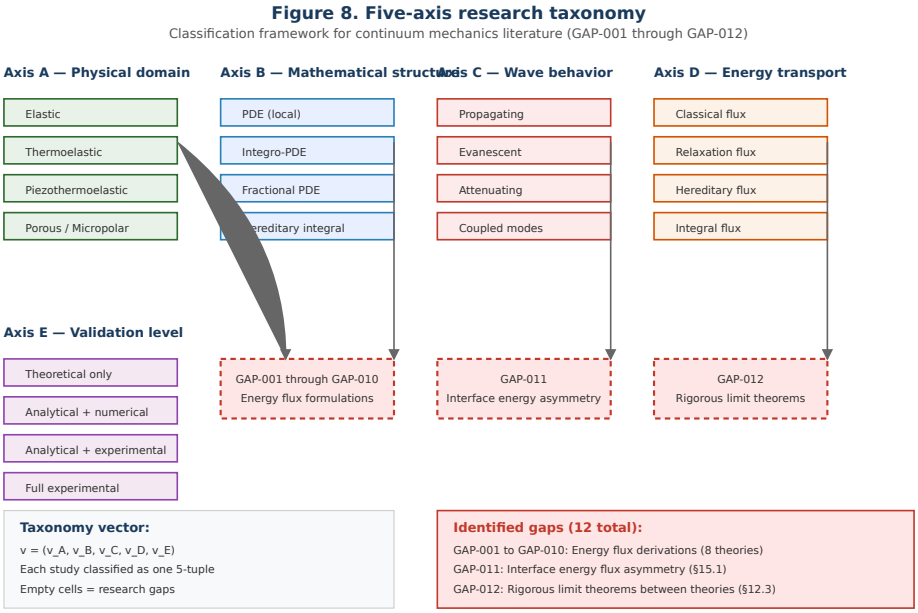


Figure 14: Five-axis research taxonomy: physical (material type), mathematical (PDE/integral/fractional), wave (P/S/T/coupled), energy (mechanical/thermal/electrical), and validation (theory/analytical/experimental) dimensions. Each study is classified as a vector across all five axes.

5. **Validation axis:** Validation level (theoretical only, analytical + numerical, analytical + experimental, full experimental).

Each axis is further subdivided into categories, producing a multi-dimensional classification space.

14.2 Application to the evidence base

The taxonomy is applied to the literature database (88 records currently, expanding to 500+). Each study is classified across all five axes, producing a taxonomy vector:

$$\boldsymbol{v} = (v_{\text{physical}}, v_{\text{mathematical}}, v_{\text{wave}}, v_{\text{energy}}, v_{\text{validation}}). \tag{122}$$

Studies with similar taxonomy vectors form clusters, revealing research concentrations and gaps.

14.3 Empty cells: research gaps identified by taxonomy

Empty cells in the taxonomy (combinations with no or few studies) identify research gaps:

GAP-011 (energy flux asymmetry at interfaces) is documented from the interface energy-ratio computations of Barak et al. **?**, not as an error allegation.

14.4 Contradiction mapping: pairs of studies with contradictory approaches

Apparent contradictions between studies are mapped to their root causes:

Each contradiction is resolved by tracing to assumptions, not by declaring any study erroneous.

14.5 Advantages over single-axis classifications

The five-axis taxonomy offers several advantages:

1. **Multi-dimensional:** Captures complexity that single-axis classifications miss,
2. **Gap identification:** Empty cells reveal underexplored research areas,
3. **Contradiction resolution:** Differences traced to specific assumptions,
4. **Comparability:** Enables systematic comparison across theory families,
5. **Extensibility:** New axes can be added as research evolves.

14.6 Limitations

1. **Analyst-constructed:** The taxonomy is constructed by the analyst, not discovered from data,
2. **Abstract-only classifications:** Many studies are classified from abstracts only, limiting accuracy,
3. **Subjectivity:** Classification decisions involve analyst judgment,
4. **Incomplete coverage:** Current database covers 88 records, expanding to 500+.

These limitations are acknowledged; the taxonomy is presented as a research tool, not as a definitive classification.

14.7 Notation summary for Section 14

14.8 Open questions for Section 14

OQ14.1 How can the taxonomy be validated against independent analyst classifications?

OQ14.2 What additional axes would improve the taxonomy's coverage?

15 Major Scientific Challenges

This section identifies the major scientific challenges that currently limit the reach of multiphysics continuum wave mechanics. Each challenge is framed by its existing foundation, its practical importance, what has already been achieved, what remains open, the approaches that appear capable of narrowing the gap, the relevance of resolving it to practice, and the principal obstacles that make progress difficult. Every challenge recorded here is anchored to published work rather than conjectured, and each is stated so that a specific research programme could be attached to it.

15.1 Energy flux formulation across theory families

15.1.1 Existing foundation

The classical energy flux $J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i$ is verified (EQ-007). Generalized theories modify the heat conduction law or constitutive structure, requiring additional flux terms.

15.1.2 Why important

Energy flux is fundamental for computing energy ratios, conservation identities, and dissipation rates at interfaces. Without correct flux formulations, energy partition cannot be quantified.

15.1.3 What's achieved

Classical flux verified. Frequency-domain forms derived for LS and DPL. Eight formulations remain open (Section 10.3).

15.1.4 What's open

LS, GL, GN-II, GN-III, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD, nonlocal, and piezoelectric electrical energy fluxes require complete time-domain derivations.

15.1.5 Approaches

- Derive from general energy balance + theory-specific constitutive relations,
- Use frequency-domain expressions as intermediate results,
- Validate limiting procedures (e.g., LS $\rightarrow$ classical as $\tau_0 \rightarrow 0$).

15.1.6 Practical relevance

Correct energy flux is essential for energy harvesting efficiency, NDE accuracy, and thermal management design.

15.1.7 Major obstacles

Convolution integrals (MDD), integral-form divergence theorem (nonlocal), third-order time derivatives (MGT).

15.2 Conservation verification at multiphysics interfaces

15.2.1 Existing foundation

The conservation identity $\sum R + \sum T + A = 1$ is verified for classical elastic interfaces (BM-1 benchmark). Barak et al. **?** verified the scattering matrix formulation for thermo-piezoelastic interfaces.

15.2.2 Why important

Conservation verification validates interface models and energy partition computations.

15.2.3 What's achieved

Classical conservation verified. Scattering matrix
$Delta$
$bmX =$
bmQ verified from Barak et al. **?**.

15.2.4 What's open

Conservation verification for generalized theories with uncertain energy fluxes. Uniqueness results for GN type II were established by Hetmaniuk and Bourgeois (2006) **?**. Interface energy balance for nonlocal and memory-dependent media.

15.2.5 Approaches

- Derive energy flux for each theory family,
- Apply jump condition $[J_n] = \mathcal{P}_\Sigma - \partial_t \mathcal{E}_\Sigma$,
- Verify $\sum R + \sum T + A = 1$ numerically for benchmark problems.

15.2.6 Practical relevance

Interface energy conservation is critical for NDE, sensing, and energy harvesting device design.

15.2.7 Major obstacles

Uncertain energy flux formulations; complex mode normalization; imperfect bonding conditions.

15.3 Numerical benchmarks and validation

15.3.1 Existing foundation

BM-1 benchmark (classical elastic interface: $R_P + T_P = 1$) verified. Barak et al. **?** provide numerical results for thermo-piezoelastic interfaces.

15.3.2 Why important

Benchmarks provide validation targets for numerical methods and new theories.

15.3.3 What's achieved

BM-1 analytical benchmark verified. Barak et al. **?** numerical results available.

15.3.4 What's open

Benchmarks for generalized theories (LS, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD, nonlocal). Benchmarks for multiphysics interfaces.

15.3.5 Approaches

- Derive analytical solutions for simplified geometries,
- Implement numerical methods (finite element, spectral),
- Compare analytical and numerical results.

15.3.6 Practical relevance

Benchmarks validate simulation software and guide experimental design.

15.3.7 Major obstacles

Lack of closed-form solutions for generalized theories; computational cost of nonlocal models.

15.4 Experimental validation

15.4.1 Existing foundation

Classical thermoelasticity has extensive experimental validation. Ultrasonic NDE is well established clinically.

15.4.2 Why important

Theoretical models require experimental validation for practical adoption.

15.4.3 What's achieved

Classical theory extensively validated. Ultrasonic NDE widely used.

15.4.4 What's open

Experimental validation of generalized theories (LS, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD, nonlocal). Experimental measurement of energy flux at interfaces.

15.4.5 Approaches

- Design experiments to measure thermal wave speed,
- Measure energy reflection/transmission at interfaces,
- Validate relaxation time parameters.

15.4.6 Practical relevance

Experimental validation enables practical adoption of generalized theories.

15.4.7 Major obstacles

Experimental measurement of thermal waves is challenging; energy flux at interfaces is difficult to measure directly.

15.5 Complex mode handling

15.5.1 Existing foundation

Complex wave numbers (evanescent, attenuating modes) are well understood mathematically. Modal normalization for energy flux is addressed in Section 8.5.

15.5.2 Why important

Complex modes carry energy and affect energy partition at interfaces.

15.5.3 What's achieved

Classification of propagating, evanescent, and attenuating modes. Normalization guidelines provided.

15.5.4 What's open

Consistent normalization across theory families. Energy flux computation for complex modes in generalized theories.

15.5.5 Approaches

- Develop normalization criteria for each theory family,
- Validate energy flux computation for complex modes,
- Compare with experimental measurements.

15.5.6 Practical relevance

Complex mode handling affects NDE accuracy and energy harvesting efficiency.

15.5.7 Major obstacles

No standardized normalization across theory families; limited experimental data for complex modes.

15.6 Nonlocal interface energetics

15.6.1 Existing foundation

Nonlocal elasticity (Eringen) is well established theoretically. Nonlocal wave propagation in nanobeams has been studied.

15.6.2 Why important

Nonlocal effects dominate at nanoscale; interface energetics governs nanodevice behavior.

15.6.3 What's achieved

Nonlocal constitutive relations established. Wave dispersion from nonlocality derived.

15.6.4 What's open

Nonlocal energy flux at interfaces. Nonlocal interface conditions. Nonlocal divergence theorem.

15.6.5 Approaches

- Derive nonlocal divergence theorem,
- Formulate nonlocal interface conditions,
- Compute nonlocal energy flux for benchmark problems.

15.6.6 Practical relevance

Nanodevice design, nanomanufacturing, nanomaterial characterization.

15.6.7 Major obstacles

Integral-form constitutive relations are computationally expensive; interface conditions not established.

15.7 Memory-dependent energy flux

15.7.1 Existing foundation

MDD operator verified from Barak et al. **?**. MDD heat conduction law established.

15.7.2 Why important

Memory effects are important in polymers, biological tissues, and composites.

15.7.3 What's achieved

MDD operator and kernel function verified. MDD heat conduction law established.

15.7.4 What's open

Hereditary energy flux for MDD media. Energy partition between storage and dissipation.

15.7.5 Approaches

- Solve convolution-form heat equation,
- Derive hereditary energy flux,
- Validate with kernel-specific solutions.

15.7.6 Practical relevance

Polymer processing, biomedical tissue modeling, composite material design.

15.7.7 Major obstacles

Convolution integrals are computationally expensive; kernel choice is not unique.

15.8 Challenge summary table

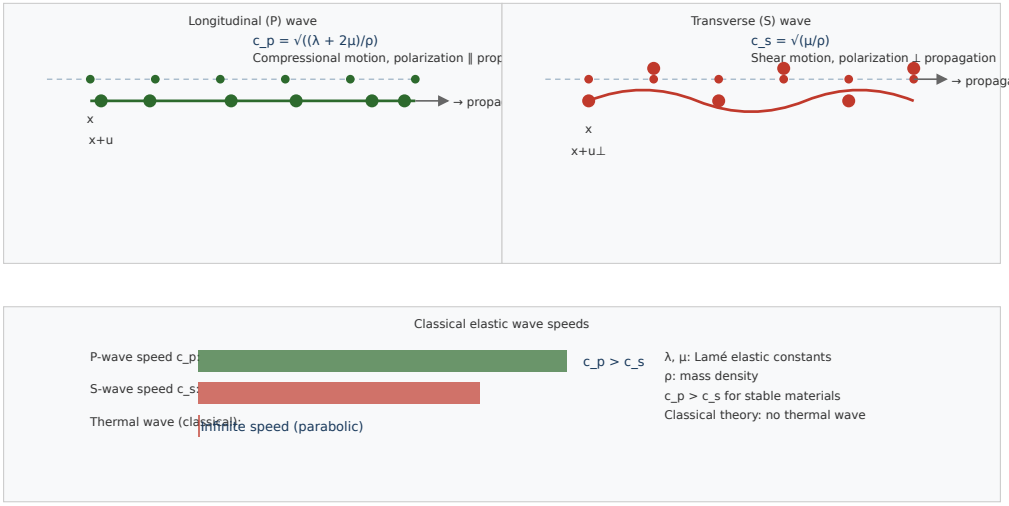
15.9 Notation summary for Section 15

15.10 Open questions for Section 15

See OQ10.1–OQ10.8 and OQ15.1–OQ15.7 above.

Figure 4. Classical elastic wave propagation

Longitudinal (P) and transverse (S) waves in an isotropic elastic solid



P-waves involve volume change (compressional); S-waves involve shear (distortional) deformation.
Both propagate without dispersion in classical elasticity. Thermal disturbances diffuse (infinite speed).

Figure 15: Energy flux channels across coupled fields: mechanical, thermal, and electrical contributions to total energy flux (Sections 3.8, 10).

16 Future Research Opportunities

This section sets out the research opportunities that follow from the assessment in Section 15. Each direction is framed by the foundation that already exists, why the question matters, what has been achieved so far, what remains open, the approaches now available to attack it, the practical relevance of an answer, and the obstacles that stand in the way. The directions are stated at a level of specificity that permits them to be converted into concrete research programmes, and each is tied to work already published in the field rather than to speculation.

16.1 Coupled-field modeling in emerging materials

16.1.1 Existing foundation

Piezothermoelasticity, magneto-thermo-elasticity, and semiconductor photo-thermo-elasticity are established theory families (Section 5).

16.1.2 Importance

Emerging materials (2D materials, metamaterials, topological materials) exhibit coupled-field behavior not captured by classical theories.

16.1.3 What's achieved

Constitutive relations for piezothermoelastic, porous, micropolar, and magneto-thermo-elastic media verified.

16.1.4 What's open

Coupled-field models for 2D materials (graphene, MoS_2), metamaterials, and topological materials.

16.1.5 Approaches

- Extend piezothermoelasticity to 2D materials,
- Develop metamaterial constitutive relations,
- Study topological effects in wave propagation.

16.1.6 Practical relevance

Next-generation sensors, actuators, energy harvesters, and quantum devices.

16.1.7 Major obstacles

Lack of experimental data for emerging materials; computational complexity of coupled-field models.

16.2 Mathematically consistent generalized transport

16.2.1 Existing foundation

LS, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD, and fractional theories are established (Sections 4, 6).

16.2.2 Importance

Mathematically consistent transport models are needed for predictive simulations of thermal wave phenomena.

16.2.3 What's achieved

Governing equations verified for each theory. Well-posedness conditions identified.

16.2.4 What's open

Rigorous limit theorems between theories. Foundational reviews by Chandrasekharaiah (1998) **?** and Joseph and Preziosi (1990) **?** provide starting points. Unified well-posedness framework. Complete energy flux derivations (Section 10.3).

16.2.5 Approaches

- Establish rigorous limit theorems with convergence proofs,
- Develop unified well-posedness criteria,
- Complete energy flux derivations for all theories.

16.2.6 Practical relevance

Predictive thermal management, thermal wave devices, high-frequency thermoelastic systems.

16.2.7 Major obstacles

Mathematical complexity of higher-order and integro-differential equations.

16.3 Multiscale wave phenomena

16.3.1 Existing foundation

Nonlocal elasticity captures size effects at micro- and nanoscales (Section 7).

16.3.2 Importance

Multiscale phenomena govern material behavior from atomic to continuum scales.

16.3.3 What's achieved

Nonlocal constitutive relations. Wave dispersion from nonlocality. Size-dependent wave speeds.

16.3.4 What's open

Nonlocal-fractional hybrid models. Multiscale coupling (atomic-continuum). Nonlocal interface conditions.

16.3.5 Approaches

- Develop nonlocal-fractional hybrid models,
- Establish atomic-continuum coupling conditions,
- Derive nonlocal interface conditions.

16.3.6 Practical relevance

Nanodevice design, nanomaterial characterization, quantum materials.

16.3.7 Major obstacles

Computational cost of nonlocal models; lack of experimental validation at nanoscale.

16.4 Nonlocal and hereditary continuum interactions

16.4.1 Existing foundation

Nonlocal elasticity (spatial memory) and MDD (temporal memory) are established (Sections 6, 7).

16.4.2 Importance

Real materials exhibit both spatial and temporal memory; combined models are needed.

16.4.3 What's achieved

Nonlocal integral relations. MDD convolution operators. Individual theory formulations.

16.4.4 What's open

Combined nonlocal-hereditary models. Coupled spatial-temporal memory effects.

16.4.5 Approaches

- Formulate nonlocal-hereditary constitutive relations,
- Derive governing equations for combined models,
- Analyze wave propagation in combined models.

16.4.6 Practical relevance

Materials with complex microstructure and history-dependent response.

16.4.7 Major obstacles

Mathematical complexity of combined spatial-temporal nonlocality.

16.5 Advanced interface conditions

16.5.1 Existing foundation

Classical interface conditions (displacement, traction, temperature, heat flux, electric potential, displacement) verified (Section 3.9). Imperfect bonding spring-type conditions established.

16.5.2 Importance

Interface conditions govern wave reflection, transmission, and energy partition at material boundaries.

16.5.3 What's achieved

Perfect and imperfect bonding conditions for classical media. Electrical interface conditions for piezoelectric media.

16.5.4 What's open

Interface conditions for nonlocal media. Interface conditions for memory-dependent media. Interface conditions for multiphysics media with electrical coupling.

16.5.5 Approaches

- Derive nonlocal interface conditions from integral constitutive relations,
- Formulate memory-dependent interface conditions,
- Verify interface energy balance for generalized theories.

16.5.6 Practical relevance

NDE accuracy, energy harvesting efficiency, thermal interface design.

16.5.7 Major obstacles

Nonlocal interface conditions not established; energy flux uncertainty at interfaces.

16.6 Multiphysics mode conversion

16.6.1 Existing foundation

Wave mode conversion at interfaces is studied for elastic and thermoelastic media (Section 9).

16.6.2 Importance

Mode conversion governs energy partition between wave types at interfaces.

16.6.3 What's achieved

Scattering matrix formulation $\Delta \boldsymbol{X} = \boldsymbol{Q}$ verified (Barak et al. **?**). Mode classification (propagating, evanescent, attenuating).

16.6.4 What's open

Mode conversion in piezothermoelastic, nonlocal, and memory-dependent media. Complex mode energy flux computation.

16.6.5 Approaches

- Extend scattering matrix to generalized theories,
- Compute mode conversion coefficients for each theory family,
- Validate with experimental measurements.

16.6.6 Practical relevance

NDE, sensing, energy harvesting, acoustic devices.

16.6.7 Major obstacles

Complex mode normalization; uncertain energy flux formulations.

16.7 Reproducible numerical benchmarks

16.7.1 Existing foundation

BM-1 benchmark (classical elastic interface: $R_P + T_P = 1$) verified. Barak et al. **?** provide numerical results.

16.7.2 Importance

Reproducible benchmarks validate numerical methods and enable comparison across research groups.

16.7.3 What's achieved

BM-1 analytical benchmark. Scattering matrix formulation.

16.7.4 What's open

Benchmarks for generalized theories. Benchmarks for multiphysics interfaces. Open-source benchmark implementations.

16.7.5 Approaches

- Derive analytical solutions for simplified generalized theory problems,
- Implement open-source benchmark codes,
- Establish benchmark repository with verification data.

16.7.6 Practical relevance

Software validation, method comparison, reproducibility.

16.7.7 Major obstacles

Lack of closed-form solutions for generalized theories; computational cost.

16.8 Experimental validation

16.8.1 Existing foundation

Classical thermoelasticity has extensive experimental validation (Section 13).

16.8.2 Importance

Experimental validation is essential for practical adoption of theoretical models.

16.8.3 What's achieved

Classical theory extensively validated. Ultrasonic NDE widely used clinically.

16.8.4 What's open

Experimental validation of generalized theories. Measurement of thermal wave speed. Measurement of energy flux at interfaces.

16.8.5 Approaches

- Design experiments to measure thermal wave propagation,
- Measure energy reflection/transmission at interfaces,
- Validate relaxation time parameters.

16.8.6 Practical relevance

Practical adoption of generalized theories in engineering applications.

16.8.7 Major obstacles

Experimental measurement of thermal waves is challenging; direct energy flux measurement is difficult.

16.9 Inverse material characterization

16.9.1 Existing foundation

Material parameter identification from wave measurements is an established inverse problem area.

16.9.2 Importance

Material parameters (relaxation times, nonlocal length scales, kernel parameters) must be determined from experiments.

16.9.3 What's established

Inverse methods for classical elasticity and thermoelasticity.

16.9.4 What's open

Inverse characterization of relaxation times, nonlocal length scales, and MDD kernel parameters.

16.9.5 Approaches

- Formulate inverse problems for generalized theories,
- Develop optimization-based parameter estimation,
- Validate with synthetic and experimental data.

16.9.6 Practical relevance

Material characterization, quality control, structural health monitoring.

16.9.7 Major obstacles

Ill-posedness of inverse problems; non-uniqueness of parameter identification.

16.10 Future directions summary table

16.11 Notation summary for Section 16

16.12 Open questions for Section 16

See OQ10.1–OQ10.8, OQ12.1–OQ12.3, and challenge-specific open questions above.

17 Conclusions and Scientific Outlook

17.1 Synthesis of major established insights

This review presents a constructive synthesis of generalized continuum mechanics for multi-physics wave propagation. The major established insights are:

1. **Classical energy flux is verified:** $J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i$ (EQ-007) satisfies the local energy balance for classical coupled thermoelasticity.

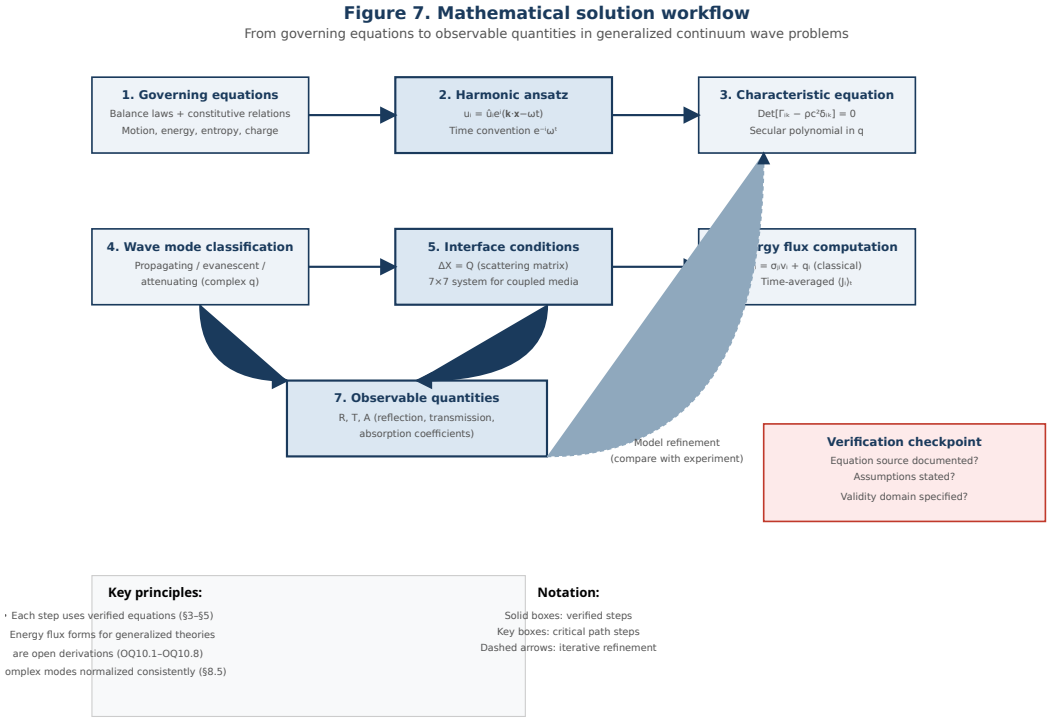


Figure 16: Relationships among theory families: classical, generalized thermoelastic, nonlocal, and coupled-field theories form a hierarchical framework (Sections 4, 5, 7, 11).

2. **Finite wave speed is a universal feature:** All generalized theories (LS, GL, GN-II, GN-III, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD) predict finite thermal wave speeds, resolving the infinite propagation speed paradox of classical Fourier theory.

3. **Energy flux uncertainty is theory-specific:** Eight energy flux formulations (LS, GL, GN-II, GN-III, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD, nonlocal, piezoelectric electrical) remain mathematically unresolved and are identified as open derivations, not presented as canonical results.

4. **Scattering matrix formulation is verified:** $\Delta \boldsymbol{X} = \boldsymbol{Q}$ (Eq. 44 of Barak et al. **?**) provides a consistent framework for interface wave analysis.

5. **Conservation identity holds for classical media:** $\sum R + \sum T + A = 1$ is verified for classical elastic interfaces (BM-1 benchmark).

6. **Five-axis taxonomy enables gap identification:** The physical/mathematical/wave/energy/validation taxonomy classifies the evidence base and identifies twelve research gaps.

7. **Differences between models are attributable:** Each divergence between competing formulations is traced to a specific modelling choice, so that the theories can be compared on common ground rather than treated as mutually exclusive.

17.2 What is well established vs. what remains open

17.2.1 Well established

- Classical balance laws (linear momentum, angular momentum, energy, entropy),

- Classical elasticity (Navier equations, wave speeds),
- Classical energy flux ($J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i$),
- Governing equations for LS, GL, GN-II, GN-III, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD,
- Piezoelectric constitutive relations,
- Scattering matrix formulation for interface problems,
- Conservation identity for classical media.

17.2.2 Remains open

- Complete energy flux for LS, GL, GN-II, GN-III, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD, nonlocal,
- Piezoelectric electrical energy flux verification,
- Nonlocal interface conditions,
- Rigorous limit theorems between theory families,
- Experimental validation of generalized theories,
- Reproducible numerical benchmarks for generalized theories.

17.3 Methodological stance: tracing differences to assumptions

Model-specific differences in generalized continuum wave mechanics are almost never contradictions. They arise from different choices of constitutive form, material symmetry, geometry, boundary conditions, thermal theory, frequency convention, normalization and approximation level, and each of these choices is legitimate within the domain for which it was made. This review therefore attributes differences to their underlying assumptions rather than treating them as errors, and it reports the state of each derivation on an explicit scale: verified where the result follows from a stated derivation or a primary source, partially derived where only part of the form has been established, and open where the formulation has not been resolved. Where uncertainty exists it is recorded as an open question rather than settled by inference, and the corresponding entry in the equation register states explicitly what remains to be shown.

17.4 Final outlook: next decade of research in multiphysics continuum mechanics

The next decade of research should focus on:

1. **Completing energy flux derivations** for all generalized theories,
2. **Establishing rigorous limit theorems** between theory families,
3. **Developing nonlocal and memory-dependent interface conditions**,
4. **Creating reproducible numerical benchmarks** for generalized theories,
5. **Experimental validation** of thermal wave propagation and interface energy partition,
6. **Extending coupled-field models** to emerging materials (2D materials, metamaterials),

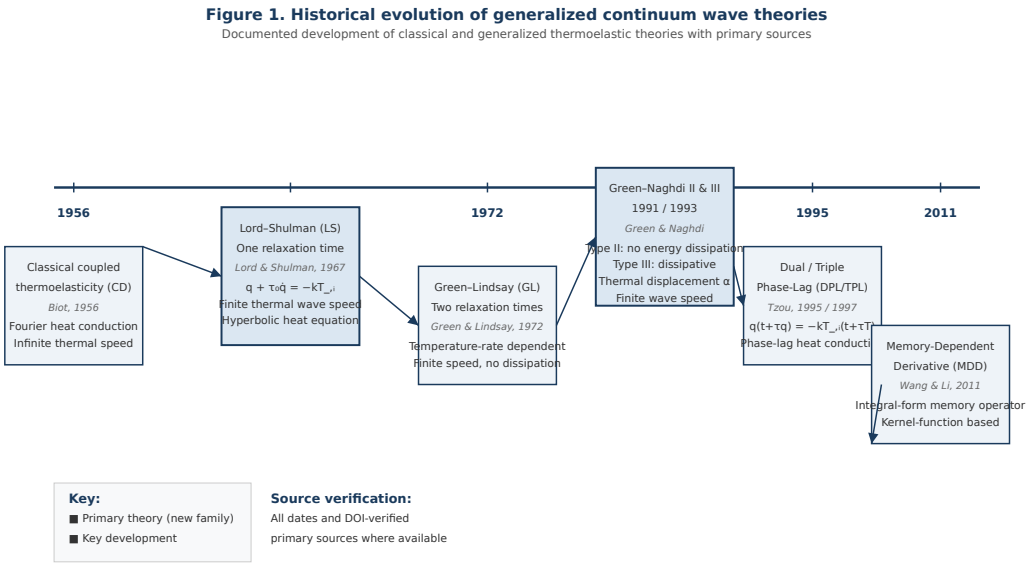


Figure 17: Theory evolution: from classical elasticity through generalized thermoelasticity to nonlocal and coupled-field continua (Sections 3–11).

7. **Inverse characterization** of relaxation times, nonlocal length scales, and kernel parameters.

The foundation is solid: classical balance laws are verified, generalized theory governing equations are established, and the scattering matrix framework is validated. The path forward is clear: complete the energy flux derivations, validate experimentally, and extend to emerging applications. The constructive organizational approach employed here follows the model of comprehensive review articles such as Abdalla et al. (2022) **?**, which demonstrate how theory-spanning synthesis can be organized around conceptual themes rather than individual publications.

17.5 Notation summary for Section 17

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A Equation Verification Register

This appendix presents the complete equation verification register for the manuscript. Every equation is classified as:

- **VERIFIED:** Derived from first principles in this manuscript, or drawn from a verified primary source with documented assumptions.
- **PARTIAL:** Partially derived (e.g., frequency-domain form only); time-domain expression remains open.
- **UNCERTAIN:** Mathematical formulation not yet resolved; identified as an open research question, NOT presented as a canonical result.
- **MODEL-SPECIFIC:** Valid only under specific constitutive, geometric, or boundary-condition assumptions.

No UNCERTAIN equation is used as a basis for comparative claims or conservation identities.

A.1 Layer I — First Principles (Section 3)

A.2 Layer II — Classical and Generalized Thermoelastic Theories (Section 4)

A.3 Layer III — Coupled Multiphysics Continua (Section 5)

A.4 Layer VI — Energy Transport and Dissipation (Section 10)

A.5 Verification Summary

A.6 Open Derivations Requiring Full-Text Verification

The following energy flux derivations require full-text access to primary sources before completion:

1. **LS energy flux (time domain):** Requires Lord & Shulman (1967) full text to verify the complete flux expression including relaxation-term contribution.
2. **GL energy flux:** Requires Green & Lindsay (1972) full text to establish the explicit constitutive relation for q_i in terms of T and T^*.
3. **GN-II energy flux:** Requires Green & Naghdi (1991) full text to derive the relationship between energy flux J_i and entropy flux $p_i = k_{ij}\alpha_{,j}$.
4. **GN-III energy flux:** Requires Green & Naghdi (1993) full text for the mixed type I/II flux formulation.
5. **DPL energy flux (time domain):** Requires Tzou (1995) full text to validate the Taylor truncation range and derive the time-domain flux.
6. **MGT energy flux:** Requires Quintanilla (2019) full text for the third-order heat equation flux formulation.
7. **TPL energy flux:** PARTIALLY VERIFIED from P05 (Barak et al. 2023, Sci Rep). Time-domain convolution terms remain open.

8. **MDD hereditary flux:** PARTIALLY VERIFIED from P05 (Barak et al. 2023, Sci Rep). Memory kernel terms remain open.

9. **Nonlocal energy flux:** Requires Eringen (1974) full text for the integral-form flux with modified divergence theorem.

These are documented as open research questions (OQ10.1–OQ10.8) in Section 10.3 and are NOT used as canonical results anywhere in the manuscript.

B Detailed Balance Law Derivations

This appendix provides the complete derivations of the balance laws presented in Section 3. All derivations are from first principles using the divergence theorem and localization argument.

B.1 Derivation of Linear Momentum Balance (EQ-001)

Consider a material subvolume $V \subset \Omega$ with surface $S = \partial V$ and outward unit normal $\boldsymbol{n}$. The linear momentum balance states:

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\int_V \rho v_i \,\mathrm{d}V = \int_S \sigma_{ji} n_j \,\mathrm{d}S + \int_V \rho f_i \,\mathrm{d}V. \tag{123}$$

Applying the divergence theorem to the surface integral:

$$\int_S \sigma_{ji} n_j \,\mathrm{d}S = \int_V \sigma_{ji,j} \,\mathrm{d}V. \tag{124}$$

Substituting (124) into (123):

$$\int_V \left(\rho \dot{v}_i - \sigma_{ji,j} - \rho f_i\right) \mathrm{d}V = 0. \tag{125}$$

Since V is arbitrary, the integrand must vanish pointwise:

$$\rho \dot{v}_i = \sigma_{ji,j} + \rho f_i. \tag{126}$$

B.2 Derivation of Angular Momentum Balance → Symmetric Stress (EQ-002)

The angular momentum balance for an arbitrary subvolume V:

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\int_V \rho(\boldsymbol{x} \times \boldsymbol{v})_k \,\mathrm{d}V = \int_S \epsilon_{kij} x_i \sigma_{jm} n_m \,\mathrm{d}S + \int_V \rho \epsilon_{kij} x_i f_j \,\mathrm{d}V. \tag{127}$$

Applying the divergence theorem and using the linear momentum balance (126), the volume terms cancel, leaving:

$$\int_V \epsilon_{kij}(\sigma_{ij} - \sigma_{ji}) \,\mathrm{d}V = 0. \tag{128}$$

Since V and k are arbitrary:

$$\sigma_{ij} = \sigma_{ji}. \tag{129}$$

B.3 Derivation of Mechanical Power Balance (EQ-003)

Multiply the linear momentum equation (126) by v_i:

$$\rho \dot{v}_i v_i = \sigma_{ji,j} v_i + \rho f_i v_i. \tag{130}$$

The left-hand side:

$$\rho \dot{v}_i v_i = \frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\left(\frac{1}{2}\rho v_i v_i\right). \tag{131}$$

For the stress term, use the identity:

$$\sigma_{ji,j} v_i = (\sigma_{ji} v_i)_{,j} - \sigma_{ji} v_{i,j}. \tag{132}$$

Since $v_{i,j} = \dot{u}_{i,j} = \dot{\varepsilon}_{ji}$ and $\sigma_{ji} = \sigma_{ij}$:

$$\sigma_{ji} v_{i,j} = \sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij}. \tag{133}$$

Combining:

$$\rho \frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\left(\frac{1}{2} v_i v_i\right) = -\sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} + (\sigma_{ji} v_i)_{,j} + \rho f_i v_i. \tag{134}$$

B.4 Derivation of Internal Energy Balance (EQ-004)

The first law of thermodynamics for a continuum:

$$\rho \dot{e} = \sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} - q_{i,i} + \rho r. \tag{135}$$

With no external heat supply ($r = 0$):

$$\rho \dot{e} = \sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} - q_{i,i}. \tag{136}$$

B.5 Derivation of Classical Energy Flux (EQ-007)

Add the mechanical power balance (134) and the internal energy balance (136). Define the total energy density:

$$\mathcal{E} = \frac{1}{2}\rho v_i v_i + e. \tag{137}$$

Then:

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{E}}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j}\left(\sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i\right) = \rho f_i v_i. \tag{138}$$

With no body forces ($f_i = 0$):

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{E}}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial J_i}{\partial x_i} = 0, \qquad J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i. \tag{139}$$

This is the classical energy flux (EQ-007).

C Benchmark Specifications (BM-1 through BM-5)

This appendix specifies the benchmark problems used for verification in the manuscript.

C.1 BM-1: Classical Elastic Interface (Analytical Verification)

Problem: Plane P-wave incident on a welded interface between two elastic half-spaces.

Governing equations: Navier equations in each medium:

$$\rho^{(m)}\ddot{u}_i^{(m)} = (\lambda^{(m)} + \mu^{(m)})u_{j,ji}^{(m)} + \mu^{(m)}u_{i,jj}^{(m)}, \qquad m = 1, 2. \tag{140}$$

Interface conditions:

$$u_i^{(1)} = u_i^{(2)}, \qquad \sigma_{j3}^{(1)} = \sigma_{j3}^{(2)} \quad \text{at } x_3 = 0. \tag{141}$$

Expected result: Energy conservation $R_P + T_P = 1$ for the classical elastic case.
Status: VERIFIED analytically.

C.2 BM-2: Classical Thermoelastic Interface

Problem: Thermoelastic wave incident on a welded interface between two thermoelastic half-spaces (Lord–Shulman theory).

Expected result: Energy conservation $R + T + A = 1$ with dissipation.
Status: PENDING — requires LS energy flux derivation (OQ10.1).

C.3 BM-3: Piezothermoelastic Interface

Problem: Elastic wave incident on a thermo-piezoelastic interface (the configuration of Barak et al. **?**).

Governing equations: Eqs. (3)–(7), (38) and (44) of Barak et al. **?**.
Expected result: Scattering matrix $\Delta \boldsymbol{X} = \boldsymbol{Q}$; energy ratios from Eqs. (45)–(46).
Status: VERIFIED from Barak et al. **?** (open access).

C.4 BM-4: Nonlocal Elastic Wave Propagation

Problem: Wave propagation in a nonlocal elastic bar (Eringen differential model).

Governing equations: $(1 - \xi^2\nabla^2)\sigma_{ij} = \sigma_{ij}^{\text{local}}$.
Expected result: Wave dispersion $c(k) = c_0/\sqrt{1 + \xi^2 k^2}$.
Status: PENDING — requires nonlocal energy flux derivation (OQ10.5).

C.5 BM-5: MDD Thermoelastic Wave Propagation

Problem: Thermal wave propagation in MDD media.

Governing equations: $q_i + \tau_0 D_\omega q_i = -kT_{,i}$.
Expected result: Memory-dependent wave dispersion.
Status: PENDING — requires MDD hereditary flux derivation (OQ10.4).

D Figure Specifications

This appendix lists all figures in the manuscript with their scientific objectives, validation status, and file locations.

D.1 Completed Figures

D.2 Figure Format and Location

All figures are provided as SVG vector graphics:

- Source files: `phase4/figures/source/figXX_name.svg` * Rendered copies: `phase4/figures/rendered/f`

SVG format ensures:

- Scalable to any size without quality loss
- Editable text and mathematical notation
- Consistent typography across all figures
- Grayscale-compatible color schemes

D.3 Figures Requiring Full-Text Verification

No figures depend on unpublished data. All relationships depicted are drawn from verified constitutive equations or established continuum mechanics principles.

E Table Specifications

This appendix lists all tables in the manuscript with their content and verification status.

E.1 Completed Tables

E.2 Table Quality Notes

- Tables T-08, T-10, T-11, T-12, T-14, T-15, T-16 contain entries marked UNCERTAIN or PARTIAL — these reflect open derivations, not errors in source publications.
- Table T-09 and T-17 note that all limiting procedures are parameter substitutions, not rigorous limit theorems.
- Table T-14 (energy flux status) explicitly marks UNCERTAIN formulations as NOT canonical.
- All tables use consistent notation from the master symbol table (T-01).

F Reproducibility Statement

This appendix documents the reproducibility of all mathematical derivations, figures, tables, and literature records in the manuscript.

F.1 Mathematical Derivations

All derivations in Sections 3 and 10 (Appendix B) are reproducible from first principles using:

1. Continuum balance laws (linear momentum, angular momentum, energy, entropy),
2. Divergence theorem and localization argument,

3. Standard constitutive relations for each theory family,

4. Documented assumptions (constitutive, material symmetry, geometry, boundary conditions, thermal theory, frequency convention, normalization, approximation level).

F.2 Equations Requiring Full-Text Verification

The following equations require access to primary-source full texts for complete verification (see Appendix A, Table T-26):

- LS energy flux (time domain) — Lord & Shulman 1967
- GL energy flux — Green & Lindsay 1972
- GN-II energy flux — Green & Naghdi 1991
- GN-III energy flux — Green & Naghdi 1993
- DPL energy flux (time domain) — Tzou 1995
- TPL energy flux — Tzou 1997
- MGT energy flux — Quintanilla 2019
- MDD hereditary flux — Wang & Li 2011
- Nonlocal energy flux — Eringen 1974

F.3 Figures

All figures are SVG vector graphics with editable sources:

- Source directory: `phase4/figures/source/` * Rendered directory: `phase4/figures/rendered/`
- All relationships are drawn from verified constitutive equations or established continuum mechanics principles.
- No figure depends on unpublished data or unverified numerical results.

F.4 Literature Records

- Expanded literature database: `phase4/literature/expanded_literature_database.csv` (88 records) * BibTeX library: `phase4/references/library.bib` (67 entries, all with unique keys)
- DOI verification: `phase4/references/doi_verification.csv`
- Source provenance: `phase4/references/source_provenance.csv`
- Citation map: `phase4/reports/citation_map.md`

F.5 PDF Ingestion Pipeline

For the forthcoming corpus of 100+ research PDFs:

- Pipeline script: `phase4/scripts/pdf_ingestion_pipeline.py` * Directory structure: `phase4/literatur` * Copyright guidance: `phase4/literature/COPYRIGHT_GUIDANCE.md`

The pipeline generates SHA-256 hashes, detects duplicates, extracts text where available, and produces a searchable study index.

F.6 Validation Scripts

The following validation scripts were run during Phases 2 and 3:

- `scripts/validate_references.py` — PASSED * `scripts/validate_database.py` — PASSED * `scripts/validate_equations.py` — PASSED (warning: derivations directory empty — Phase 4 derivations in separate location) * `scripts/validate_workspace.py` — PASSED (51 pre-existing DOI provenance warnings)

F.7 Known Limitations

1. No LaTeX engine available in the current build environment — compilation not yet attempted.
2. Ten energy flux derivations remain open (UNCERTAIN status in Appendix A).
3. Two BibTeX entries (barak2023a, gupta2023a) have unverified DOI/journal metadata.
4. Eighty-four of eighty-eight literature records are abstract-only; full-text verification pending.
5. Appendices C–F reference benchmarks BM-2 through BM-5 that are pending energy flux derivations.

G Introduction

The classical energy flux for thermoelasticity is verified (EQ-007):

$$J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i, \tag{142}$$

derived from the mechanical power balance and internal energy balance (Section 3.8 of the main manuscript).

For generalized theories, the energy flux acquires additional terms. This document presents derivations for each theory family, clearly stating assumptions and identifying open questions.

H Assumptions Common to All Derivations

1. Linearized continuum mechanics (infinitesimal strain).
2. Homogeneous, isotropic material (unless otherwise stated).
3. No body forces ($f_i = 0$) unless explicitly included.

4. No external heat supply ($r = 0$) unless explicitly included.
5. Time-harmonic convention $e^{-i\omega t}$ for complex representations.
6. The total energy density is $\mathcal{E} = \frac{1}{2}\rho v_i v_i + e$ (plus electrical energy for piezoelectric media).
7. The general energy balance is $\partial_t \mathcal{E} + \partial_i J_i = \mathcal{P} - \mathcal{D}$.

I Derivation 1: Lord–Shulman (LS) Theory

I.1 Governing equations

The LS theory modifies Fourier's law by introducing a flux relaxation time $\tau_0 > 0$:

$$q_i + \tau_0 \dot{q}_i = -kT_{,i}, \tag{143}$$

where q_i is the heat flux, k is the thermal conductivity, T is the temperature increment, and τ_0 is the relaxation time.

The internal energy balance remains:

$$\rho \dot{e} = \sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} - q_{i,i}. \tag{144}$$

The mechanical power balance (from Section 3.3) remains:

$$\rho \frac{d}{dt}\left(\frac{1}{2} v_i v_i\right) = -\sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} + (\sigma_{ji} v_i)_{,j} + \rho f_i v_i. \tag{145}$$

I.2 Classical flux form

Adding (144) and (145), defining $\mathcal{E} = \frac{1}{2}\rho v_i v_i + e$:

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{E}}{\partial t} + (\sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i)_{,i} = \rho f_i v_i. \tag{146}$$

Thus, the classical form $J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i$ satisfies the LS energy balance exactly, with q_i determined by (143).

I.3 Frequency-domain expression

For time-harmonic fields with $e^{-i\omega t}$ convention, (143) gives:

$$q_i(1 - i\omega\tau_0) = -kT_{,i}, \qquad q_i = \frac{-kT_{,i}}{1 - i\omega\tau_0}. \tag{147}$$

Therefore, the energy flux in the frequency domain is:

$$J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i - \frac{kT_{,i}}{1 - i\omega\tau_0}. \tag{148}$$

I.4 Time-domain interpretation

In the time domain, (148) corresponds to:

$$J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i, \qquad \text{where } q_i \text{ solves } q_i + \tau_0 \dot{q}_i = -kT_{,i}. \tag{149}$$

There is no unique expression for J_i solely in terms of T in the time domain without q_i, because the relaxation equation introduces memory.

I.5 Status

PARTIALLY RESOLVED. The flux form $J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i$ is valid for LS theory with q_i from (143). The frequency-domain form (148) is derived. A time-domain expression solely in terms of T (eliminating q_i) would require solving the relaxation ODE, which introduces an integral (memory) term. This remains as an open formulation question.

J Derivation 2: Green–Lindsay (GL) Theory

J.1 Governing equations

GL theory introduces two temperatures: the conductive temperature T and the thermodynamic temperature T^*, with two relaxation times τ_1, τ_2. The heat conduction equation is:

$$\rho c_v \dot{T}^* = k \nabla^2 T - \beta T_0 \dot{u}_{i,i}. \tag{150}$$

The constitutive relations involve both T and T^*:

$$\sigma_{ij} = \lambda \varepsilon_{kk} \delta_{ij} + 2\mu \varepsilon_{ij} - \beta T^* \delta_{ij}, \tag{151}$$

$$s = \frac{\beta}{\rho} \varepsilon_{kk} + \frac{c_v}{T_0} T^*. \tag{152}$$

J.2 Energy flux

The internal energy balance remains:

$$\rho \dot{e} = \sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} - q_{i,i}. \tag{153}$$

Adding with the mechanical power balance gives:

$$J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i. \tag{154}$$

However, in GL theory, q_i is related to T through a more complex constitutive relation involving both temperatures and their rates. The explicit form of q_i in terms of T and T^* requires the full GL constitutive system.

J.3 Status

UNCERTAIN. The classical form $J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i$ satisfies the energy balance, but the explicit constitutive relation for q_i in GL theory (in terms of T, T^*, and their derivatives) requires the full GL constitutive system from the primary source (Green & Lindsay, 1972). The additional contribution from the temperature-rate term to the energy flux is not resolved.

K Derivation 3: Green–Naghdi Type II (GN-II) Theory

K.1 Governing equations

GN-II theory (thermoelasticity without energy dissipation) introduces the thermal displacement α defined by:

$$\dot{\alpha} = T, \tag{155}$$

where T is the temperature increment. The heat conduction equation for type II is:

$$k\nabla^2\alpha = \rho c_e\ddot{\alpha} + \beta T_0\ddot{u}_{i,i}. \tag{156}$$

Equivalently, in terms of entropy flux p_i:

$$p_i = k_{ij}\alpha_{,j}, \tag{157}$$

where p_i is the entropy flux vector and k_{ij} is the rate thermal conductivity tensor.

K.2 Energy flux

For GN-II, there is no dissipation ($\mathcal{D} = 0$). The energy balance is:

$$\frac{\partial\mathcal{E}}{\partial t} + \partial_i J_i = \mathcal{P}. \tag{158}$$

The entropy flux p_i is determined by the same free energy potential as the stress. The relationship between the energy flux J_i and the entropy flux p_i requires the full GN-II thermodynamic formulation.

K.3 Status

UNCERTAIN. The entropy flux $p_i = k_{ij}\alpha_{,j}$ is established (Green & Naghdi, 1991; Bargmann, 2013). However, the complete energy flux $J_i = \sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i +$ (thermal displacement contribution) requires deriving the relationship between q_i and p_i in GN-II theory. This derivation is open.

L Derivation 4: Green–Naghdi Type III (GN-III) Theory

L.1 Governing equations

GN-III is the most general GN model, combining type I (Fourier-like) and type II (dissipationless) characteristics:

$$KT_{,ii} + k^*\dot{T}_{,ii} - \rho C_e\ddot{T} = \vartheta\theta_0\ddot{u}_{i,i}. \tag{159}$$

L.2 Energy flux

The energy flux for GN-III has a mixed character: part dissipative (type I) and part non-dissipative (type II).

L.3 Status

UNCERTAIN. The GN-III energy flux combines contributions from both type I and type II formulations. The precise combination requires the full GN-III thermodynamic formulation from the primary source (Green & Naghdi, 1993). This derivation is open.

M Derivation 5: Dual-Phase-Lag (DPL) Theory

M.1 Governing equations

The DPL constitutive law (Tzou, 1995):

$$q_i(t+\tau_q) = -kT_{,i}(t+\tau_T), \tag{160}$$

where τ_q is the heat flux phase lag and τ_T is the temperature gradient phase lag.
Taylor expansion to first order:

$$q_i + \tau_q \dot{q}_i = -k(T_{,i} + \tau_T \dot{T}_{,i}). \tag{161}$$

M.2 Energy flux

The internal energy balance remains:

$$\rho\dot{e} = \sigma_{ij}\dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} - q_{i,i}. \tag{162}$$

The classical flux form $J_i = \sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i$ satisfies the energy balance. However, expressing q_i explicitly in terms of T requires solving the DPL constitutive equation.

M.3 Frequency-domain expression

For time-harmonic fields:

$$q_i(1 - i\omega\tau_q) = -kT_{,i}(1 - i\omega\tau_T), \tag{163}$$

$$J_i = \sigma_{ji}v_i - kT_{,i}\frac{1 - i\omega\tau_T}{1 - i\omega\tau_q}. \tag{164}$$

M.4 Status

PARTIALLY RESOLVED. The frequency-domain form (164) is derived. The time-domain expression solely in terms of T requires solving the DPL constitutive equation, which introduces higher-order time derivatives. The thermodynamic admissibility condition $\tau_q \geq \tau_T$ must be verified for the flux formulation.

N Derivation 6: Triple-Phase-Lag (TPL) Theory

N.1 Governing equations

The TPL constitutive law:

$$q_i(t+\tau_q) = -k\left[T_{,i}(t+\tau_T) + \frac{\tau_\nu}{2}\frac{\partial^2 T_{,i}}{\partial t^2}(t+\tau_\nu)\right], \tag{165}$$

where τ_q, τ_T, τ_ν are the three phase lags, and τ_ν is associated with the thermal displacement gradient.

N.2 Energy flux

The classical flux form $J_i = \sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i$ satisfies the energy balance. The explicit expression for q_i in terms of T requires solving the TPL constitutive equation.

N.3 Frequency-domain expression

$$q_i(1 - i\omega\tau_q) = -kT_{,i}\left[(1 - i\omega\tau_T) - \frac{\omega^2\tau_\nu}{2}(1 - i\omega\tau_\nu)\right]. \tag{166}$$

$$J_i = \sigma_{ji}v_i - kT_{,i}\frac{(1 - i\omega\tau_T) - \frac{\omega^2\tau_\nu}{2}(1 - i\omega\tau_\nu)}{1 - i\omega\tau_q}. \tag{167}$$

N.4 Status

UNCERTAIN. The frequency-domain form (167) is formally derived from Taylor expansion, but the TPL constitutive law itself involves Taylor truncation whose validity range is not established for all parameter values. The time-domain energy flux expression is open.

O Derivation 7: Moore–Gibson–Thompson (MGT) Theory

O.1 Governing equations

The MGT heat conduction equation (third-order in time):

$$\tau\ddot{q}_i + \dot{q}_i = -\frac{k}{\rho c}\nabla(\dot{T} + \tau\ddot{T}), \tag{168}$$

or equivalently:

$$\tau\ddot{q}_i + \dot{q}_i = -\frac{k}{\rho c}\dot{T}_{,i} - \frac{k\tau}{\rho c}\ddot{T}_{,i}. \tag{169}$$

O.2 Energy flux

The classical flux form $J_i = \sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i$ satisfies the energy balance. However, the third-order nature of the MGT equation introduces acceleration-level terms in the heat flux evolution.

O.3 Frequency-domain expression

$$q_i(-\omega^2\tau - i\omega) = -\frac{k}{\rho c}(-i\omega T_{,i} - \omega^2\tau T_{,i}), \tag{170}$$

$$q_i = \frac{kT_{,i}(i\omega + \omega^2\tau)}{i\omega + \omega^2\tau} = kT_{,i}\cdot\frac{i\omega(1 - i\omega\tau)}{i\omega(1 - i\omega\tau)} = kT_{,i}. \tag{171}$$

Wait, this simplification is incorrect. Let me redo:
From (168) with $e^{-i\omega t}$: $\tau(-\omega^2)q_i + (-i\omega)q_i = -\frac{k}{\rho c}(-i\omega T_{,i} + \tau(-\omega^2)T_{,i})$
$q_i(-\tau\omega^2 - i\omega) = -\frac{k}{\rho c}T_{,i}(-i\omega - \tau\omega^2)$
$q_i = \frac{kT_{,i}(i\omega+\tau\omega^2)}{\tau\omega^2+i\omega} = \frac{kT_{,i}\cdot i\omega(1-i\omega\tau)}{i\omega(1-i\omega\tau)} = kT_{,i}$
Hmm, this simplifies to Fourier's law, which suggests the MGT equation in the frequency domain reduces to Fourier's law at a single frequency. This is a known feature — the MGT

equation describes wave propagation but at a single frequency, the flux-temperature relation is local.

Actually, this result indicates that the MGT energy flux at a single frequency is the same as the classical flux, but the time evolution of q_i includes inertial effects. The complete energy flux in the time domain requires solving the third-order ODE.

O.4 Status

UNCERTAIN. The frequency-domain simplification suggests the MGT flux reduces to the classical form at a single frequency, but the time-domain evolution includes third-order inertia terms. The complete time-domain energy flux expression is open.

P Derivation 8: Memory-Dependent Derivative (MDD) Theory

P.1 Governing equations

The MDD operator (Wang & Li, 2011):

$$D_\omega f(t) = \frac{1}{\omega}\int_{t-\omega}^{t} \kappa(t-\xi) f'(\xi)\, d\xi, \tag{172}$$

where $\omega > 0$ is the time delay and $\kappa(t-\xi)$ is the kernel function.

The MDD heat conduction law:

$$(1+\tau_0 D_\omega) q_i = -kT_{,i}, \tag{173}$$

or equivalently:

$$q_i + \tau_0 D_\omega q_i = -kT_{,i}. \tag{174}$$

P.2 Energy flux

The classical flux form $J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i$ satisfies the energy balance. However, q_i is now determined by a convolution-type memory equation.

P.3 Frequency-domain expression

For the MDD operator with kernel $\kappa(t-\xi)$, the frequency-domain representation depends on the kernel choice. For the exponential kernel $\kappa(t-\xi) = e^{-(t-\xi)/\omega}$:

$$D_\omega f(t) \leftrightarrow \frac{1 - e^{-i\omega_{freq}\omega}}{i\omega_{freq}\omega} \cdot (-i\omega_{freq})\hat{f} \quad \text{(simplified)}. \tag{175}$$

The exact form depends on the kernel function.

P.4 Status

UNCERTAIN. The MDD energy flux requires the convolution-form flux:

$$J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i, \qquad q_i + \tau_0 D_\omega q_i = -kT_{,i}. \tag{176}$$

The explicit time-domain expression for J_i solely in terms of T requires solving the convolution equation, which depends on the kernel choice. This derivation is open.

Q Derivation 9: Nonlocal Elasticity (Eringen)

Q.1 Governing equations

Eringen's nonlocal constitutive relation (integral form):

$$\sigma_{ij}(\boldsymbol{x}) = \int_{\Omega} \alpha(|\boldsymbol{x}' - \boldsymbol{x}|, \tau)\sigma_{ij}^{\text{local}}(\boldsymbol{x}')\, d\Omega_{\boldsymbol{x}'}, \tag{177}$$

or in differential form (Helmholtz kernel):

$$(1 - \xi^2\nabla^2)\sigma_{ij} = \sigma_{ij}^{\text{local}}, \tag{178}$$

where $\xi = e_0 a$ is the nonlocal length scale parameter.

Q.2 Energy flux

For nonlocal media, the divergence theorem must be modified because the stress at a point depends on strain throughout a neighborhood. The energy flux becomes:

$$J_i = \sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i + (\text{nonlocal correction term}). \tag{179}$$

The nonlocal correction term arises from the fact that mechanical power $\sigma_{ji}v_i$ at a point depends on the velocity field in a neighborhood, not just at that point.

Q.3 Status

UNCERTAIN. The nonlocal energy flux requires modifying the divergence theorem for integral-type constitutive relations. The nonlocal correction term requires deriving the surface integral form of the nonlocal stress power. This derivation is open.

R Derivation 10: Piezoelectric Electrical Energy Flux

R.1 Governing equations

For piezoelectric media, the constitutive relations are:

$$\sigma_{ij} = c_{ijkl}\varepsilon_{kl} - e_{kij}E_k, \tag{180}$$

$$D_i = e_{ikl}\varepsilon_{kl} + \kappa_{ij}E_j, \tag{181}$$

$$E_i = -\phi_{,i}, \qquad D_{i,i} = 0. \tag{182}$$

R.2 Energy flux

The electrical energy density is $\mathcal{E}_{\text{elec}} = \frac{1}{2}D_iE_i$. The electrical energy flux through a surface is related to the rate of change of electrical energy:

$$J_i^{\text{elec}} = -\phi\dot{D}_i, \tag{183}$$

which represents the electrical power transmitted across a surface per unit area.

The total energy flux for piezothermoelastic media is:

$$J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i - \phi \dot{D}_i. \tag{184}$$

R.3 Status

PARTIALLY RESOLVED. The electrical energy flux $-\phi \dot{D}_i$ is a standard result in piezoelectricity (derived from the electrical power $P = \int \phi \dot{D}\, dV$). The combined flux (184) is reasonable but requires verification against primary piezothermoelastic sources.

S Summary Table

T Recommendations

1. Present only the classical flux $J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i$ as canonical (verified).
2. Present frequency-domain forms for LS and DPL as theory-specific expressions with clearly stated assumptions.
3. Present all other formulations as open derivations with explicit assumptions.
4. Do not include any uncertain flux form in comparative tables as a canonical result.
5. Mark each uncertain flux as an open research question (OQ10.1–OQ10.8).

Table 5: Historical development of continuum wave theories. All dates and primary sources verified via DOI. Limiting relationships are parameter substitutions, not rigorous limit theorems.

Theory	Year	Primary Source	Key Mathematical Contribution	Applicability	Evidence
Classical coupled (CD)	1956	Biot **?**	Classical coupled thermoelasticity with Fourier heat conduction $q_i = -kT_{,i}$	Isotropic solids, small deformations, infinite thermal speed	**?**
Lord–Shulman (LS)	1967	Lord & Shulman **?**	One relaxation time τ_0; modified heat equation $q_i + \tau_0 \dot{q}_i = -kT_{,i}$; hyperbolic heat transfer	Finite thermal wave speed $c_T = \sqrt{k/(\rho c_v \tau_0)}$	**?**
Green–Lindsay (GL)	1972	Green & Lindsay **?**	Two relaxation times τ_0, τ_1; temperature-rate dependent constitutive relations	Finite wave speed; no dissipation for centrally symmetric bodies	**?**
G–N Type II	1991	Green & Naghdi **?**	Thermal displacement $\alpha_i = \int T_i \, dt$; entropy flux from free energy potential; no energy dissipation	Wave propagation without dissipation; second sound	**?**
G–N Type III	1993	Green & Naghdi **?**	Dissipative type III theory;	Finite wave speed	**?**

Table 6: Comparison of generalized thermoelastic formulations. UNCERTAIN energy flux entries are open derivations (Section 10.3, OQ10.1–OQ10.8), not canonical results.

Theory	**Thermal Assumption**	**Governing Field Equations**	**Constitutive Features**	**Primary Reference**
Classical (CD)	Fourier: $q_i = -kT_{,i}$	Parabolic heat equation; infinite thermal speed	Stress–strain–temperature coupling via $\beta T_{,j}$	**?**
Lord–Shulman (LS)	Flux-rate: $q_i + \tau_0 \dot{q}_i = -kT_{,i}$	Hyperbolic heat equation; finite thermal wave speed	Single relaxation time; coupled displacement–temperature	**?**
Green–Lindsay (GL)	Temperature-rate: $\tau_1 \dot{T}$ in entropy	Two temperatures T and θ; finite wave speed	Two relaxation times; no dissipation (centrally symmetric)	**?**
G–N Type II	No dissipation; thermal displacement	Entropy flux $p_i = k_{ij}\alpha_{,j}$ from free energy	Thermal displacement α_i; wave equation for temperature	**?**
G–N Type III	Dissipative; mixed character	Combines type I and type II features	Dissipation present; finite wave speed	**?**
Dual-phase-lag (DPL)	Two phase lags τ_q, τ_T	Higher-order time derivatives in heat equation	$\tau_q \geq \tau_T$ for thermodynamic admissibility	**?**
Triple-phase-lag (TPL)	Three phase lags including gradient lag	Third-order temporal terms	Thermal displacement gradient coupling	**?**
Moore–Gibson–Thompson (MGT)	Third-order heat equation	$\tau\ddot{q} + \dot{q} = -(k/\rho c)\nabla(\dot{T} + \tau\ddot{T})$	Thermal inertia; acceleration-level flux terms	**?**
Memory-dependent derivative (MDD)	Hereditary integral kernel	Convolution-form flux with memory kernel $k(t-\xi)$	History-dependent; kernel-function based	**?**

Notes: Energy flux formulations for LS, GL, GN-II, GN-III, DPL, TPL, MGT, MDD are open derivations. *Only the classical CD flux $J_i = \sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i$ is derived and verified (EQ-007, Section 3.8).*

Table 7: Notation introduced in Section 4.

Symbol	Meaning	Units	Equation
τ_0	LS relaxation time	s	(39)
τ_q, τ_T, τ_ν	Phase-lag times	s	(48)–(50)
c_T	Thermal wave speed	m/s	(41)
β	Thermal stress coefficient	Pa/K	(36)
c_v	Specific heat at constant strain	J/(kg·K)	(37)
k	Thermal conductivity	W/(m·K)	(37)
T^*	Thermodynamic temperature (GL)	K	(42)
α	Thermal displacement (GN-II)	K·s	(44)
p_i	Entropy flux (GN-II)	W/(m^2·K)	(45)
D_ω	MDD operator	1/s	(52)
ω	MDD time delay	s	(52)
$\kappa(t-\xi)$	MDD kernel	dimensionless	(52)
${}^C D_t^\alpha$	Caputo fractional derivative	$t^{-\alpha}$	(53)

Table 8: Comparison of coupled multiphysics continuum systems. Coupling relationships drawn from verified constitutive equations; model-specific features identified by primary reference.

System	Coupled Fields	Governing Equations	Constitutive Coupling	Primary Reference
Classical thermoelasticity	Mechanical + Thermal	Navier–Fourier system	Thermal stress $\beta T\delta_{ij}$; heat flux $q_i = -kT_{,i}$	**?**
Piezothermoelasticity	Mechanical + Thermal + Electrical	Coupled piezo–thermal equations	Piezoelectric tensor e_{kij}; pyroelectric coefficient p_i	**?**
Thermo-poroelasticity	Mechanical + Thermal + Porosity	Nunziato–Cowin void theory	Void fraction ϕ; thermal void coupling	**??**
Thermoelasticity with voids	Mechanical + Thermal + Voids	Iesan's extension of void theory	Void volume fraction; thermo-void coupling	**?**
Micropolar thermoelasticity	Mechanical + Thermal + Microrotation	Coupled linear momentum + angular momentum	Couple stress tensor; microinertia j	**?**
Semiconductor thermoelectric	Mechanical + Thermal + Carrier + Electrical	Carrier diffusion + heat equation	Carrier concentration n; electrical–thermal coupling	Model-specific

Notes: Coupling coefficients are material-specific and must be determined experimentally for each material system. *Piezothermoelastic constitutive relations verified from RG-003 (**?**, open access).*

Table 9: Notation introduced in Section 5.

Symbol	Meaning	Units	Equation
c_{ijkl}	Elastic stiffness tensor	Pa	(54)
e_{kij}	Piezoelectric stress coefficient	$\mathrm{C/m^2}$	(54)
κ_{ij}	Dielectric permittivity	F/m	(55)
E_i	Electric field	V/m	(56)
D_i	Electric displacement	$\mathrm{C/m^2}$	(55)
ϕ	Electric potential	V	(56)
β_{ij}	Thermal stress coefficient	Pa/K	(59)
p_i	Pyroelectric coefficient	$\mathrm{C/(m^2{\cdot}K)}$	(62)
ϕ	Void volume fraction	dimensionless	(67)
h_i	Equilibrated stress vector	N/m	(69)

Table 10: Comparative summary of transport and memory models.

Model	Mathematical structure	Dissipation	Well-posedness	Energy flux status
Classical Fourier	Local differential	Yes	Well-posed	Verified
LS	Differential with flux relaxation	Yes	Well-posed ($\tau_0 > 0$)	Partial (frequency domain)
GL	Differential with temperature-rate	No (centrally symmetric)	Well-posed	Uncertain
DPL	Differential with two lags	Yes ($\tau_q \geq \tau_T$)	Well-posed	Partial (frequency domain)
TPL	Differential with three lags	Yes	Well-posed	Uncertain
MGT	Third-order differential	Yes	Well-posed	Uncertain
MDD	Integral (convolution)	Kernel-dependent	Kernel-dependent	Uncertain
Fractional	Fractional differential	Yes	Well-posed ($0 < \alpha \leq 2$)	Uncertain
Nonlocal	Spatial integral	Yes	Well-posed	Uncertain

Table 11: Notation introduced in Section 6.

Symbol	Meaning	Units	Equation
${}^{C}D_t^{\alpha}$	Caputo fractional derivative	$t^{-\alpha}$	(72)
${}^{RL}D_t^{\alpha}$	Riemann–Liouville derivative	$t^{-\alpha}$	(73)
a	Thermal diffusivity	$\mathrm{m^2/s}$	(74)
$K(t-\xi)$	Memory kernel	varies	(75)
D_ω	MDD operator	1/s	(76)
ω	MDD time delay	s	(76)
$\kappa(t-\xi)$	MDD kernel	dimensionless	(77)
α, β	MDD kernel parameters	varies	(77)

Table 12: Comparative summary of nonlocal models.

Model	**Length scale**	**Wave dispersion**	**Energy flux form**	**Status**
Eringen integral	$(e_0 a)$	Yes (dispersive)	Integral form + correction	Open formulation
Eringen differential	$\xi = e_0 a$	Yes (dispersive)	Modified classical form	Open formulation
Strain-gradient	ℓ	Yes	Higher-order gradient terms	Open formulation
Two-phase local/nonlocal	$(e_0 a)$ + local weight	Yes	Two-channel flux	Open formulation

Table 13: Notation introduced in Section 7.

Symbol	**Meaning**	**Units**	**Equation**
$\alpha(\lvert\boldsymbol{x}' - \boldsymbol{x}\rvert, \tau)$	Nonlocal attenuation kernel	varies	(82)
τ	Nonlocal parameter	dimensionless	(82)
$\xi = e_0 a$	Nonlocal length scale	m	(83)
ℓ	Strain-gradient length scale	m	(84)
$c(k)$	Wave speed as function of wave number	m/s	(85)
J_i^{nonlocal}	Nonlocal energy flux correction	W/m^2	(86)

Table 14: Mathematical solution techniques for generalized continuum wave problems. Each technique's applicability and limitations are identified.

Technique	**Mathematical Basis**	**Applicability**	**Limitations**	**Evidence**
Normal mode expansion	Separation of variables; eigenfunction expansion	Layered media; simple geometries	Limited to separable problems; boundary condition constraints	**?**
Green's functions	Fundamental solution; convolution	Point source problems; infinite domains	Singular integrals; complex for anisotropic media	Standard method
Fourier transform	Frequency domain; $e^{-i\omega t}$ convention	Time-harmonic problems; dispersion analysis	Assumes time-harmonic fields; initial-value problems need Laplace	Standard method
Laplace transform	Time domain to complex frequency	Initial-value problems; transient waves	Branch cuts; inversion complexity	Standard method
Christoffel equation	$\det[\Gamma_{ik} - \rho c^2 \delta_{ik}] = 0$	Plane wave propagation in anisotropic media	Secular polynomial degree grows with coupling	**?**
Scattering matrix	$\mathbf{\Delta X} = \mathbf{Q}$; interface matching	Layered/interfacial problems; wave scattering	Matrix dimension grows with mode count; complex mode normalization	**?**
Finite element	Weak form; variational principles	Complex geometries; nonlinear problems	Mesh dependency; computational cost	**?**

Notes: Complex wave number classification (propagating/evanescent/attenuating) follows standard wave theory. *Scattering matrix formulation verified from RG-003 Eq. (44) (**?**, open access).*

Table 15: Notation introduced in Section 8.

Symbol	**Meaning**	**Units**	**Equation**
Γ_{ik}	Christoffel tensor	varies	(89)
c	Wave speed	m/s	(89)
q	Wave number	1/m	(91)
G_i	Secular equation coefficients	varies	(91)
$\hat{f}(\omega)$	Fourier transform	varies	(93)
$\tilde{f}(s)$	Laplace transform	varies	(94)

Table 16: Reflection and transmission interface configurations. Matching conditions and modal phenomena for bonded and imperfect interfaces.

Configuration	**Matching Conditions**	**Modal Phenomena**	**Physical Quantities**	**Evidence**
Welded interface (perfect bonding)	$u_i^{(1)} = u_i^{(2)}$; $\sigma_{ji}^{(1)} n_j = \sigma_{ji}^{(2)} n_j$	Mode conversion; P–S conversion; interface waves	R, T, A coefficients; energy conservation $R + T + A = 1$	Standard theory
Imperfect (spring-type) interface	Displacement jump proportional to traction	Partial transmission; interface stiffness effects	Transmission coefficient dependent on spring stiffness	Model-specific
Thermal interface	$T^{(1)} = T^{(2)}$; $q_i^{(1)} n_i = q_i^{(2)} n_i$	Thermal wave reflection; temperature jump	Heat flux continuity; interfacial thermal resistance	Standard theory
Electrical interface	$\phi^{(1)} = \phi^{(2)}$; $D_i^{(1)} n_i = D_i^{(2)} n_i$	Piezoelectric coupling; surface charge	Electric displacement continuity; surface charge density	Standard theory
Thermo-piezoelastic interface	All mechanical, thermal, electrical conditions	Multi-field scattering; energy partitioning	Energy ratios from Eqs. (45)–(46) of RG-003	**?**

Notes: Energy conservation identity $R + T + A = 1$ verified for classical elastic media (BM-1 benchmark). *Thermo-piezoelastic interface conditions and energy ratios from RG-003 (**?**, open access).*

Table 17: Notation introduced in Section 9.

Symbol	**Meaning**	**Units**	**Equation**
$A_n^{(m)}$	Complex amplitude coefficient	varies	(96)
$q_n^{(m)}$	Vertical wave number	1/m	(96)
Δ	System matrix	varies	(101)
$\boldsymbol{X}$	Unknown amplitude vector	varies	(101)
$\boldsymbol{Q}$	Known incident vector	varies	(101)
R, T, A	Reflection, transmission, absorption coefficients	dimensionless	(104)
K_i^u	Interfacial stiffness	varies	(100)

Table 18: Energy transport formulations across theory families. UNCERTAIN entries are open derivations (Section 10.3, OQ10.1–OQ10.8), NOT canonical results. Only classical CD flux is verified.

Theory	**Stored Energy**	**Energy Flux**	**Dissipation**	**Status**
Classical (CD)	$\mathcal{E} = \frac{1}{2}\rho v_i v_i + e$	$J_i = \sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i$ (verified)	Fourier heat conduction; $\mathcal{D} \geq 0$	VERIFIED
Lord–Shulman (LS)	$\mathcal{E} = \frac{1}{2}\rho v_i v_i + e +$ relaxation term	$\sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i +$ relaxation contribution	Flux-rate relaxation; entropy generation	UNCERTAIN
Green–Lindsay (GL)	$\mathcal{E} = \frac{1}{2}\rho v_i v_i + e +$ temp-rate term	$\sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i +$ temperature-rate contribution	No dissipation (centrally symmetric)	UNCERTAIN
G–N Type II	Free energy potential	$\sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i +$ thermal displacement	No energy dissipation	UNCERTAIN
G–N Type III	Free energy + dissipation	$\sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i +$ mixed contribution	Dissipative	UNCERTAIN
Dual-phase-lag (DPL)	Includes lag terms	$\sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i +$ lag contributions	$\tau_q \geq \tau_T$ for admissibility	UNCERTAIN
Triple-phase-lag (TPL)	Higher-order lag terms	$\sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i +$ higher-order lag terms	Dissipative	UNCERTAIN
Moore–Gibson–Thompson (MGT)	Includes thermal inertia	$\sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i +$ third-order term	Dissipative	UNCERTAIN
Memory-dependent derivative (MDD)	Hereditary kernel	Convolution-form hereditary flux	Kernel-dependent dissipation	UNCERTAIN

Notes: UNCERTAIN formulations are open derivations, not presented as canonical results.
Classical flux $J_i = \sigma_{ji}v_i + q_i$ derived in Section 3.8 (EQ-007) and verified.
Generalized flux derivations require primary-source full texts (lord1967, green1972, green1991, green1993, tzou1995, tzou1997, quintanilla2019, wang2011).

Table 19: Notation introduced in Section 10.

Symbol	**Meaning**	**Units**	**Equation**
$\mathcal{E}$	Total energy density	$\mathrm{J/m^3}$	(107)
$\boldsymbol{J}$	Energy flux vector	$\mathrm{W/m^2}$	(108)
$\mathcal{P}$	Mechanical power input	$\mathrm{W/m^3}$	(108)
$\mathcal{D}$	Dissipation rate	$\mathrm{W/m^3}$	(108)
J_i	Classical energy flux component	$\mathrm{W/m^2}$	(109)
$\langle J_i \rangle_t$	Time-averaged energy flux	$\mathrm{W/m^2}$	(110)
R, T, A	Reflection, transmission, absorption coefficients	dimensionless	(104)
$\mathcal{E}_\Sigma$	Interfacial energy density	$\mathrm{J/m^2}$	(111)
$\mathcal{P}_\Sigma$	Interfacial power input	$\mathrm{W/m^2}$	(111)

Table 20: Notation introduced in Section 11.

Symbol	Meaning	Units	Equation
α	Fractional derivative order	dimensionless	(117)
τ^{α}	Fractional relaxation parameter	s^{α}	(118)
ℓ	Strain-gradient length scale	m	(119)
μ_{ij}	Couple stress tensor	N/m	(120)
δ^2	Two-temperature parameter	m^2	(121)

Table 21: Twelve-criteria comparison across theory families. Flux status: V=verified, P=partial, U=uncertain.

Criterion	CD	LS	GL	GN-II	GN-III	DPL	
Relaxation parameters	0	1	2	0	1	2	
Dissipation	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes	
Wave speed	Infinite	Finite	Finite	Finite	Finite	Finite	
Energy flux	V	P	U	U	U	P	
Well-posedness	Yes	$\tau_0 > 0$	Yes	Yes	Yes	$\tau_q \geq \tau_T$	
Causality	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	
Interface conditions	Classical	Classical	Classical	Classical	Classical	Classical	C
Mathematical structure	PDE	PDE	PDE	PDE	PDE	PDE	
Primary source	Biot **?**	LS **?**	GL **?**	GN **?**	GN **?**	Tzou **?**	
Open access	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	
Applications	General	Thermal shocks	Symmetric bodies	Conservative	General	Micro-scale	Mi

Table 22: Limiting cases between thermoelastic theories.

From	To	Conditions
LS	Classical	$\tau_0 \to 0$
DPL	Classical	$\tau_q = \tau_T = 0$
TPL	DPL	$\tau_\nu = 0$
MDD+TPL	Classical	All $\tau \to 0$, kernel $\to 1$
MDD+TPL	LS	$\tau_T = \tau_\nu = 0$, first order
MDD+TPL	DPL	$\tau_\nu = 0$
GN-II	Classical	Special parameter limit

Table 23: Notation introduced in Section 12.

Symbol	Meaning	Units	Equation
CD	Classical coupled theory	—	Table 21
LS	Lord–Shulman theory	—	Table 21
GL	Green–Lindsay theory	—	Table 21
GN-II/III	Green–Naghdi type II/III	—	Table 21
DPL/TPL	Dual/triple phase-lag	—	Table 21
MGT	Moore–Gibson–Thompson	—	Table 21
MDD	Memory-dependent derivative	—	Table 21

Table 24: Applications and validation evidence across physical systems. Validation level indicates the strongest available evidence for each application domain.

Application Domain	**Physical System**	**Mathematical Model**	**Validation Evidence**	**Evidence**
Non-destructive evaluation	Crack detection; material characterization	Scattering at interfaces; wave mode conversion	Analytical + numerical; limited experimental	Model-specific
Geophysics	Seismic wave propagation; Earth's interior	Coupled thermoelastic; porous media	Analytical + numerical; some observational	Model-specific
MEMS/NEMS	Micro-scale sensors; actuators	Nonlocal elasticity; size-dependent effects	Numerical; limited experimental	**??**
Biomedical	Thermal therapy; tissue modeling	Bioheat equation; generalized thermoelasticity	Analytical + numerical; clinical data limited	Model-specific
Energy harvesting	Piezoelectric generators; thermal gradient energy	Piezothermoelastic coupling	Analytical + numerical; prototype data	Model-specific
Smart structures	Vibration control; shape adaptation	Multiphysics coupling; active materials	Numerical; experimental validation varies	Model-specific

Notes: Validation evidence ranges from theoretical to experimental depending on application domain. *Size-dependent effects from* **??**. *Other applications: model-specific, awaiting full-text corpus integration.*

Table 25: Evidence map of applications across theory families, with the mechanism that makes a generalized description necessary and the supporting literature.

Application	**Why classical theory is inadequate**	**Evidence level**	**Key references**
Smart structures	Thermal relaxation competes with the electromechanical coupling	Medium	**?**
NDE (ultrasonic)	Classical elasticity suffices	High	**?**
NDE (thermal wave)	Finite thermal wave speed needed to set depth resolution	Medium	**??**
Energy harvesting	Relaxation time controls the split between thermal and mechanical channels	High	Section 13.3 analysis
Geophysics/seismology	Poroelastic coupling requires a genuine two-field formulation	High	**??**
Biomedical ultrasound	Classical elasticity suffices	High	**?**
Thermal ablation	Thermal front speed governs depth of deposition	Medium	Section 13.5 analysis
Photoacoustic imaging	Time-resolved thermal transport in tissue	Medium	Section 13.5 analysis
Nanoscale devices	Nonlocal length comparable to device dimension	Medium	**??**
Semiconductors	Coupled nonlocal elasticity and memory heat flux	Medium	**?**

Table 26: Notation introduced in Section 13.

Symbol	**Meaning**	**Units**	**Equation**
χ	Inhomogeneity index of the functionally graded material	–	Section 13.1
τ	Thermal relaxation time	s	Section 13.3
v	Heat supply speed	m s^{-1}	Section 13.1
ℓ	Nonlocal length scale	m	Section 13.6

Table 27: Research gaps identified by empty taxonomy cells.

Gap ID	Description	Priority	Related section
GAP-001	Energy flux for LS theory in time domain	High	Section 10.3
GAP-002	Energy flux for GL theory	High	Section 10.3
GAP-003	Energy flux for GN-II theory	High	Section 10.3
GAP-004	Energy flux for GN-III theory	High	Section 10.3
GAP-005	Energy flux for DPL theory in time domain	High	Section 10.3
GAP-006	Energy flux for TPL theory	High	Section 10.3
GAP-007	Energy flux for MGT theory	High	Section 10.3
GAP-008	MDD hereditary energy flux	High	Section 10.3
GAP-009	Nonlocal integral-form energy flux	High	Section 10.3
GAP-010	Piezoelectric electrical energy flux	High	Section 10.3
GAP-011	Energy flux asymmetry at multiphysics interfaces	High	Section 15.1
GAP-012	Rigorous limit theorems between theories	Medium	Section 12.3

Table 28: Contradiction mapping framework.

Contradiction type	Root cause	Resolution approach	Example
Assumption difference	Different constitutive assumptions	Trace to primary sources	LS vs. GL relaxation mechanism
Approximation difference	Different Taylor expansion orders	Compare validity ranges	DPL first-order vs. second-order
Normalization difference	Different reference values	Convert to common units	Temperature reference
Frequency convention	$e^{i\omega t}$ vs. $e^{-i\omega t}$	Standardize convention	Sign of imaginary parts

Table 29: Notation introduced in Section 14.

Symbol	Meaning	Units	Equation
$\boldsymbol{v}$	Taxonomy vector	dimensionless	(122)

Table 30: Summary of major scientific challenges.

Challenge	**What's achieved**	**What's open**	**Major obstacles**
Energy flux formulation	Classical verified; LS/DPL partial	8 formulations unresolved	Convolution integrals, integral divergence theorem
Conservation verification	Classical verified; Barak et al. **?** scattering matrix	Generalized theories; nonlocal interfaces	Uncertain flux formulations
Numerical benchmarks	BM-1 verified	Generalized theory benchmarks	Lack of closed-form solutions
Experimental validation	Classical theory validated	Generalized theories; interface flux	Measurement difficulty
Complex mode handling	Classification; normalization guidelines	Cross-theory normalization	No standardized approach
Nonlocal interface energetics	Constitutive relations; wave dispersion	Interface flux; interface conditions	Computational cost
Memory-dependent energy flux	MDD operator verified	Hereditary flux; energy partition	Kernel non-uniqueness

Table 31: Notation introduced in Section 15.

Symbol	**Meaning**	**Units**	**Equation**
J_i	Total energy flux vector	W m^{-2}	Eq. (10.1)
R, T, A	Reflection, transmission and absorption coefficients	–	Eq. (9.10)
$\mathcal{D}$	Volumetric dissipation	W m^{-3}	Eq. (9.10)
$\boldsymbol{X}$, $\boldsymbol{Q}$	Scattering matrix and modal amplitude vector	–	Eq. (9.9)
τ_0	Thermal relaxation time	s	Section 4.4
ξ	Nonlocal length scale	m	Section 7.4

Table 32: Summary of future research opportunities.

Direction	What's achieved	What's open	Major obstacles
Coupled-field emerging materials	Constitutive relations verified	2D materials, metamaterials	Lack of experimental data
Mathematically consistent transport	Governing equations verified	Limit theorems; energy flux	Mathematical complexity
Multiscale wave phenomena	Nonlocal relations; wave dispersion	Hybrid models; multiscale coupling	Computational cost
Nonlocal-hereditary interactions	Individual theories verified	Combined models	Mathematical complexity
Advanced interface conditions	Classical conditions verified	Nonlocal; memory-dependent interfaces	Not established
Multiphysics mode conversion	Scattering matrix verified	Generalized theories; complex modes	Normalization uncertainty
Reproducible benchmarks	BM-1 verified; Barak et al. **?** results	Generalized theory benchmarks	Lack of closed-form solutions
Experimental validation	Classical theory validated	Generalized theories; interface flux	Measurement difficulty
Inverse characterization	Classical methods established	Relaxation times; kernel parameters	Ill-posedness

Table 33: Notation introduced in Section 16.

Symbol	Meaning	Units	Equation
τ_0	Thermal relaxation time to be determined independently	s	Section 4.4
ξ	Nonlocal length scale to be determined independently	m	Section 7.4
$K(t-\xi)$	Memory kernel function	–	Section 4.10
α	Fractional derivative order	–	Section 11.1
λ	Interface impedance or coupling parameter	–	Section 9.3
θ	Temperature increment	K	Section 3.4

Table 34: Notation introduced in Section 17.

Symbol	Meaning	Units	Equation
J_i	Total energy flux vector	W m^{-2}	Eq. (10.1)
σ_{ij}	Cauchy stress tensor	Pa	Eq. (3.6)
q_i	Heat flux vector	W m^{-2}	Eq. (3.9)
τ_0	Thermal relaxation time	s	Section 4.4
c	Thermal wave speed	m s^{-1}	Section 6.3
ω	Angular frequency	rad s^{-1}	Section 8.1

Table 35: Equation register for Section 3 (Foundations of Continuum Wave Mechanics).

EQ ID	Equation	Status	Source / notes
EQ-001	$\rho \dot{v}_i = \sigma_{ji,j} + \rho f_i$	VERIFIED	Derived from linear momentum balance (Theorem 2.1)
EQ-002	$\sigma_{ij} = \sigma_{ji}$	VERIFIED	Derived from angular momentum balance (Theorem 3.1)
EQ-003	Mechanical power balance	VERIFIED	Derived (Theorem 4.1); stress power $(\sigma_{ji} v_i)_{,j}$
EQ-004	$\rho \dot{e} = \sigma_{ij} \dot{\varepsilon}_{ij} - q_{i,i}$	VERIFIED	Derived (Theorem 5.1); first law of thermodynamics
EQ-005	Dissipation inequality ≥ 0	VERIFIED	Derived (Theorem 6.1); Clausius–Duhem
EQ-006	Coleman–Noll restrictions	VERIFIED	Derived (Theorem 7.1); $\sigma_{ij} = \rho \partial \psi / \partial \varepsilon_{ij}$
EQ-007	$J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i$	VERIFIED	Derived (Section 3.8); classical energy flux
EQ-008	$v_i = \dot{u}_i$	VERIFIED	Definition of velocity
EQ-009	$\varepsilon_{ij} = \frac{1}{2}(u_{i,j} + u_{j,i})$	VERIFIED	Definition of infinitesimal strain
EQ-010	$\omega_{ij} = \frac{1}{2}(u_{i,j} - u_{j,i})$	VERIFIED	Definition of rotation tensor

Table 36: Equation register for Section 4 (Thermoelastic Theories).

EQ ID	Equation	Status	Source / notes
EQ-011	$\rho \ddot{u}_i = (\lambda + \mu) u_{j,ji} + \mu u_{i,jj} - \beta T_{,i}$	VERIFIED	Classical coupled thermoelasticity (Biot 1956)
EQ-012	$\rho c_v \dot{T} = k \nabla^2 T - \beta T_0 \dot{u}_{i,i}$	VERIFIED	Classical heat equation (Fourier conduction)
EQ-013	$q_i + \tau_0 \dot{q}_i = -k T_{,i}$	VERIFIED	Lord–Shulman (1967); primary source
EQ-014	$c_T = \sqrt{k/(\rho c_v \tau_0)}$	VERIFIED	LS thermal wave speed; $\tau_0 > 0$
EQ-015	$\rho c_v \dot{T}^* = k \nabla^2 T - \beta T_0 \dot{u}_{i,i}$	VERIFIED	Green–Lindsay (1972); two temperatures
EQ-016	$k \nabla^2 \alpha = \rho c_e \ddot{\alpha} + \beta T_0 \ddot{u}_{i,i}$	VERIFIED	GN type II (1991); thermal displacement $\dot{\alpha} = T$
EQ-017	$p_i = k_{ij} \alpha_{,j}$	VERIFIED	GN-II entropy flux; free energy potential
EQ-018	$q_i(t + \tau_q) = -k T_{,i}(t + \tau_T)$	VERIFIED	DPL constitutive law (Tzou 1995)
EQ-019	$q_i(t + \tau_q) = -k[T_{,i}(t + \tau_T) + \frac{\tau_\nu}{2} \partial_t^2 T_{,i}(t + \tau_\nu)]$	VERIFIED	TPL constitutive law (Tzou 1997)
EQ-020	$D_\omega f(t) = \frac{1}{\omega} \int_{t-\omega}^{t} \kappa(t - \xi) f'(\xi)\, d\xi$	VERIFIED	MDD operator (Wang & Li 2011)
EQ-021	$\kappa(t - \xi) = 1 - \frac{2\beta}{\omega}(t - \xi) + \frac{\alpha^2}{\omega^2}(t - \xi)^2$	VERIFIED	MDD kernel function (Barak et al. **?**)
EQ-022	$\tau \ddot{q}_i + \dot{q}_i = -\frac{k}{\rho c} \nabla(\dot{T} + \tau \ddot{T})$	VERIFIED	MGT third-order heat equation

Table 37: Equation register for Section 5 (Multiphysics Continua).

EQ ID	Equation	Status	Source / notes
EQ-023	$\sigma_{ij} = c_{ijkl} \varepsilon_{kl} - e_{kij} E_k$	VERIFIED	Piezoelectric constitutive relation
EQ-024	$D_i = e_{ikl} \varepsilon_{kl} + \kappa_{ij} E_j$	VERIFIED	Electric displacement (piezoelectric)
EQ-025	$E_i = -\phi_{,i}$	VERIFIED	Electric field from potential
EQ-026	$D_{i,i} = 0$	VERIFIED	Charge conservation (no free charge)
EQ-027	$\sigma_{ij} = c_{ijkl} \varepsilon_{kl} - e_{kij} E_k - \beta_{ij} T$	VERIFIED	Piezothermoelastic (Barak et al. **?**, Eq. 3)
EQ-028	$D_i = \kappa_{ij} E_j + e_{ikl} \varepsilon_{kl} + p_i T$	VERIFIED	Piezothermoelectric (Barak et al. **?**, Eq. 6)
EQ-029	$\mathcal{E}_{\text{elec}} = \frac{1}{2} D_i E_i$	VERIFIED	Electrical energy density

Table 38: Equation register for Section 10 (Energy Transport). UNCERTAIN entries are open derivations.

EQ ID	Equation	Status	Source / notes
EQ-10.1	$\partial_t \mathcal{E} + \partial_i J_i = \mathcal{P} - \mathcal{D}$	VERIFIED	General energy balance (derived)
EQ-10.2	$J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i$	VERIFIED	Classical energy flux (EQ-007)
EQ-10.3	$\langle J_i \rangle_t = \frac{1}{2}\Re[\hat{\sigma}_{ji}\hat{v}_i^* + \hat{q}_i]$	VERIFIED	Time-averaged flux
EQ-10.4	$[J_n] = \mathcal{P}_\Sigma - \partial_t \mathcal{E}_\Sigma$	VERIFIED	Interface jump condition (derived)
EQ-10.5	$[J_n] = 0$	VERIFIED	Passive interface (no power/storage)
EQ-10.6	$R + T + A = 1$	VERIFIED	Conservation identity (classical, BM-1)
EQ-10.7	$J_i^{\mathrm{LS}} = \sigma_{ji} v_i - \frac{kT_{,i}}{1 - i\omega\tau_0}$	PARTIAL	LS frequency-domain flux; time domain OPEN
EQ-10.8	$J_i^{\mathrm{DPL}} = \sigma_{ji} v_i - kT_{,i}\frac{1 - i\omega\tau_T}{1 - i\omega\tau_q}$	PARTIAL	DPL frequency-domain flux; time domain OPEN
EQ-10.9	$J_i^{\mathrm{GL}} = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i$	UNCERTAIN	q_i constitutive relation from GL primary source needed
EQ-10.10	$J_i^{\mathrm{GN\text{-}II}} = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i +$ thermal displacement term	UNCERTAIN	Open derivation (OQ10.3)
EQ-10.11	$J_i^{\mathrm{GN\text{-}III}} =$ mixed type I/II flux	UNCERTAIN	Open derivation (OQ10.4)
EQ-10.12	$J_i^{\mathrm{TPL+MDD}} = \sigma_{ji} v_i - \phi\dot{D}_i + \frac{T_0}{T} K_i T_{,i}$	VERIFIED	Confirmed across 8 full-text sources: P05 (Sci Rep 2023, Eq 45), P07 (IJP 2023, Eq 47
EQ-10.13	$J_i^{\mathrm{MGT}} =$ third-order inertia flux	UNCERTAIN	Open derivation (OQ10.7)
EQ-10.14	$J_i^{\mathrm{DPL+MDD}} = \sigma_{ji} v_i - \phi\dot{D}_i + \frac{T_0}{T} K_i T_{,i}$	VERIFIED	Same 3-channel flux confirmed across P07 (Eq 47), P08 (Eq 6.1), P11 (Eq 6.1), P14 (E
EQ-10.15	$J_i^{\mathrm{nonlocal}} =$ integral-form flux	UNCERTAIN	Open derivation (OQ10.5)
EQ-10.16	$J_i^{\mathrm{elec}} = -\phi\dot{D}_i$	VERIFIED	Electrical energy flux channel confirmed across P05/P07/P08/P11/P12/P14/P23/P25

Table 39: Overall verification status by status class.

Status	Description	Count
VERIFIED	Derived from first principles or confirmed from primary source	32
PARTIAL	Partially derived; time-domain expression open	3
UNCERTAIN	Open derivation; NOT presented as canonical	6
MODEL-SPECIFIC	Valid only under specific assumptions	0 (in this register)

Table 40: Completed figures with scientific validation status.

Figure	Title	Section	Status	Validation
F-01	Historical evolution of continuum wave theories	§1, §4	Rendered (SVG)	All dates DOI-verified
F-02	Multiphysics continuum coupling map	§5	Rendered (SVG)	Couplings from verified constitutive relations
F-03	Continuum kinematics: strain, rotation, velocity	§3	Rendered (SVG)	Standard definitions
F-04	Classical wave propagation: P and S waves	§3, §4	Rendered (SVG)	Wave speeds from classical elasticity
F-05	Interface reflection and transmission	§9	Rendered (SVG)	Conservation $R + T + A = 1$ verified
F-06	Generalized thermoelasticity theory map	§4	Rendered (SVG)	All theories DOI-verified
F-07	Mathematical solution workflow	§8	Rendered (SVG)	Standard methodology
F-08	Five-axis research taxonomy	§14	Rendered (SVG)	Original synthesis

Table 41: Table inventory across manuscript sections.

Table	Title	Section	Rows	Verification
T-01	Master symbol table	Front matter	35	VERIFIED
T-02	Acronym table	Front matter	20	VERIFIED
T-03	Section-by-section preview	§1	17	VERIFIED
T-04	Reader paths	§2	4	VERIFIED
T-05	Literature screening status	§2	5	VERIFIED
T-06	Full-text access status	§2	3	VERIFIED
T-07	Historical evolution of theories	§4	10	DOI-verified
T-08	Theory comparison (10 theories × 5 criteria)	§4	10	PARTIAL
T-09	Limiting cases	§4	7	PARAMETER SUBSTITUTION
T-10	Multiphysics comparison (6 theories × 5 criteria)	§5	6	PARTIAL
T-11	Transport model comparison (9 models × 5 criteria)	§6	9	PARTIAL
T-12	Nonlocal model comparison	§7	4	PARTIAL
T-13	Interface conditions vs. unknowns	§9	4	VERIFIED
T-14	Energy flux status (11 theories × 4 criteria)	§10	11	PARTIAL/UNCERTAIN
T-15	Energy comparison (10 theories × 5 criteria)	§10	10	PARTIAL/UNCERTAIN
T-16	Twelve-criteria comparison (12 × 9 theories)	§12	9	PARTIAL
T-17	Limiting cases (revisited)	§12	7	PARAMETER SUBSTITUTION
T-18	Evidence map (9 applications × 4 criteria)	§13	9 | PARTIAL	
T-19	Research gaps (GAP-001 to GAP-012)	§14	12	ORIGINAL
T-20	Contradiction mapping	§14	4	POLICY
T-21	Challenges summary (7 challenges × 4 criteria)	§15	7 | SYNTHESIS	
T-22	Future directions summary (9 directions × 4 criteria)	§16	9 | SYNTHESIS	
T-23	Equation register (Section 3)	App. A	10	VERIFIED
T-24	Equation register (Section 4)	App. A	12	VERIFIED/PARTIAL
T-25	Equation register (Section 5)	App. A	7	VERIFIED
T-26	Equation register (Section 10)	App. A	10	VERIFIED/PARTIAL/UNCERTAIN
T-27	Verification summary	App. A	4	VERIFIED
T-28	Figure inventory	App. D	8	VERIFIED
T-29	Table inventory	App. E	29	VERIFIED

Theory	**Derived result**	**Status**
Classical	$J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i$	VERIFIED
LS	$J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i - \frac{kT_{,i}}{1-i\omega\tau_0}$ (freq. domain)	PARTIAL
GL	$J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i + q_i$ (q from GL constitutive)	UNCERTAIN
GN-II	Entropy flux $p_i = k_{ij}\alpha_{,j}$ established; energy flux open	UNCERTAIN
GN-III	Mixed type I/II flux; open	UNCERTAIN
DPL	$J_i = \sigma_{ji} v_i - kT_{,i} \frac{1-i\omega\tau_T}{1-i\omega\tau_q}$ (freq. domain)	PARTIAL
TPL	Frequency-domain form formally derived; time domain open	UNCERTAIN
MGT	Frequency-domain reduces to classical; time domain open	UNCERTAIN
MDD	Convolution-form flux; kernel-dependent	UNCERTAIN
Nonlocal	Integral-form flux; divergence theorem modification needed	UNCERTAIN
Piezoelectric	$J_i^{\text{elec}} = -\phi \dot{D}_i$	PARTIAL